

*Practicing A.A.'s Principles—
The Pathway to Unity*

**THE SIXTIETH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2010
Final Report*

Hilton Rye Town, Rye Brook, NY April 18-24, 2010

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



60TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Under the theme “Practicing A.A.’s Principles—The Pathway to Unity,” the 131 members of the 60th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the U.S. and Canada, met April 18-24, 2010, at the Hilton Rye Town in Rye Brook, N.Y.

Often referred to as “A.A.’s annual business meeting,” Conference week can be long, often arduous but ultimately rewarding—filled with presentations, workshops, trustees’ elections and committee meetings.

The Conference Committees met first in joint meetings with their corresponding trustees’ committees. Then each Conference committee met separately to review background material, deliberate and discuss various agenda items and come up with recommendations, some of which resulted in Conference Advisory Actions.

This year’s Conference was chaired by Ward Ewing, Class A (nonalcoholic) chairman of the General Service Board; Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O.’s general manager; and Lowell Long, delegate chair. Staff member Adrienne Brown was Conference coordinator.

Prior to the Conference, in February, the General Service Board announced with great sadness the death of Michael Alexander, a man deeply linked to A.A.’s history. He was remembered at the Conference Opening Dinner by his friend Jim Estelle, Class A

trustee emeritus. As Jim noted, Mike’s association with A.A. stretched back decades to a time when Mike worked as a young lawyer with Bernard Smith (nonalcoholic), and was present when Smith and Bill W. developed the framework of the General Service Conference structure. Mike later served as a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee from 1976 to 1985, and as chairman of the General Service Board from 1988 to 1993. “Mike’s historic knowledge of A.A., his keen insights and wonderful humor will be missed,” said Jim.

A.A. history was also evident in the Archives presentation on Monday evening, as G.S.O.’s Archivist Michelle Mirza (nonalcoholic) projected a photo of Bill and Lois onto a large screen for the entire Conference to see. The photo was one taken in San Diego in 1948 when Bill was traveling across the country to gain support for the Conference.

In keeping with the Conference theme, Michelle reflected, “. . . through our combined efforts, we can continue to support our objective in chronicling A.A.’s history, to sustain our unity.” She then played a recording of Bill’s San Diego speech, in which Bill said, in part: “. . . unless we are bound together as one there can be little recovery for those hundreds of thousands yet to turn to us.”

Leon Arps (Nebraska) was elected chair for the 2011 Conference;

Louie Bellner, (NW Ohio/SE Michigan) was selected alternate chair.

At the trustee elections Wednesday morning, Rod Betonney, of Salt Lake City, Utah, was elected Pacific regional trustee; Donald Cusson, of Terrebonne, Quebec, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee.

As excitement mounts for A.A.'s 75th Birthday Party in San Antonio, Rick Walker, International Convention coordinator, brought the Conference up-to-date on the last minute preparations and, later in the evening on Friday, the 475 Riverside Players (starring G.S.O. staff members) presented a skit based on some of the humorous situations one might expect to encounter during the July 4th celebration.

On Friday, the 60th General Service Conference closed with the Serenity Prayer in English, Spanish and French.

Conference members met for the last time at the Saturday morning Closing Brunch, with farewell talks from rotating trustees Bill Clark, Class A (nonalcoholic), and Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee.

Delegate chair, Lowell Long, summed up: "It's hard to say goodbye. What do you say? . . . I'll see you later. I'll see you soon. It's been fun."

Greetings

It is truly an honor to be standing here today as the delegate chairperson for the 60th General Service Conference. I would like to welcome our trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff and my fellow delegates to the 60th General Service Conference—and an especially warm welcome to our guests from Venezuela. I hope all of you enjoy your week here at the Conference.

When my name was pulled from the hat to be the delegate chair for this Conference, I was in a state of shock. My first thought was, "More work!" and then I found out what I had to do. One of the things I was told was that I get to give this welcoming address and chair the Delegates Only Meeting. This made me say "Why me?" (Because of my fear of speaking to crowds.) Then someone said to me, "Why not you?" and that "Nothing happens in God's world by mistake." (He really has a sense of humor.) Another thing I was told was that the delegate chair was to be the inspirational leader for the delegates. We are all here because our areas felt we

can be leaders and do the service they elected us to do. It during the course of the week your emotions are running high and you need a listening ear or just a hug—look for me.

Last year's Conference was a memorable one—ending at 2:15 a.m. After I got home, I remember thinking that "Nothing happens in God's world by mistake." My sponsor wanted a rundown on my experience of the week and to make sure I didn't screw up A.A. He just sat there and listened, and after I had finished he said, "Listen to me. I want you to go home and read page 122 at the bottom over to 123 in the Twelve and Twelve and call me." What a way to get calmed down.

Our theme this year is "Practicing A.A.'s Principles—The Pathway to Unity." I asked some members, "What are A.A.'s principles?" I heard: honesty, open mindedness, willingness, the right to participate, the right of decision, love and tolerance and the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts and the six Warranties.

When I came into A.A. I was living in a Recovery House, and I didn't want to be there. They told me I had to go to A.A. meetings. What kept me in A.A. was hearing about blackouts and smashed cars. I said to myself, "That's what was happening to you!" They also were talking about solutions. I heard things like: get a sponsor, read the Big Book, work the Steps, get a home group, and get a commitment. I remember when I asked someone to sponsor me and he said he would be honored. I remember my sponsor saying to me that if I work these Steps to the best of my ability, one day at a time, my life would get better, and I would begin to get right with myself, other people and the God of my understanding. He also said that I had to practice—practice these principles in all of my affairs. Then he told me to find a home group and get involved with it. I found one, which was the oldest group in the district and, at that time, only had two group members. Today we have eighteen members. Also, I found out a few years later that the founder of the group was a Panel 7 delegate.

I became a G.S.R., and my sponsor said to me, "You are the group's voice" and "Don't try to change A.A." A couple of years later I became D.C.M. Then my sponsor told me to keep my ego in check; I'm not the boss; and I am the link between the area and the district. A couple of years later, when I was asked to serve as officer-at-large because the elected person had to step down, my sponsor said to me that my Higher Power must have something in store for me. Six years later, after I was elected delegate, he said to me, "Not bad for someone that didn't like Traditions and Grapevine meetings and came in here with a black-eye, a spot in the middle of their forehead and didn't know he was an alcoholic." He then said, "Now you have to read *The A.A. Service Manual*—the one you don't like to read." Attending the Conference last year and going to the Board Weekend in January allowed me to see *The A.A. Service Manual* in action.

Throughout my service work and travels, I have witnessed members and groups practicing these thirty-six principles. I always try to remember what is stated on page 174 in the Twelve and Twelve: "Unless each A.A. member follows to the best of his ability our suggested Twelve Steps to recovery, he almost certainly signs his own death warrant. His drunkenness and dissolution are not penalties inflicted by people



Entrance to Hilton Rye Town, Rye Brook, N.Y.

in authority; they result from his personal disobedience to spiritual principles."

The same stern threat applies to the group itself. Unless there is approximate conformity to A.A.'s Twelve Traditions, the group, too, can deteriorate and die. So we of A.A. do obey spiritual principles, first because we must, and ultimately because we love the kind of life such obedience brings. Great suffering and great love are A.A.'s disciplinarians; we need no others."

This week we will build relationships that will last a lifetime. The week will go fast, and some votes may not go our way. Some folks may not agree with the majority, but the minority will be heard. In the end we will know that we acted in the best interest of carrying the message to that alcoholic that will show up in our groups looking for help. Another reading that is dear to me and reminds me of our theme is our Declaration of Unity.

This we owe to A.A.'s future:
To place our common welfare first;
To keep our fellowship united.
For on A.A. unity depend our lives;
And the lives of those to come.

I am truly grateful for this opportunity. Thank you.

Lowell Long, Eastern Pennsylvania

Keynote

I thank the organizers and Adrienne for extending the loving invitation to speak with you as we open our historic 60th General Service Conference. I am honored and greatly humbled. Most of what I say will point to familiar ideas, and I echo other Class A's who have said words to the effect of "Now that I'm finally getting it, I'm rotating." I hope you will receive my words in the spirit of respect and appreciation with which they are given. It is my wish that they make good sense and foster a tone of partnership and good will as we practice A.A. principles and work in unity this week.

The book, *Best of Bill* was initially compiled in 1988. The following quote from the foreword to this collection brings a warm feeling to my heart each time I read it because it connects A.A. history directly to our Conference. "In 1935, a nondrinking alcoholic stockbroker from New York convinced a hung over alcoholic surgeon in Akron, Ohio, that he didn't have to drink anymore. From that historic meeting, a program of recovery for more than 2,000,000 once hopeless alcoholics in more than 150 countries was to grow and flourish."

One of Bill's great talents was his ability to express the lessons he so painfully learned. Perhaps he spoke about unity most succinctly in Tradition One: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends on A.A. unity." In the Twelve and Twelve, p. 133, he says, "The unity of A.A. is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. Without unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God."

Our Conference task is to assure that the Fellowship remains focused and unified. As we begin our work, I am asking myself these questions: Why has A.A. grown and flourished, and can it continue to do so? Will this 60th Conference be able to facilitate further flowering of the Fellowship? I'll continue to quote that nondrinking stockbroker as I explore connections between A.A. principles and the pathway to unity.

The General Service Conference brings together a diverse group of strong willed alcoholics and a few nonalcoholics, some of whom are also strong willed—like me. We are men and women, younger and older; we differ in ethnicity, in religious persuasion, in personality, in so many ways. Each of us is committed to widening the



The Workroom at Hilton Rye Town.

circle of recovery, in his town, in her state, in our U.S.A. and Canada, and even around the world. What brings us together is a commitment to do our best to "keep our world arteries carrying the life-giving grace..." People cannot live out that covenant with the Fellowship by themselves and alone. We must move forward together, in unity, if we are to facilitate the Fellowship's flourishing.

Back in 1949, Bill was able to say, "Though many of us have had to struggle for sobriety, never yet has this Fellowship had to struggle for lost unity. Consequently, we sometimes take this one great gift for granted. We forget that, should we lose our unity, the millions of alcoholics who still 'do not know' might never get their chance." (letter, 1949)

Leadership is a complex job, especially for an organization that wishes to reach around the world. What audacity the founders showed in vesting leadership in the Conference—a group of individuals who come together only one time for only one week! Our enormous charge is to heed the expressed needs of the Fellowship and to adjust A.A.'s operations so that all of its trusted servants can do whatever is right and proper to assure that the heart of A.A. continues to beat vigorously.

Now it is 2010, 61 years after Bill said the Fellowship "never had lost its unity," and I hope that our 60th Conference will not take unity for granted. We must each decide to live out A.A. principles that demonstrate that we are leaning into and living into the Responsibility Statement, doing our utmost to assure that the hand of A.A. is always there. We must trust that all Conference members are living those principles. I believe, and I hope you will agree with me, that each of us wishes to assure that A.A. remains vigorous and freely available to both suffering and recovering alcoholics.

Hard decisions will be made here—shall A.A. produce another pamphlet, shall A.A. allow full faces in videos, shall A.A. develop another PSA, and even, shall we change policy or procedure on how to set the Conference agenda? Can we facilitate rather than impede the work of our General Service Board, A.A. World Services, the Grapevine and the General Service Office?

I wish to emphasize some beliefs that I hope you share. First, I'll return to who we are and who is here, and state my belief that our diversity is a strength. Because we are different, our ideas about complicated issues, like full-face videos, will differ. These differences allow us to fully explore issues and examine them from all sides. Our differences constitute a strength; we will not make hasty decisions.

Second, I believe that we all wish to support a unified A.A. for the future, and it is a measure of the strength of that belief in our vitality that diverse Conference members can express differences and expect to reach a good decision. When disagreements are expressed in the service of a higher goal, when we have each prom-

ised to do our best to keep A.A. alive, we commit to working together until we reach agreement.

Our principles help us find the pathway to Conference unity. I point to key principles for successful work. Tradition Two reads, "For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern." Tradition Twelve supports Tradition Two: "And finally, we of Alcoholics Anonymous believe that the principle of Anonymity has an immense spiritual significance. It reminds us that we are to place principles before personalities; that we are actually to practice a genuine humility. This to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us; that we shall forever live in thankful contemplation of Him who presides over us all." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, S13)

At the spiritual level Anonymity implies a "sacrifice" of self. This spiritual principle asks us to give up our need for power and control. It signifies that I am no more important than anyone else, that we value every member's experience, that hearing minority voices is critical to success. Genuine humility means listening and respecting others' sharing, and promotes emergence of a true group conscience. When we sense that what is right for the Fellowship has emerged from our discussion, we can move on. Class A's have a hard time finding true humility, not because we're more imperfect than others, but because A.A. has not saved us from death from alcohol, nor have we learned A.A. principles while working the Steps, sponsoring newcomers and living through the business meetings the alcoholic Conference members talk about.

For my third point, I believe that finding the group conscience on complex issues is legitimately difficult. Naturally, as we explore complicated subjects, we will sometimes express strongly opposing opinions. When people express irritation, or even anger, or cling tightly to a belief that seems fundamental, group conscience will emerge slowly. Strong-willed people change their views reluctantly on issues with uncertain outcomes. These difficult conversations challenge our humility. Can we reach deep inside and find the place that values true listening? Will we tolerate the expression of feelings, and respond with kindness and empathy to those feelings? Can we trust that others wish to work in partnership; can we continue to value sharing from everyone? Showing trust and respect and tolerating unintended offense are expressions of humility.

I trust that every Conference member wishes to listen carefully, to recall and to weigh all the sharing and the evidence, to express him- or herself clearly, to recall the need for unity and the higher purpose expressed in Tradition One. Writing this out is easy, whereas, when contentious issues present themselves living it out calls on all of one's inner strength and tranquility.

When the group conscience is not clear, we must lead with humility. Experience teaches us that the emergence of group conscience will be assisted by slowing down a bit, by listening attentively, by asking for clarification, and by sharing new information—about both facts and feelings. However, its emergence will be hindered by responding quickly, restating positions, speaking more loudly, retaliating in response to perceived offense, jumping up and down or throwing shoes. I believe that even strong-willed people can put their humility into action in order to discern the group conscience.

Bill had many issues and problems, like every one of us. He came to an essentially spiritual understanding that so long as his recovery was "all about me," his sobriety was at risk. As he struggled, he developed and fostered the humility that finally enabled him to listen carefully to other people's opinions, to respect their integrity and to learn from their experience. Stories about Bill and his own writings testify that the road to humility was confusing and bumpy. Although I personally have not traveled the recovery road, hard

knocks, surprises, and loving feedback have pushed me along the humility pathway. I'm certain this Conference experience will humble me further. I believe this journey never ends, and that we will journey together at this Conference if we partner effectively in service to the Fellowship.

I fully endorse the following statement that Bill made in 1958 after a contentious Conference. "A.A. was born out of trouble, one of the most serious kinds of trouble that can befall an individual, the trouble attendant upon this dark and fatal malady of alcoholism. Every single one of us approached A.A. in trouble, in impossible trouble, in hopeless trouble. And that is why we came.

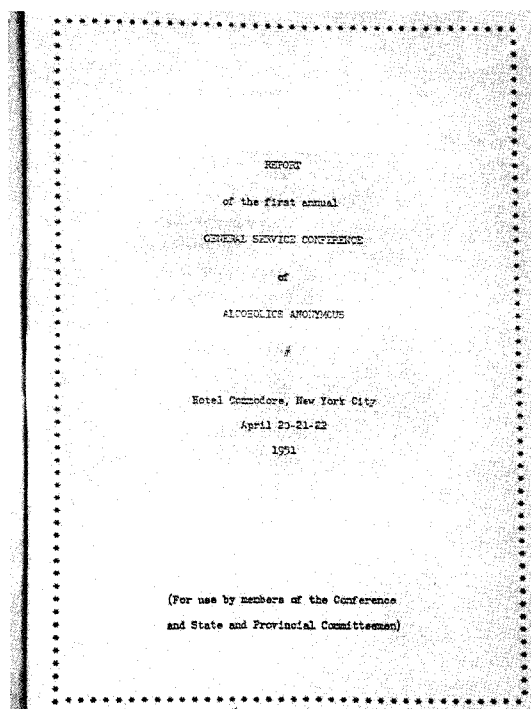
"If this conference was ruffled, if individuals were deeply disturbed—I say, 'This is fine.' What parliament, what republic, what democracy has not been disturbed? Friction of opposing viewpoints is the very modus operandi on which they proceed. Then what should we be afraid of?" (talk, 1958)

On Friday, I hope we can say that the 60th Conference was filled with progress, that we followed and abided by A.A. principles, and that no one was deeply disturbed. Personally, my intention is to listen attentively to the expression of opposing views. I hope that I will share when I have something new to say, and you have my promise that when I have nothing new I will shut my

mouth! And, whatever the ups and downs of our week together, when it ends I know we will have contributed to unity in A.A., and to strengthening A.A. for all alcoholics in the years to come.

I express to you my utmost gratitude for allowing me the privilege of speaking my mind at the opening of this Conference. You have been a gracious audience. Thank you again for your attention.

William D. Clark, M.D., Class A trustee



The First Conference Report was a mimeographed copy consisting of 27 pages – five of them being Financial. The 1951 General Service Conference met at the Hotel Commodore, New York City, and ran only three days (April 20-22). There were nine Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees, seven Class Bs, and 37 delegates. There was a total of 12 Advisory Actions: six general, four finance and two Grapevine.

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2010 Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 1 The request for development of procedures for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference, be recommitted to the General Service Board, taking into account considerations expressed during the 2010 General Service Conference, and forward a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.
- 2 The revised 60th Conference draft pamphlet, "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," be returned to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.
- 3 The request to replace the existing pie charts on page 12 of the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money & Spirituality Mix" be recommitted to the trustees' Finance Committee and report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Finance.
- 4 The Conference Committee on Report and Charter's Advisory Action which read:
"That Advisory Actions and Additional Committee Considerations be published exactly as approved by the Conference in the General Service Conference Final Report."
Be rescinded and replaced with:
"That the Publications Department work cooperatively with the Conference Committee on Report and Charter on the Final Report of the General Service Conference to ensure that all Advisory Actions and Additional Committee Considerations are consistent in format, grammatically correct, and accurately reflect the actions of the General Service Conference."
[See Advisory Action #33]

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 5 The theme for the 2011 General Service Conference be: "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future—Let it Begin With Us."
- 6 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2011 General Service Conference:
 - a) Alcoholics Anonymous in a Digital Age:
 - 1) Practicing Our Traditions in a Digital Age.
 - 2) Carrying A.A.'s Message Online.
 - 3) Grapevine—"A.A.'s Meeting in Print" and More . . .
 - b) An Informed Group Conscience: The Voice of A.A.:
 - 1) Self-Support—Where Do Money and Spirituality Mix?
 - 2) Humility—Accepting the Group Conscience.

3) An Informed Group Conscience—Using the Three Legacies.

c) Diversity in A.A.:

- 1) The Language of the Heart is Spoken Here.
- 2) The Hand of A.A.—Inclusive Never Exclusive.
- 3) Tradition Five—Our Primary Purpose.

d) Sponsorship:

- 1) Importance of a Home Group.
- 2) Leading by Example—Attraction Not Promotion.
- 3) Recovery, Unity, Service.

- 7 The following be the workshop topic for the 2011 General Service Conference: "How to Increase Participation in A.A.—Striving for Self-Support in All Our Affairs."

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 8 The pamphlet "Carrying the Message Into Correctional Facilities" be revised so that the sentence "Obey the rules of the facility you are visiting" is replaced with the following text:
"Deciding to participate in Corrections Twelfth Step work is an important individual decision. A.A. members should carefully read all paperwork required by correctional facilities, and fully understand and be willing to comply with all rules/regulations prior to commencing such work."
- 9 The pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" be revised so that the last sentence on page 4 under the heading "Policy Meetings" that previously read:
"Policy matters include deciding when and where the group is to meet; and setting the conditions under which A.A. visitors may attend these meetings."

Will now read:

- "Policy matters include deciding when and where the group is to meet; and setting the conditions under which visiting A.A. members may attend these meetings, including any required volunteer orientation and forms that must be completed."*
- 10 The pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" be revised so that the following two sentences are added to the end of the first paragraph under "Inmate Groups":
"Since regulations can and do vary, A.A. members will need to be specifically informed about the rules/regulations of each facility they will enter. To that end, good communication between corrections administrators and local A.A. committees is essential."

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



The Little Denmark Tavern, where two nonalcoholic ministers met with six alcoholics in 1943, and A.A. in Canada "officially" began.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 11 The following be added to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" where appropriate:

Q. Can our group make financial contributions to A.A. Grapevine?

A. No. A.A. Grapevine Inc. is not set up to take contributions from groups or individuals. Groups and individual A.A. members support the Grapevine by purchasing Grapevine and La Viña magazine subscriptions and other Grapevine publications and using them in their Twelfth Step work.

- 12 In the second paragraph on page 7 under the heading "How can groups participate?" in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix"; the second sentence "(rent, refreshments, A.A. literature,...)" be changed to read "(for example: rent, refreshments, A.A. and A.A. Grapevine literature,...)"

- 13 The trustees' Finance Committee gather personal stories drawn from the Fellowship that humanize the impact of Seventh Tradition monies for the purpose of communicating with the Fellowship about Self-Support in new or existing literature.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

- 14 La Viña achieve spiritual parity with the A.A. Grapevine, beginning in the following manner:

- Publishing La Viña as a bimonthly, perfect-bound, black-and-white, 68-page issue at an additional estimated cost of \$21,400 per year for one year beginning in 2011 followed by a year of review and assessment in 2012. The results of this review and assessment will be brought to the 2013 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.
- Content and substance be of primary importance.
- An announcement will be published in La Viña magazine, beginning immediately and throughout the trial year, encouraging increased submissions and subscriptions, moving toward the goal of being self-supporting.

- 15 It was recommended to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, that in order to reach the broadest spectrum of the Fellowship, sharing on the following items be gathered from the General Service Conference delegates on behalf of the 2010 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine:

- What is the value of the Grapevine magazine to you?
- How do you use the Grapevine magazine?
- What would you like to change about the Grapevine magazine?
- What do you think the purpose of the Grapevine magazine should be?

Note: Responses are to be submitted to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board by 12/31/2010 and included as background material for the 2011 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 16 The revised pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be approved.
- 17 The trustees' Committee on Literature develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous, and bring a draft or progress report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.
- 18 The paragraph regarding closed meetings on page 22 of the pamphlet "Frequently Asked Questions about A.A.," which reads:

"A closed meeting is limited to members of the local A.A. group or visiting members from other groups. The purpose of the closed meetings is to give members an opportunity to discuss particular phases of their alcoholic problem that can be understood best only by other alcoholics."

Be replaced with:

"A closed meeting is for A.A. members only, or for those

who have a drinking problem and have a desire to stop drinking. Closed meetings give members an opportunity to discuss particular phases of their alcoholic problem that can be understood best only by other alcoholics.”

- 19 The trustees’ Literature Committee update the pamphlet “A.A. and the Armed Services” to include recent experiences from members on active duty and a section which focuses on veterans of the armed services, and that the range of experiences be reflected in the title of the pamphlet. The committee requested that a draft or progress report be brought to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.
- 20 The trustees’ Committee on Literature review the booklet *Living Sober* and present a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 21 Donna Gibson, alternate delegate, Area 33, Southeast Michigan, be seated as a Conference member at the 60th General Service Conference because Derek Daniel, the Panel 59 delegate for Area 33, resigned.
- 22 Angel Andres Colmenarez and Carlos Julio Hernandez from the General Service Board of Venezuela be admitted to the 60th General Service Conference as observers.
- 23 The 63rd General Service Conference be held April 21-27, 2013 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws’ deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.
- 24 The General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself and that a Conference Inventory Planning Committee be established to develop a comprehensive inventory plan to bring forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for consideration, along with an estimated cost for conducting the inventory.

Composition of the Conference Inventory Planning Committee

The composition of the Conference Inventory Planning Committee (CIPC) will have a proportional representation similar to the General Service Conference including delegates, trustees, a nontrustee director, a G.S.O. staff member and a Grapevine staff member.

Selection of eligible delegates shall include those not elected as chair of a Conference committee who are willing and able to serve. The Conference Inventory Planning Committee will consist of 17 individuals with representation as follows:

11 Panel 60 Delegates

Alternate Conference delegate chair
Alternate chair—Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions
Alternate chair—Conference Committee on Agenda
One delegate from each region for a total of 8 to be chosen by lot by the chair of the General Service Board, the G.S.O. Conference coordinator and the Conference delegate chair.

Trustees, Directors and Staff

One Class B regional trustee
One Class B general service trustee who will serve as chair of the committee

One Class A trustee
One Nontrustee director
One G.S.O. staff person
One Grapevine staff person

The trustees, nontrustee director and G.S.O./Grapevine staff will be appointed by the chair of the General Service Board.

A G.S.O. staff member, appointed by the G.S.O. general manager, will serve as the nonvoting secretary to the Conference Inventory Planning Committee and coordinate committee meeting schedules and correspondence.

As a resource for the development of an inventory plan, the Conference Inventory Planning Committee will use the background, recommendations, questions and summary of suggestions contained in the report of the February 2, 2009 trustees’ subcommittee on “Discussion of the Proposal for a General Service Conference Inventory” and the January 6, 2010 report of the trustees’ subcommittee on “Developing a Plan for the General Service Conference to Conduct an Inventory of Itself,” along with any additional, related background material the committee may deem appropriate.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 25 The 2010 television public service announcement, “My World,” developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, be approved.
- 26 The 2010 television public service announcement, “My World,” be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$35,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.
- 27 The following text be included in the Conference-approved pamphlet “Understanding Anonymity,” under Facts About Anonymity on page 10, to read as follows:

“A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his or her death, but in each situation, the final decision must rest with the family. A.A. members, though, are in agreement that the anonymity of still-living A.A. members should be respected in obituaries or in any type of printed remembrance or death notice.”

- 28 The A.A. Video for Young People titled “Animation” be approved with a minor change in format so that there is one informational frame that reads: “For more information, search ‘Young People’ at www.aa.org.”
- 29 The term “drying out” be replaced with “detox” and “rehabilitation” replace “sanitarium” in the “What A.A. Does Not Do” section of the “A.A. at a Glance” flyer so that the phrase reads “...provide detox, rehabilitation, or nursing services...” and the entire section reads as follows:

“What A.A. Does Not Do

“A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover...solicit members...engage in or sponsor research...keep attendance records or case histories...join “councils” or social agencies (although A.A. members, groups and service offices frequently cooperate with them)...follow up or try to control its members...make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses...provide detox, rehabilitation or nursing services, hospitalization,

drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment...offer religious services or host/sponsor retreats... engage in education about alcohol...provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money, or any other welfare or social services...provide domestic or vocational counseling...accept any money for its services, or any contributions from non-A.A. sources...provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.”

- 30 The trustees' Public Information Committee report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information with a draft policy on showing or not showing faces of actors who are portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media, reviewing and taking into consideration targeted audiences for all available A.A. tapes and videos.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 31 The General Service Board consider adding a section describing the role of trustees emeriti to *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- 32 The Publications Department publish the Area Service Highlights in their entirety in the *Final Report*.
- 33 *Advisory Actions* and *Additional Committee Considerations* be published exactly as approved by the Conference in the General Service Conference *Final Report*.

Note: Rescinded by Floor Action #4.

TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS/ACCESSIBILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 34 The following slates of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. in April 2010:

Class A

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE	John Fromson, M.D.
Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.	Michele Grinberg, J.D.
Corliss Burke	The Honorable
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	Rogelio R. Flores

Class B

Rod Betonney	Jo-Anne Lowenberger
Kenneth P. Brueggemann	George G. Martin
Conley F. Byrd, Jr.	Don Massey
Donald Cusson	Don Miller
Dorothy L. Hurley	Eleanor W. Nault
John Kane	Victor Phillips
Roberta Lindeman	Pamela Reising

Officers of the General Service Board

<i>Chairperson</i>	Ward B. Ewing, D.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Jo-Anne Lowenberger



1170 Yonge Street, handy to the liquor store and railroad station just across the street, was the home of Toronto's beloved A.A. clubhouse from 1944 to 1960.

Second vice-chairperson
Treasurer
Secretary

Dorothy L. Hurley
Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE
John Kane

- 35 The January 2010 appointment of the following officers by the chair of the General Service Board be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2010:

Assistant Treasurer
Assistant Secretary

Donald W. Meurer
Doug Richardson

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

- 36 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2010:

Andrea G. Barthwell
Joe Downey
Phyllis A. Halliday
Roberta Lindeman
George G. Martin

William Noonan
Victor Phillips
Doug Richardson
Pam Reising

- 37 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2010:

Ginger Rhoades Bell
Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.
Robin Bromley
Kenneth Brueggemann
Nancy Haynes

Dorothy L. Hurley
Don Miller
Eleanor Nault
Albin Zezula

Presentations and Reports

FINANCE REPORT

Monday afternoon, the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by Terry Bedient, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. I am Terry Bedient, a grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report to the 60th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The PowerPoint presentation is designed to show key points of the financial position of the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, and the A.A. Grapevine. Our goal is to help you become as familiar as possible with our financial condition so that you will be able to communicate clearly when you return to your area. I believe that a sure way to improve the service structure is for each of us to develop a clear understanding of the finances of the Fellowship. Clarity in our understanding translates to clarity in our communications. Please don't hesitate to ask questions as the week progresses. Your area will be listening carefully to what you have to report after this Conference, so let us know what you may need in order to enhance the communication.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, will be included in the finance section of the *Final Conference Report*. Copies of the slides from this presentation have been placed before you, and the entire presentation is available from Ivy in electronic format, including text. My contact information is in the orange Conference Manual and I encourage you to call or e-mail with any questions. Also remember that Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, Grapevine controller, understand this information better than any of us, and they are available and willing to help with questions.

Last year, an insightful delegate noted that much of our finance communication is figuratively "preaching to the choir" and we should focus on giving delegates tools to use in talking about A.A. finance back home *around the picnic table*. I am hoping that this presentation will be a start in building a better tool box.

To begin the discussion, I present a draft of ideas (Chart #1) to use when communicating with the Fellowship about Finance—but each of you will have to determine the order of importance—and each of you will need to personalize the principles from ideas from your own experience.

- Talk about the spiritual value of contributing as you see it. You might talk about the sense of ownership, belonging, participation, and yes, even responsibility.
- Give poignant examples of how contributions are used to carry the message in North America—and throughout the world.
- Affirm the fact that although A.A. may have its fiscal ups and downs, the delegates, staff, directors and trustees are tireless in planning for A.A.'s viability long into the future.
- I would want those around the picnic table to know that A.A. has as many financial checks and balances as any other nonprofit organization in North America.
- At times, some of the numbers seem large and inanimate.

Please humanize the numbers. For example, a \$12 million Reserve Fund could be intimidating around the picnic table, but it is easier to grasp if we say that each group essentially owns \$197 of the Reserve Fund, or that each member owns \$9 of the Reserve Fund.

- Emphasize corporate poverty; our financial credo is "just enough."
- Encourage Grapevine subscriptions as an excellent way to help carry the message.
- And finally, lead by example in contributions, in subscriptions and in communication.

The next chart (#2) summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office on behalf of the General Service Board. We are all familiar with each function listed with the possible exception of the last line, Supporting Services, which includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other overhead costs. It would be difficult for the various service functions to operate without this support structure. The total cost of G.S.O. functions for 2009 was \$8,783,000, approximately 7% less than spent in 2008.

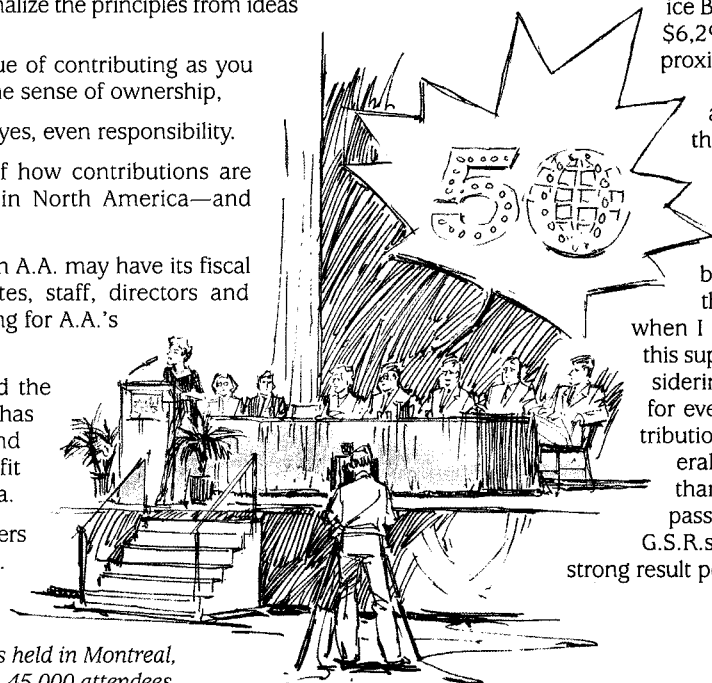
Some of the functional expenses showed increases, some showed decreases. For example, in 2009 we did not have the World Service Meeting expense or general manager search expense. Additionally, a staff member who left during 2008 was not replaced; 2009 was doing more with less—7% less.

Chart #3 is very similar. Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. And, there were no International Convention expenses in 2007 and 2008.

Chart #4 was specifically requested by several dozen delegates. It shows various member and group statistics. It shows that an annual contribution of only \$6.46 per member or \$142.64 per group in 2009 would have allowed the Services to be fully self-supporting from contributions.

Chart #5 shows a detailed breakdown of the Group Services activities. This is intended to give a broader understanding of the range of services performed by the General Service Office on behalf of each group. The next few slides explore the question of how we pay for these important service functions. As you know, the General Service Board has three sources of funds: group contributions, A.A.W.S. literature profits and transfers from the Reserve Fund.

In 2009 (Chart #6) the General Service Board received group contributions of \$6,296,000, which was a decrease of approximately \$165,000, or 2.5% less than 2008. 2009 was the second year in a row that contributions to support the activities of your G.S.O. declined from the prior year. This has not happened for many years and we eagerly await 2010 results, though to date we are on track with budget. I am sure I speak for everyone throughout our entire service structure when I say how deeply grateful we are for this support from across the Fellowship considering these tough times. We are grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help pay the bills of your General Service Office. A special word of thanks to all you delegates, and please pass our thanks along to the D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who worked hard to make this strong result possible.



A.A.'s 50th Anniversary was held in Montreal, with 45,000 attendees.

Slide #7 summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2009 amounted to \$13,758,000, which was about \$1,000,000 greater than 2008. We must remember, however, that several large purchasers made substantial orders prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase. After deducting the cost of goods sold, shipping and warehousing costs, there remained a gross profit of \$8,236,000, or 61.1 % of sales. We then deducted Program Expenses of \$2,685,000 and Supporting Expenses of \$1,790,000, leaving an Excess of Revenue over Expenses of \$3,760,000. The previous treasurer had commented on what had been a steady decline in the Gross Profit percentage. Though this concern was recently addressed, I would encourage the A.A.W.S. Board to consider establishing targets for the future.

La Viña (Chart #8), our Spanish-language magazine, reported slightly better financial results for 2009. Gross profit from the sale of magazines and related items was just over \$50,000, an increase of about \$6,000 from 2008. After deducting costs and expenses, the resulting loss for 2009 was \$54,000, as compared to a loss in 2008 of \$76,000. A loss of \$79,000 has been budgeted for 2010.

The A.A. Grapevine (Chart #9) incurred a loss as well. This week, you will hear details of extensive work underway to address a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. In 2009, the A.A. Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$2,127,000. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$1,247,000. Gross profit from related items was just over \$537,000, giving a total Gross Profit of \$1,784,000. Total costs and expenses of \$1,963,000, less Interest Income of \$46,000, are then deducted, leaving a loss for 2009 of \$132,594, compared with the 2008 loss of \$138,456. The Grapevine budget for 2010 anticipates a loss of \$245,741. Chart #10 shows various Grapevine circulation levels as they relate to profitability. In this chart, we find that the Grapevine was generally profitable in periods when subscriptions were up, and generally not profitable when subscriptions were down. The key is subscriptions.

Chart #11 shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2009. G.S.O. shows contributions, interest and literature profits totaling \$10,957,000. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$8,783,000, leaving a positive result for 2009 of \$1,273,000. Next we subtract the operating losses of the A.A. Grapevine (\$132,594) and La Viña (\$54,472), leaving a net combined positive bottom line of \$1,086,496 for 2009. This positive bottom line has been designed to assist in keeping the Reserve Fund on an even keel.

Chart 12 & 13 depicts the relationship between the Fellowship, G.S.O. and the Reserve Fund. G.S.O. has only two sources of money to pay the bills: contributions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than is necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund.

The last part of our analysis will cover the General Service Board Reserve Fund. (Chart #14). The Reserve Fund ended 2009 with an adjusted balance of \$12,135,909, equal to approximately 9.5 months of operating expenses, including pending transfers. This means that we remain in the lower end of the acceptable range in terms of the number of months of expenses covered. The Reserve Fund at the end of 2008 was the equivalent of 9.3 months of operating expenses.

I would like to remind everyone again of the key actions that have been taken in recent years to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. (Chart #15) As you know we have:

- Reduced the price of the Big Book by \$1 coincident with the publication of the 4th edition.
- Restored the price of the Big Book in July 2004 by raising the price by \$1.

- Announced increases in certain book prices and handling charges effective July 1, 2005.

- Accomplished a major cost reduction program at the General Service Office to lower our annual operating costs.

- Both A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine had price increases in 2009.

As a result of these actions, the Reserve Fund has fluctuated between 12 equivalent months of operating expenses in calendar 2000 to 9.5 months at the end of 2009. So, what can we say about our financial condition as we end 2009 and move along into 2010? Here are some thoughts:

- The management teams and boards of both operating corporations continue to work with incredible dedication and remain a true asset to the Fellowship.

- Group contributions were 2.5 % lower in 2009 as compared to 2008. We are pretty sure that this is a result of tough economic times. I believe that each delegate in the room today deserves a "tip of the hat" for a job well done and not letting contributions slip more. And, of course, the biggest accolades go to our contributing members. Thank you from everyone involved in the Service Structure of the Fellowship. Your contributions make it possible for our General Service Office to work tirelessly in the background of Twelfth Step work.

- The Grapevine and La Viña were both slightly turned in deficits for the year 2009, however, they were less than the original 2009 budgets. Both La Viña and Grapevine circulation dipped slightly.

- Our Pension and post retirement health obligations now account for about 12 % of the annual General Service Office budget. We will need to sustain this annual level of fund payments of approximately \$1,600,000 for the next several years. In spite of the size of this obligation, we are managing our expenses to stay within our revenue stream.

- A.A.W.S. finished the year with a positive bottom line, having addressed previous treasurers concerns that they "might find it useful to look more closely at the recent decline in the percentage of gross profit on literature."

- The Reserve Fund increased just slightly from covering 9.3 months of expenses at the end of 2008 to 9.5 months at the end of 2009. This performance is undoubtedly influenced somewhat by a lower level of contributions and essentially flat literature sales. At the end of 2009, approximately \$400,000 was pending transfer to the Reserve Fund. Additionally, we shouldn't overlook the good management and attention to detail shown by our general manager, financial staffs, and operating boards. 2009 was another year of very good work.

Each year, our external auditor gives us a report on the Reserve Fund. His report includes an assessment of the adequacy of the Reserve Fund to meet circumstances or conditions in the foreseeable future. For 2008, the auditor concluded that assets of the Fund were sufficient to allow A.A. to meet any such demands in the short-term. However, he reported that with the current uncertainty of financial markets and the potential impact of an economy in recession, we would have to consider that the present level of the Reserve Fund is not adequate to meet A.A.'s long-term needs.

The auditor's Reserve Fund Report for the period ending December 31, 2009 mirrored the 2008 report. Specifically, that the Reserve Fund was adequate for short-term obligations, but *not* adequate to meet A.A.'s long-term needs. Our auditor tells us that this is the first time he can remember that the long-term inadequacy has been noted in two successive year reports.

In response, the trustees' Finance Committee has established

a subcommittee for the express purpose of studying the long-term adequacy of the Reserve Fund. Committee activity will be reported out to the trustees' Finance Committee and to the General Service Board. However, it is safe to say that the subcommittee will be considering each and every issue which may affect the long-term adequacy of the Reserve Fund. We have all heard the phrase "put a dollar in the basket," but a dollar today is only worth eight cents compared to 1945.

In closing, I say "thank you" to members of all the finance and audit committees who sort through enormous finance details throughout the year. Thank you to Phyllis Halliday and Robin Bromley for competently overseeing our operating corporations. And a very special thank you to Don Meurer and Eugene O'Brien, our talented and dedicated finance managers. Don and Eugene tirelessly supervise our accounting activities, but more importantly, they guide our strategic financial planning.

2010 will undoubtedly be marked with some uncertainty and perhaps some surprises due to the continuing hard economic times, but there will be new faces, and plenty of opportunities for the Fellowship to continue to prosper. Let's just "keep on doing what we are doing," always trying to be a little better and 2010 will be another good year for the Fellowship.

And remember, Finance has no importance in and of itself. Finance is simply a way to help carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

*Terrance M. Bedient, treasurer
General Service Board*

PRACTICING THESE PRINCIPLES IN ALL OUR "SERVICE" AFFAIRS

Sunday afternoon's presentations were moderated by Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee.

What is the Difference Between General Service Conference and Service in General?

Let's face it—general service is not for everyone. Some think it's the business trivia of A.A. Some would rather sit through three root canals than endure one area business meeting. My wife, Rachel, has her own service desires. She likes to work with sponsees, make coffee and set up chairs for A.A. events—all of which are worthy acts of service. She openly proclaims that becoming a general service representative will be the result of all other service options being eliminated. Rachel is amazed that people like us love and partake in general service. After years of attempting reform, I became grateful for Rachel's right to choose the service that works best for her.

I myself have felt the coercion of those involved in general service when I was not. One time, a G.S.R. or D.C.M. informed me that I would be picked up for an area meeting at 1:00 p.m. He arrived at noon, but did not find me. I had left at 8:00 a.m. General service was not of interest to me. If asked to share at a treatment center, carry the message into the local prisons or partake in a Twelfth Step call, I was in. I understood the direct correlation between these kinds of service and my, and others', spiritual well-being.

However, on one fine winter evening on the west side of Mount Rose in the snowy Lake Tahoe Region, at my home group, I learned of a vacant alternate G.S.R. position. It seemed to make sense to serve the group in this position. Go figure. Sitting at my first area meeting as alternate G.S.R., I developed the desire to

serve as delegate. Service involving the group, district, area, and the General Service Conference took my heart.

Fast Forward. Like everything that is new to me, I pictured the 59th General Service Conference prior to attending. Oh the poise, respect, happiness and fellowship I imagined. I did find that, but I also found other things. It matters not that I felt disappointed that all the members of the Conference were human and full of human tendencies. What matters is the message I received by completing the circle of thoughts surrounding this idea that Conference members should act and do in a principled manner.

It occurred to me that I am a part of A.A. history by being here at the Conference, by just coming to the meeting. But why just attend a meeting when I can be present, closely tied with a loving higher power, educated on the Conference process, open to new ideas, quick to share inspiration and slow to pass judgment. I know all of you are much more mature than I. You probably worked diligently with sponsor and sponsee to ensure your absolute presence at this Conference. And I know you are all spiritual giants awaiting the moment to listen, and take care with A.A.'s future. Of course, none of you are run ragged, skipping your exercise regimen, eating poorly, snapping at somebody because you have a low threshold for those humans with their human tendencies. That couldn't be. None of us would rest on our laurels and then come here to take our chair at this great place of decisions.

When I experience the promises while serving A.A., I genuinely and naturally do so much. A gentleman approached me with intensity and an opinion. It seemed that for him happy, joyous and free could wait awhile. He spoke of the controlling area committee, the old hands who told him how it used to be and why it should be different today and that it did not matter what I wished to talk about, it was about him. I've learned that a slow heartbeat goes a long way, particularly in A.A. service. I kindly listened, I was intrigued. I wanted to know how he came to these conclusions and why. I am grateful that I learned actions taken day after day can produce emotional responses contrary to those I experience without them.

I need the program of Alcoholics Anonymous to be at my best in general service. Practicing these principles in all my service affairs is the direct result of my involvement in the Steps, working with a sponsor and working with sponsees, the direct result of taking action in this wonderful, incredible and undeserved program.

I need encouragement. So this encouragement I give. Higher power, Good Orderly Direction, God, please help me to care for my body, mind and spirit daily so I may be most available to my fellow Conference members and the decisions we make for the good of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Jason Carter, Nevada

Love and Tolerance is Our Code

Good afternoon, my name is Ruben and I am an alcoholic. A few weeks ago I received an invitation from Adrienne B., asking if I would present on the topic of "Practicing These Principles in All Our 'Service' Affairs—Love and Tolerance is Our Code." I almost fell out of my chair after reading this, especially after having inventoried my behavior at last year's General Service Conference. For the benefit of the Panel 60 delegates, I'll share this quick recap of a conversation I had on Friday night, about seven hours before the Conference finished its business. I was standing behind Bob M., the former East Central regional trustee, in line waiting to buy pizza, and I said, "Bob, I think I may be coming off a little bit too excited at the mic." Bob turned around and said, with a puzzled look on his face, "Really?" I responded, "Why, you don't think so?"

Bob's response was incredibly humbling: "Some might say aggressive." Again, having taken a close look at what transpired at last year's General Service Conference and what role I played there, I would have to agree that I was a bit "aggressive."

You see, it's not hard to get that way—"aggressive." Like most of you, I'm sure, I love A.A. I only want what's best for A.A. However, what I want for A.A. and what is best for A.A. may not always be the same. Also, I alone cannot manage A.A. and, as my friends continually remind me, it is not my job to manage all of A.A. I am but a single voice among many. I may have opinions on many matters, as I should. However, I am not the final voice of any decisions being made here at the General Service Conference, the area assembly, or my home group. Again, I only have one voice. When love and tolerance has escaped me, this is where I have to reel it back in and Tenth Step the matter right away. I should be checking my motives on what transpired and immediately institute acceptance and gratitude, which will evolve into some serenity (or peace of mind) that will lead to once again having that love and tolerance.

Trying to keep love and tolerance in the forefront of our minds and in our hearts will be difficult when conducting our service work—for myself at least. Like everything else in my life, however, A.A. has afforded me the opportunity to restart my day and reinvent these principles into my life. I hope that I am reminded of this later in the week when the rubber meets the road, and I promise you it will.

A couple of months ago, I was on the phone speaking with Phyllis H., our general manager of the General Service Office, regarding something that had been brought to my attention at the area level back home in Chicago. After a while, we were just talking about how quickly the General Service Conference was approaching and I said something to the effect, "One of my goals this year at the Conference is to leave without making amends." The response on the other side was a polite chuckle, followed by a reassurance that everything would be fine (this is how I remembered it and could be way off, I'm sure).

Now, I will be honest with each of you here today—I do have every intention of practicing love and tolerance here at the General Service Conference. However, I may fall short a time or two. This is by no means me trying to justify poor behavior in advance, only me pointing out that I am human and I'm still working on a character defect or two.

We have a lot of work to do this year, which is no different from any other year. I have every intention of fully participating; I promise this isn't a threat. We may find ourselves in precarious situations that require we have difficult conversations, and I will participate in those conversations. I will, however, remember that I am not the final authority on any matter here at the General Service Conference, that it's not "my will be done." Rather, that God, as we understand him, will speak through the group conscience.

In closing I would like to say that I've yet to be elevated to the level of perfection. "Practicing These Principles in All Our 'Service' Affairs—Love and Tolerance is Our Code" requires just that—practice. Thankfully, I have the Twelve Steps, Traditions and Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous to lead the way, and for this, I am truly grateful. Thank you for allowing me to be of service.

Rubén González, Chicago, Illinois

Setting an Example — Attraction to Service

When I heard that I had been invited to speak to you today, my thoughts were first and foremost, *fear*—followed closely by, "Jane, would you please quit planning service activities for me?" Jane was my sponsor for 11 years until she passed away in her first year as general service trustee in 2006. I have continued to experience

her loving guidance from above, and from others whom she influenced. Everything I know about my topic for today, "attraction into service," I learned from her. This is a story of how she was able to influence me, and many others like me.

I began my journey in service in 1991. I went to our area assembly to see our new area chairperson chair his first assembly. He was a member of my regular Saturday night meeting. I had never been to an assembly before that day, and was immediately sucked in. This body of people had what I wanted (and needed). I don't know how I knew that, though. I went to my home group and asked if I could be the G.S.R., and was told, "Yes, but we don't want any reports." So, I went to the district meetings and assemblies and came back to the group and they sat through my reports anyway, because the chairman told me I should do that.

The time then came when I needed to either get out of service or quit being the G.S.R.. That's when Jane's magic began working in my life. She seemed friendly enough, so I started talking with her, and asked her if she thought I could be of service to the area. That's when those eight magic words came out of her mouth: "I think you would be great as registrar." I stood unopposed for the position of registrar and was elected. Life continued on like that through several more rotations. When I ran out of ideas, she filled in with hers, eventually convincing me to stand under Third Legacy for one of the positions which were elected in that manner. I saw her do that time after time after time with others, as well as with me, and it never occurred to me that she might be wrong. She never was.

Jane's ability to attract people into service hinged on things such as her simple, unassuming, humble attitude toward life in general. She had a way of getting people who wanted to say "no" and really meant to tell her "no" to suddenly find themselves saying "yes" and not being really sure what they had just said "yes" to, or why they had even said it! I saw that happen on many occasions. It even happened to me. She had a calm demeanor that immediately got people to listen intently to what she had to say. There were times when people disagreed with her. That was okay with her. She did not find it necessary to force anyone's opinion, believing that the informed group conscience was where God resided, and that the outcome would be His, not hers, and therefore the outcome, whatever it was, and whichever way it went, would be the best for A.A. as a whole. Folks appreciated and admired that about her. And, I wish I had a dollar for every time I heard Jane say that every member of A.A. should be on a service committee. I learned to believe in the power of God as I understood Him by watching how she turned her belief in a Higher Power into action. She taught me to be a giver rather than a taker, and to truly believe that gratitude is an action word. But the biggest gift that Jane gave me is that she believed in me, and she taught me to believe in myself.

I suspect that all of you gathered here today have had a person such as Jane in your lives, too. There have been many people like Jane whose paths I have crossed over the past twenty years. When they shared, they talked about the importance of unity to the survival of the Fellowship. They never berated or belittled fellow members, but instead shared their thoughts and concerns by speaking the language of the heart. They all made it appear that service, as a way of life, was something to be desired rather than something to be dreaded, a duty or a chore. By doing this, they taught me, not by their words, but by their actions, that service enhanced the quality of their lives and their sobriety, and kept them coming back for more. If they had been ones who mirrored "Do as I say, not as I do," I would not have been drawn to service in the manner that I was. Their examples of inviting others to join them in their journey were done in an attractive way, rather than a forced way. Most importantly, they showed me that, if I did what they did, I too could stay sober one day at a time.

I believe that the key to attraction into service is humility, and I believe the key to humility is having an open mind, without fear or ego. People who practice a genuine humility are ones who appear open and receptive to hearing all sides of an issue, and share with others, not agreeing with everything that is said, but rather participating and sharing their experience, strength and hope, with little or no investment in the outcome. They are prime examples of a "loving God, as He may express Himself in our group conscience."

In Bill's April 1959 Grapevine article, *Leadership in A.A.: Ever a Vital Need*, Bill comments that, "A leader in A.A. service is therefore a man (or a woman) who can personally put principles, plans, and policies into such dedicated and effective action that the rest of us want to back him up and help him with his job." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 288).

Another comment he wrote was "Good leadership will also remember that a fine plan can come from anybody, anywhere. Consequently, good leadership will often discard its own cherished plans for others that are better, and it will give credit to the source." (*ibid*) By their example, they have what I want.

My path today is to put into action the tools that I have learned from those who have gone before me, to be on guard constantly to assure that I am in a fit, spiritual condition, to be the best example of the Big Book that I can be, and to lead by example rather than driving by mandate. A service sponsee of mine recently was sharing with one of our new G.S.R.s, and I overheard her say, "Betsy always tells me 'I'll bet you'd be great at that.'" Without even realizing it, I was carrying on Jane's example of attraction into service. In all my actions today, my first thought is "how would my actions appear to a newcomer?" Would my example guide him or her into sobriety, or push him or her away? The same holds true with service. Will my actions be an example of what service can and should be for the new recruit? If the answer ever is "No," then I have Step work to do to get to the causes and conditions. Sobriety and service saved my life, and I never want to stop trying to pay back the gift that was shared by so many willing servants who came before me.

Betsy Gerber, Southeast Texas

ARCHIVES

Monday evening George Martin, general service trustee, who chairs the trustees' Archives Committee, moderated the Presentation/ Discussion section on the Archives.

I am honored, nervous and delighted to be here tonight. I especially want to welcome the new Panel 60 delegates to New York—and hope that you will all feel free to use G.S.O.'s archives as a valuable resource whether you are visiting our offices in person, by phone or by e-mail. We'll do our best to answer any questions you may have on any aspect of either our work as archivists or on A.A.'s history.

When I received my loving invitation to speak, my thoughts alternated on a myriad of emotions—mostly on apprehension, but also a blend of excitement and gratitude. The invitation suggested that I focus my talk on Archives, as well as the Conference theme "Practicing A.A.'s Principles—The Pathway to Unity." I will begin however, by sharing briefly on my experience at the General Service Office. I came to work at the G.S.O. in November 1999 as part-time Archives Clerk, while completing my college degree. Some ten years later, and through various other positions in the Archives, I became the Archivist.

In the 10 years that I have served in the Archives I have been asked numerous times, "Are you a friend of Bill?" To which my reply was "no"; this was typically followed with comments such as,

"Well, I guess you don't understand" or "I don't think you can help me." As a nonalcoholic, this is a challenge; but having worked intimately with the collections for so many years, my daily interaction with A.A. members, my attendance at some open A.A. meetings, as well as my personal experience with an alcoholic for many years, I have come to deeply understand and embrace the meaning of "the disease concept of alcoholism"—a rather complex concept to accept for any nonalcoholic.

This year, our Fellowship marks its 75th anniversary with 35 years of continuous archival service. But the beginnings of capturing our history initiated over 60 years ago with Bill's vision and Nell Wing's oversight. Nell, as most of you might know, came to work for A.A. as a secretary in 1947, later becoming our first Archivist. Without having archival collections yet, or a formal Archives Department at Headquarters, Bill and Nell started to collect records of historic significance. Without those early efforts most of our historic records would have been lost. Today, whenever we need to research material from the past to either diffuse a heated debate or help with some other research, we appreciate both Bill's vision and Nell's efforts to save those records for the future. To this day, we continue to give credit to Nell, as she fastidiously set out on the rewarding journey of collecting, organizing and searching through the wastepaper baskets to save the discarded copies of correspondence that was sent out that particular day. Today, those unique fragile carbon copies are the most precious part of the collection.

In this vast correspondence, historical evidence of our growing pains is captured. Out of this emerged our Twelve Traditions—those principles which solidify A.A. today. Our Legacy of Unity was born out of past experiences, or as Bill would describe much later on, "hammered out on the anvil of experience." As this Conference proceeds throughout this week and as you consider proposed agenda items and engage in loving and contradictory discourse, may we remember how we have referred to past experiences, failures or successes to help steer us in making informed decisions.

When Bill first introduced the Twelve Traditions to the Fellowship in 1946 he stated: "But A.A. unity cannot automatically preserve itself. Like personal recovery, we shall always have to work to maintain it. Here, too, we surely need honesty, humility, open-mindedness, unselfishness, and above all—vigilance."

At the General Service Office Archives we are actively capturing this historic evidence—our valuable treasure—preserving it for the future and for our use. But archival service also extends to the area and district level and our unified effort can help prevent erosion of our values; our values are the embodiment of what we stand for. Many thousands of letters and administrative records are being preserved, scanned and secured. Those letters contain facts, humorous anecdotes and tragic tales that firmly remind us why our Fellowship exists. Bill often said that "it's the stories that make the early experiences live." One such story is shared by Ruth Hock, the Foundation's first secretary, in a letter dated November 1955:

"...To keep us humble and laughing were developments like the Southern group. The group's secretary wrote us glowing reports about the phenomenal number of new members in his group. One of our traveling members stopped in for a visit and his letter to us was an eye-opener indeed. It seems that particular group was based on the theory that all alcoholic beverages were very bad for the alcoholic — except beer. This idea was carried out so thoroughly that beer was served at their A.A. meetings with the copious reading of the A.A. book. Oh well—the beer itself soon cured that misconception."

The repository is also a habitat for thousands of voices captured on audio and hundreds of films, which includes rare footage of Bill

and Dr. Bob. We have professionally preserved these and are now engaged in fully cataloging each recording—a tedious but significant process that might take a number of years. The diversity of the voices in this collected memory, a social phenomenon, offers an alternate path to the past for scholars of A.A. history. It may be one way to augment and contextualize the records, and fill in undocumented mysteries.

The acts of organizing, preserving and scanning culminate to a single purpose: to facilitate access to everyone. Our access policies, established since our opening, are in place to ensure that the physical integrity of the A.A. records is maintained, and that the confidentiality and anonymity of members are safeguarded. We make the history available through the thousands of research questions that we respond to yearly, through resources published on the Archives portal of the A.A. Web site, through *Markings*, the Archives electronic newsletter and through outreach efforts such as our onsite exhibits and the newly created Archives Digital Exhibit.

Finally, in the spirit of this year's Conference's theme, I offer an excerpt of a recording of Bill speaking at a gathering in San Diego in 1948 as he was visiting the groups throughout the United States and Canada proposing the Conference idea. Even at this early time in our history, both Bill and Dr. Bob emphasized the significance of unity for our continued existence, preserved by A.A.'s Twelve Traditions:

"This is the latest terminus of the trip Lois and I have been taking across the country coming out first through Canada and then down here. There is no means of describing the things that we have seen and heard and felt and to see old faces and the thousands of new ones to stand again here among you face to face is something which we will treasure always. And Lois and I want to renew our thanks and our congratulations to your people here in this town whose achievement since we have been away is so very, very outstanding and we thank you. So we have been casting up out of our experience unconsciously perhaps to some degree principles best calculated to bind AA together into what please God may be an indissoluble unity. For we are coming to see and ever so clearly that unless we are bound together as one there can be little recovery for those hundreds of thousands yet to turn to us. So then to what shall be our relation toward those troublesome questions of money and of property and the disagreeable personal authority and possessiveness which the presence of too much money and property often engenders. Ah yes, next to the problem of recovery that's life and death comes the problem of unity and that is the question of life and death even more."

The original purpose of A.A. Archives has not changed since the early travails undertaken by Bill and Nell. Together, through our combined efforts, we can continue to pursue our objective in chronicling A.A.'s history, to sustain our unity.

Michelle Mirza, Archives Director

UNITY THROUGH INVENTORY

Tuesday afternoon's Presentation/Discussion topic was chaired by Ken Brueggemann, West Central regional trustee.

Our Common Welfare Should Come First

I am Irma and I am an alcoholic and privileged to be here and sharing with you my thoughts on "Unity Through Inventory—Our Common Welfare Should Come First." I thank you for the invitation.

Many of us have tried other avenues on our own to quit drinking before A.A., usually without much success, and many of us

have lost family members or friends to this disease. A.A. must continue to live or most of us will surely die. That stark assertion carries a world of meaning for every member of A.A. who has experienced the depths of despair before we reached this Fellowship. Experiences have shown that unity is crucial to ensuring A.A. does survive. So I ask, "What can ensure unity within our Fellowship?" Unity: As summed up in the Webster Dictionary, "Unity is the quality or state of being or being made one, in harmony, in agreement."

I believe the answer lies in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts—as we study them, review their history and apply them. The principles they represent are a guiding force that lights the way for any alcoholic who reaches out for help in Alcoholics Anonymous. I was gently taught, by the members of my home group, about the Traditions and their importance to the unity of our Fellowship. The insight from a group conscience meeting or a group inventory can tell how the group is functioning as part of the greater whole of A.A., what group problems exist, and where a breakdown within the group has occurred. These problems generally have to do with our relations, whether the relation between the A.A. member to another member or to the group, or the relation of the group to A.A. as a whole. Our future may well depend on how we feel and act about things that are controversial and how we work together to solve our common problems. In *The Language of the Heart*, p. 34, Bill wrote "While it is perfectly true that no A.A. group can possibly coerce an alcoholic to contribute money, to conform to the Twelve Steps of our recovery program or to the Twelve Points of A.A. Tradition, each A.A. member is, nevertheless, most powerfully compelled, in the long run, to do these things."

Keeping in mind that no one was going to punish me or compel me to do anything, my sponsors shared with me, and I learned around the tables of Alcoholics Anonymous, that I needed to conform to A.A. principles if I wanted what they had. And as it is stated in Tradition One, each member of Alcoholics Anonymous is but a small part of a great whole. For me the entire essence of our Fellowship and our program are the words "our" and "we" and "us."

A quote from Ward Ewing, chairman of the General Service Board, in a 2009 *Quarterly Report*, "The A.A. spiritual life is founded on experience, not doctrine, and the fundamental spiritual experience of A.A. is the movement away from self-directed—toward being directed by a power greater than self." The Steps, Traditions and Concepts came about thanks to a Higher Power guiding us, and years of experience and learning in the Fellowship from our mistakes and challenges. Am I willing to benefit from the experiences and knowledge of the past?

An inventory is a process of taking stock that can help determine if we—as a group, as a district, as an area, as A.A. worldwide—are adhering to the principles of A.A. found in the Steps, Traditions and Concepts. And what is the purpose of an inventory? I believe it can answer questions such as: Are we as a Fellowship practicing the principles of A.A.? How can we ensure that we in Alcoholics Anonymous are putting our common welfare first? Are we keeping our focus on our singleness of purpose and remembering that our primary purpose is to help the still-suffering alcoholic and to ensure that when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help the hand of A.A. is there? Are we practicing the principle of anonymity and putting principles before personalities? As Bill W. wrote in the July 1955 Grapevine, "Our Twelfth Step—carrying the message, is the basic service that A.A.'s Fellowship gives; this is our principle aim and the main reason for our existence.... Therefore, A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a Society of alcoholics in action. We must carry the message, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth will die." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 160)

How, as a whole Fellowship, can we take our inventory and what will that look like? What will it ensure? Again I quote from *The Language of the Heart*, p. 137: "We believe that our Conference, when securely linked to similar conferences in every distant land, can guarantee *absolutely*, the survival, unity, and functioning of A.A. throughout the world. We feel the deep assurance that this new beacon of light of service can endure every storm and peril that the passage of the years may cast upon us. For the first time, we are certain that A.A. is safe and secure." Since that time the A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada have exercised their right and responsibility to manage A.A.'s affairs through the general service structure, of which we are all a part. It is in this body, and through this structure, that the groups of A.A. oversee the management of their service affairs. An inventory is part of the process to ensure that the general service structure is still doing what it was designed to do.

At the 59th General Service Conference I got to share in the wonderment of witnessing how a bunch of recovering drunks from all across Canada and the United States would join together, putting aside our egos and personal agendas, to do what we believed was best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole.

Today I believe we are privileged people and that it is because of our misfortune and sufferings that today all our opportunities and blessings are thanks to Alcoholics Anonymous and our Higher Power. I am looking forward to serving with you all at our 60th General Service Conference as we do all we can to ensure A.A. remains alive and well. I thank you for the opportunity to share with you.

Irma Van De Bon, Saskatchewan

This We Owe to A.A.'s Future

Self-examination through the process of inventory dates back to the earliest beginnings of Alcoholics Anonymous. Our basic text, the Big Book, states on page 64 that inventory is "...a fact-finding and a fact-facing process. It is an effort to discover the truth about the stock-in-trade." Those words ring true whether we are discussing individual recovery, or A.A. groups, or any portion of our general service structure. Our Declaration of Unity states: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; To keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives and the lives of those to come." Seen in this light, any inventory of the General Service Conference must begin with a solid commitment to examining whether we truly do effectively manage the inheritance that is the General Service Conference with an eye towards our common welfare and the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous. Do we indeed act like the active voice and the effective conscience of our whole Society in its world affairs? The stakes are high indeed because failure means the disintegration of our collective services and, we believe, death for the individual alcoholic not reached.

Service to others being a deeply spiritual concept, any Conference inventory must detail how well we aim our financial resources and direct our service efforts towards a spiritual end result. From trustee-at-large Ruth Hartshorn's keynote address to the 1981 General Service Conference, "We ask ourselves what we do well, in which areas we are weak, and what we could do better?" We need also remember something driven home to me by my sponsor long ago, that our goal must be to sweep our own side of the street, to take *our own* inventory as the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. Our "What's On Your Mind Sharing Sessions" here allow any Conference member to pose any question about how we have committed resources or about how we have or have not effectively carried A.A.'s message this past year. Those unstructured sharing sessions go a long way toward en-

suring that a structured set of inventory questions never be scripted so as to divert light from reaching dark corners. So I hope whatever inventory process we might choose to use here will never replace those sessions.

If you have not noticed already, it is a little difficult to talk to the value of inventory as a principle and how we owe this to A.A.'s future when that item is on the agenda for discussion and decision at this very Conference. I am humbly trying to speak in a way that does not presume your decision either for or against that item. Do allow me to say at this point that I realize we are all here as Conference members because we share a deep love for the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. I realize we all bring experience in general service to these tables. And I applaud the fact that we all deeply believe in the primary purpose for which we are here assembled. That is all true whether we are alcoholic or non-alcoholic, trustee or director or staff member or delegate. Please allow me to say here that any inventory to be undertaken by the Conference will be examined closely by our Fellowship. As such, it would have to be reported upon at length and should embrace the notion that we, the Conference, because of the nature of our service, bear a heavier responsibility to adhere to our basic principles than do other parts of the general service structure. It would have to question whether authority has been properly used, whether responsibilities have been properly discharged, whether we realize that the A.A. groups, districts, and areas are actually seen as the end-users of the services we provide, and whether the use of their contributions and monies have been wisely prioritized. Tough questions!

In an address delivered to this body in the 1960s, former Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee and former chairman of the General Service Board Bernard Smith spoke on the topic "Unity and Continuity." Following his own near twenty-five years of service to us, he credited Bill W. with having had the most far-reaching understanding of our need for unity as a Fellowship. Mr. Smith, an architect of our Conference structure and the chair of six Conferences, warned about complacency, saying about Alcoholics Anonymous: "I am persuaded it enjoys a powerful structural unity, yet we can never become complacent with what we have so far accomplished for human frailties being what they are, we have to make certain as time passes that the structure of our society is strong enough to continue the unity which we have so carefully thus far nurtured." Therein lies our charge! He warned about excesses like the assumption of a "proprietary right to serve," about how essential it is to subordinate any of our individual desires to the greater good and to unity, and about the need for selflessness. He spoke of the need for taking action here with care and deliberation, and in all cases he illustrated these things with well-intentioned behaviors that had actually occurred, some of them his own.

So, can we be searching and fearless, yet restrain ourselves and temper our actions with selfless goodness in the process? Can we ask the questions and still respect the scope, duties, and authority of other service entities as we look closely at what we do as the General Service Conference? An inventory can be a bludgeon, or an inventory can bring unity in harmonious action. Can we embrace the process, trusting in the goodness of the outcome? We can never attain a *perfect* unity because that requires perfect love and perfect selflessness. But can we move one small step closer to God's chosen ideal for us today? Will we each be able to go to our separate homes and to report to other members that this Conference was indeed characterized by its Unity? That choice is ours.

Stu Elwing, Southern Wisconsin

What Happens After Inventory?

When I received my invitation to give a presentation at the General Service Conference, I was pretty excited until I saw my topic: "Unity Through Inventory—What Happens After?" I can spend hours talking about many things. However, inventories, other than Fourth Step ones, is one topic about which I have almost no experience. Confining my topic to five minutes and three typed pages, double-spaced, was not going to be a problem. It would only be one word: Nothing. In my years of sobriety and service I have participated in only three inventories, other than personal inventories. One was an area inventory. We had a delegate from an adjoining state chair it. We used the Traditions Checklist, and many things were brought out. My district did the same inventory, as did my home group. Only two of us showed up at the one for my home group—the G.S.R. and me. After all three of these, the answer to the question, "what happens after inventory?" was: Nothing. Change requires action. Identifying the problems and suggesting solutions is great, but if no one takes an action, there is no change. Nothing changes if nothing changes.

Last year's Conference was a tough one for me. I had heard the rhetoric: life changing event, etc. Well, that one was true. It did affect me profoundly, but not for the better. I left the Conference defeated, discouraged, disheartened and disappointed. I had wanted to hold the delegates to a higher, informed level, forgetting that the highest we get is sober, that each delegate, board member, staff person comes with their own experiences, knowledge and special gifts. I thought, "How could they not have read all the background information?" I wanted to make a rule that if you hadn't read the background you shouldn't go to the microphone. But the biggest eye opener was when I took my own inventory instead of yours. Although I had read all the background, I had only a nodding acquaintance with *The A.A. Service Manual*. As for the *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, I had only read them, the illustrated pamphlet, and attended a couple of workshops. I saw delegates who knew those things inside and out and used that knowledge in their areas; areas that get involved in the General Service Conference agenda; areas that talked about the agenda items and whose delegates went to New York with many different views and ideas, not just their own. It was a painful lesson for me. Having taken my own inventory about this, I am trying to have a better informed area. Small steps.

I keep thinking about the phrase about our Traditions: hammered out on the anvil of experience. If any of you have ever watched metal shaped by hammering on an anvil, you will notice one thing: the metal must be very hot before the hammering will have the desired effect. Beating on cold metal will just wear your arm out. Our Conference theme is: "Practicing A.A.'s Principles—The Pathway to Unity." Inventory coupled with action can identify problems, possible solutions, and implement the plans. We won't all be in agreement about everything. Some of us will be quite "hot" about certain issues. But we must always keep in the forefront the importance of unity. Our very lives depend on it, and the lives of those that follow us. Tradition One states: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

I would like to close with an illustration that helps me keep all of this in perspective. This is an illustration about singing and shows the difference between unity and uniformity. When we sing in unison, we are all in uniformity on the same song page, same word, and same note. You can understand the song, but it may seem thin and weak. When we sing in harmony, the different voices or notes blend and weave together to bring out a richer sound than we can get in unison. It is the richer blended sound that we should be shooting for.

Kathy O'Shea, West Virginia

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AGENDA SELECTION PROCESS

Wednesday afternoon's Presentation/Discussion was moderated by Rogelio Flores, Class A trustee.

How It Works

When I first received my "loving invitation" I thought about the topic and read through our literature to ensure that I knew what I was talking about. Then I thought again and decided to take the direct approach, rather than quoting from our literature and/or providing a history lesson. I took the "keep it simple" approach to this presentation—so here goes.

Our process works well when and if we let it. We all have our individual personalities and, at times, need to keep ourselves in check—all, of course, based on working our Steps and practicing A.A.'s principles. Our practice of allowing each and every individual member the right to a voice is how we stay unified. All opinions and concerns are, or should be, considered as valid and valued—whether this means general discussion or a requirement to vote.

This is how our agenda becomes a reality. A member, group, district, area or trustee has an idea or suggestion. This can travel through our service structure or can be provided directly—either way it ends up with G.S.O.'s Conference coordinator, who reviews the submissions in the light of previous Conference actions, then passes it on to either the trustee's Conference Committee or the appropriate Conference committee—whichever may be relevant given the nature of the submission. The idea or suggestion then becomes a workshop or presentation topic (such as what I am doing now), a proposal or a committee concern.

The Conference agenda items are to deal with policy for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, so if something that has been submitted does not fall into that category it then gets routed for general discussion as workshops or presentations. When the item does deal with policy it becomes a Committee agenda item for discussion, and in turn a possible recommendation on the General Service Conference floor.

Our process may appear slow—but in fact it is deliberate. It protects us from ourselves in that it does not allow for hasty or emotional decisions, so that at the end of the day—the good of A.A. as a whole is served.

Sandy Smith, Eastern Ontario

Collective Participation

In *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, pages 97 and 98, our co-founder, Bill Wilson, in describing the meaning of Tradition One, spoke of the trials and tribulations that were the greatest threats to A.A.'s unity. He spoke most directly about: 1) how "slippers" were treated like less than someone with a disease other than alcoholism, and 2) the out-of-bounds romance. However, Bill's two paragraphs from that particular passage (on page 98, that were a part of his Three Legacies talks on the topic of Unity, given at the 1955 International Convention in St. Louis) were visionary and contained a warning for the Fellowship. He warned us of "... forces among us that could threaten us in ways that alcohol and sex could not. There were desires for power, for domination, for glory, and for money. They were all the more dangerous because they were invariably powered by self-righteousness, self-justification, and the destructive power of anger, usually masquerading as righteous indignation.

"Pride and fear and anger—these are the prime enemies

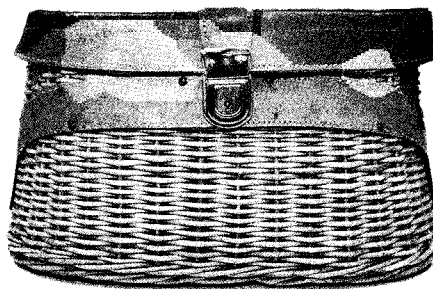
of our common welfare. True brotherhood, harmony, and love, fortified by clear insights and right practices, are the only answers. And the purpose of A.A.'s traditional principles is to bring these forces to the top and keep them there. Only then can our common welfare be served; only then can A.A.'s unity become permanent."

From my own personal experience at every service level—from my home group to the General Service Conference—there have been instances when disunity arose and, in retrospect, it usually came about because principles were not being practiced. In some instances it simply amounted to some person's or some group of people's voice not being heard or listened to about a particular issue or issues. I'm here at the podium to discuss the "General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process—Collective Participation." Frankly, I sat down to write something several times, but just couldn't wrap my head around it until it was almost too late. My reasoning for struggling with this issue was that I had seen instances when I thought the collective participation shone through quite brilliantly, and instances when it appeared as if the process of collective participation was largely ignored when the Conference agenda selection process was implemented.

An example of collective participation shining through was when I was able to witness the idea of an Archives Committee at the Conference level ferment from a few home group members, through the group, district, and area informed group consciences all the way to the General Service Conference floor, where Archives became a secondary committee. In recent years, however, I've seen several areas united in their support of agenda items that obviously had collaborative participation from the amount of information that was collected from participation of many informed A.A.s that never made it past the trustees' Committee on Agenda. At times like this I scratch my head and ask why? In part, this is because of the way our current process is implemented. There is no real, solid feedback given as to why these particular items were not placed on the agenda.

If we truly followed *The A.A. Service Manual* and agreed in principle and practice that "collective conscience of our Fellowship resides in the Conference" then Agenda selection process would truly, fully, involve the Conference Committee on Agenda and re-instate the duties and responsibilities of that Conference Committee, instead of leaving it fully in the hands of the trustees. Six areas submitted similar items asking for just such an action in time for the 59th General Service Conference, but it was made available only as a potential workshop item. This was after two Floor Actions that were defeated at the 58th G.S.C., which asked that a policy to restore the duties and responsibilities back to the Conference Committee, along with more information and an explanation. The explanations have been more forthcoming but not the consideration for more collective participation for Conference members to be involved. How hard could it be to accomplish extra committee meetings with the technologies available today—like teleconferencing, e-mails and conference calls?

Article 10 of our Conference Charter provides the General Service Board to set the Conference Agenda from long-term practice, which means "precedent." Does that mean what has always been done is best for A.A. as a whole? We have the ability to involve more people than ever before and reach forward towards a greater collective participation. Why wouldn't the trustees want to



When the 2nd General Service Conference was preparing for a Question and Answer session, Dennis Manders, G.S.O.'s nonalcoholic bookkeeper at the time, was sent out to find a "box with a slit in the top." Dennis, who would eventually serve as G.S.O. controller for many years, came back with a fishing creel he had spied in the window of Abercrombie & Fitch. Thus it became known as the "Ask-It-Basket" and was used at many future Conferences.

share the responsibility of the agenda and expand that process, thus creating more discussion and achieving a greater unity? Article 10 also states that "It is nonetheless understood that the board shall at all times reserve the right to decide which of its actions or decisions may require the approval of the Conference." However, if they are supposed to be responsible to the Fellowship in an upside down triangle, what proven process do we have to address any grievances that allows the collective conscience of our Fellowship to be heard?

As Bill pointed out in his 1955 talk on the Three Legacies, our biggest Unity problems occurred when we judged others because they had a slip or out-of-bounds romance, as if we knew better and had room to judge. None of us really knows better than all of us. We all suffer from the same illness and A.A. has no second-class citizens. Let's practice our Ninth and

Twelfth Concepts by listening to what someone has to say, even when we believe them to be wrong, and include them in the discussion and voting that is our inherent right and solid principle of A.A. That is how the God of my understanding treats me. He listens to me, even when I'm wrong, to hear what is right in my heart, because he knows of my love for A.A. Thanks to each and every one of you for your love and service to Alcoholics Anonymous.

J.G. Regnier, Arkansas

Communication— The Key to an Informed Decision

When first given the invitation from our Conference coordinator, my initial reaction was, "It's such a long topic, where do I begin?" My next thought about "Communication—The Key to An Informed Decision" was to communicate with my service sponsors to get guidance and help from them so that I could be better informed. A.A. has given me wonderful principles by which to live my life today. I no longer have to be the lone wolf in trying to decide things all by myself. Practicing such principles as love and service, tolerance, acceptance and understanding helps to keep me somewhat unified with those around me.

One of the problems facing the first Conference was how to get "the sense of the meeting" on important matters presented at the Conference. (*Your Third Legacy—Will You Accept It?*, p. 29.) In other words, communication toward reaching an informed decision. In the early days, communication channels were limited to phone calls and written correspondence. Today, the tools of technology have expanded our capacity to communicate with each other instantly. Have you ever received a reply-all e-mail that included 92 other people? Have you ever pushed the send button and later regretted it? Have you ever been in an A.A. meeting and were busy thinking of what you were going to share once the speaker was finished? Communication is a two-way street that also involves listening. I need to listen before I reply so that I will make an informed decision on the information being presented. This has not always been the case, as I have had to make amends for nonrestraint of tongue and pen. Before a decision of mine is "informed," I need to listen.

Communication in the selection of agenda items for the Conference begins with A.A. members and their groups. Groups can hold a business meeting or an informed group conscience. Items of interest can be communicated to G.S.R.s. Districts can hold district meetings and discuss items or concerns of interest to A.A. These can then be communicated to the area at assembly meetings. Some areas have panels which meet routinely through the year to discuss matters of interest to Alcoholics Anonymous. The results of the discussions from these panels can then be passed on to the delegate, discussed more at assembly, voted on and sent along to G.S.O. as a suggestion/request for inclusion on the agenda.

During the course of the year, during their quarterly meetings, the trustees discuss items relevant to A.A. and may also have presentations and workshops/discussions on an item. Subcommittees may also be formed during the year to further discuss an item. Background material on each item is given to the trustees before their meeting, so that they can come to an informed decision on matters before them. There can also be conference calls and e-mails that may take place between the times of Board weekend. This information can be, and is, communicated to the Fellowship through updates to the delegates, *Box 4-5-9* and the *Quarterly Report* of the General Service Board.

In reading the background material for agenda items to this year's Conference, you can see the amount of communication that happens among groups, districts, assemblies, delegates, our General Service Office staff, and trustees. One of the messages that I continue to carry to A.A. members in Area 13 is that the Conference is a year-round process. It does not end when we return home to our respective areas. We give our personal reports from the Conference; we stay in contact and communicate with our groups, the districts, the area and our General Service Office and the *Final Conference Report* is made available to the Fellowship.

There is a paragraph in the introduction to the Concepts which states in part: "There will also be seen in these Concepts a number of principles which have already become traditional to our services, but which have never been clearly articulated and reduced to writing. For example: the 'Right of Decision' gives our service leaders a proper discretion and latitude." [We must trust our trusted servants.] "The 'Right of Participation' gives each world servant a voting status commensurate with his (or her) responsibility." [This is a highly effective and unifying principle in which there are no 'superiors,' no 'inferiors' and no 'advisers'—we all have one vote.] "The 'Right of Appeal' protects and encourages minority opinion." [Many times a vote has changed from a yea-to-nay or vice versa based on new or other information.] "And the 'Right of Petition' makes certain that grievances can be heard." (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 3)

In July 1960, our co-founder Bill W. wrote: "The word is communication. There has been a lifesaving communication among ourselves, with the world around us, and with God. From the beginning, communication in A.A. has been no ordinary transmission of helpful ideas and attitudes. It has been unusual and sometimes unique." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 243)

Our Concepts and our unique General Service Conference are based on principles of communication.

Practice of these principles will keep us on the pathway to unity and make certain that our message continues to be available to all who seek it, and that our communication has been the key to an informed decision.

Elaine Gaisey, District of Columbia

A.A. AROUND THE WORLD

After lunch on Thursday there were two Presentations on international A.A. Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada moderated the session.

A.A. Around the World

My name is Don Massey, and I am privileged to serve as your trustee-at-large/U.S. My sobriety date is August 8, 1994, and my home group is the Responsibility Group, in Metairie, Louisiana.

My topic is "A.A. Around the World." For many, including me, it is a fascinating and very moving life experience to meet other A.A. members from foreign lands, who receive the same miracles from our Legacies that we do, despite some often monumental challenges. It is frequently a very emotional experience to witness other A.A. service structures in various phases of their evolution. Today, however, I will talk less about where we are, than where we aren't. Let me assure you that A.A. has touched the four corners of our planet. Our Fellowship has found its way into some very dark recesses in our world.

There is a basic, threshold question I have personally asked, and others have asked me: "Why do we need an international effort at all? Why bother?" There are two main reasons. First, Bill W. and our early A.A. pioneers, were steadfastly dedicated to carrying our message beyond the group, city, state, and countries from which we come. Very early on, Bill foresaw the need and utility of establishing footholds for carrying our message of recovery to "beachheads" all over the globe. Many of Bill's early writings on this subject can be found in archived Grapevine articles, some of which are reprinted in *The Language of the Heart*. Our collective group conscience, expressed through our General Service Conference, has consistently embraced the need to carry our message beyond the geographic constraints of the United States and Canada. The basic tenet of our Responsibility Statement does not place geographic limits on where the hand of A.A. reaches out to still-suffering alcoholics. Instead, we use the words *anyone* and *anywhere*.

Second, and in addition to the important primary goal Bill and early A.A.s expressed regarding carrying our message beyond the U.S. and Canada, is the impact that our efforts abroad have had, and should have on our groups here. Merely knowing that we are not alone is one of the most common things we hear each other relate in joy when we finally find A.A. The spiritual satisfaction of knowing that we have carried the message to others, particularly those who seek it, helps keep us sober. That other alcoholics we may never meet achieve and maintain sobriety using our same Legacies, despite war, repression and the very worst of human conditions, often inspires individual alcoholics who have much for which to be grateful. And, the spiritual connection with general services that groups forge through self-support, including supporting general services, gives participants from the group down throughout our service structure the very clear and inspiring realization that we are doing together what we could not do alone. Our common solution has been shown again and again to work well across the globe.

You may take comfort that the General Service Board, and particularly your two trustees-at-large, staff member Warren S. on the International assignment, Phyllis H. as general manager, all with the oversight of Ward Ewing as chair, spend a great deal of time and consideration in deciding when and how to use valuable A.A. resources in our international effort. When travel is prudent, and when a trip will reasonably further the end of carrying our message to still-suffering alcoholics, we will happily travel. I was just in Japan, and have been to Monterey, Mexico recently. For

both, our hosts participated in some self-support. Jo-Anne, trustee-at-large/Canada, has made a number of worthy trips between 2009 and 2010, and has reported those out to the Fellowship. Note that each trip was to a place where we were invited, and in which an organized service structure exists. That is our current policy. About that approach, I wonder and ask: "Are we institutionally complacent?"

When I look at a map of where A.A. has reached across the globe, I tend to focus on the blank or dark spots. I begin asking questions. Where aren't we? And why aren't we there? More to the point, what is our role, as a board, Conference and Fellowship, in carrying our message where we aren't? I have been wisely counseled that we, the U.S. and Canada service structure, do not and should not proselytize A.A., and that our service structure's role is surely not to start or directly bring meetings on foreign soil like missionaries. A.A. members, of course, start meetings, and as everyone here knows, our message is best carried one alcoholic to another. I totally agree that we are not "white helmets" from the U.N. on a worldwide humanitarian mission, or the Vatican establishing churches where there are none. As of now, however, we only go where an organized service structure has very specifically invited us. As a result, we have made repeated trips to places where A.A. formally exists at some stage of its evolution.

But I continue to press the issue, and put the question to you—what about the places where A.A. is unknown? These dark nooks and crannies are not isolated. Some are in treacherous places, with wars, oppression and other difficulties. Others are in our own cities and neighborhoods. Many are just out there in a sizable A.A. wilderness. Don't we have wonderful tools for carrying our message to our friends in the professions, such as P.I., C.P.C., Treatment and Corrections, to name a few? Think about it, if a preacher had not directed Bill Wilson to a lady who helped him find Bob Smith, they may never have met. If not, would we be having this discussion today? Professional intervention and assistance was a critical, prerequisite occurrence at the very inception of our Fellowship. Doesn't it still make sense to reach out to our friends in the professions? In addition, we all know how important a role the media, through public information, played in the evolution of our Fellowship—such as the *Cleveland Plain Dealer* and *The Saturday Evening Post*, to name a few.

We use our P.I. and C.P.C. tools on local, district, area and national U.S. and Canada levels, with varying degrees of effectiveness. We spend an enormous amount of time, effort and resources on these efforts at Conference, the General Service Board and G.S.O. Why not do it on a larger scale for countries where A.A. isn't? Why not call on medical communities within countries where we aren't? Aren't many of our Class A trustees, and possibly trustees emeriti, perfect for this role? What about C.P.C./P.I. calls on embassies of countries where A.A. has not yet reached, and where we aren't "attractive" because we are absent? Most embassies are but a half day train ride from here to Washington, D.C. Don't we have, and shouldn't we be selecting, Class A trustees who can represent us well in this context? Why the hesitancy to engage in this type of message carrying?

There is a legitimate concern that we may offend other nearby service structures if we reach out to countries in their region or neighborhood. Isn't this something that we can and should coordinate? In fact, doesn't the possibility of offending present an opportunity to work together with other service structures, and foster worldwide A.A. Unity? Our service structure clearly doesn't "know it all," but we do have a wealth of prior experience, strength and hope. So, too, do many of our sister service structures. The World Service Meetings and Zonal Meetings provide forums to discuss these topics, and should build relationships to

carry out this service work. Also, from what I have been taught, and from my personal experience, it is essential that we approach and interact with our sister service structures with humility, among all else.

Finally, we should consider the lightning-speed evolution of world wide communications. The rapid evolution of how messages are carried has transcended most imaginations, and this has occurred in a very short timeframe. World technology continues to evolve at break-neck speed. The opportunities to carry our message are incredibly rich and plentiful. Can you imagine the excitement that our pioneers would express, given the absence of many barriers and obstacles to communication? But will we let the world evolve without us? For example, in a very short time, hardcover books may very well be a historical sentimentality and an anomaly. Yet today, over fifty percent of our service structure's revenue comes from the sale of hardcover books. While this is a larger subject for another discussion, it fits directly into our discussion of A.A. Around the World.

If we are to be anywhere at all in the future, we must address these nagging yet fast track issues. How will we carry out our Fellowship's primary purpose, and as individual A.A. members how will we engage in our Twelfth Step suggestion to carry our message to still-suffering alcoholics in a rapidly evolving world? Here is a suggestion based on wise counsel: Never deviate from principles, but most issues aren't really an affront to any principle. Instead, the issue may just be a "change" in the *status quo*. For matters that aren't principles, love and tolerance are our code, and we should remember never to take ourselves too seriously. I will leave you with two more questions, which like the others seek more of an introspective look at us, as opposed to providing answers—perhaps inventory type questions. These are:

1. Who are we and what is our present place in the world?
2. Who and where do we want to be?

Don Massey, trustee-at-large/U.S.

A.A. Around the World

My name is Warren and I am an alcoholic. Currently, I am the staff member assigned to the International desk at your General Service Office. What an honor and privilege it has been to work at G.S.O. for the past 13 years. It is not often that one gets to combine avocation and vocation. I get to earn a living working for an organization whose life-saving message has given and continues to give me a life that is truly incredible.

Today, I am grateful for the opportunity to share with you some of the excitement I have experienced listening to the challenges and triumphs of A.A. members around the world, working hard to grow A.A. in their lands.

As many of you will know, the International desk is the contact point for those residing outside of Canada and the United States, primarily members of the A.A. Fellowship, and also those seeking information about A.A. Astonishingly, there is now an A.A. presence in over 180 countries. And, while service structures vary, currently there are 59 countries with their own autonomous General Service Offices. I correspond and share our collected experience with both developed and developing A.A. structures. It is important to remember that our office, while the most senior of the general service offices, has no authority over offices in other countries.

Your General Service Board and General Service Office, via the International desk, receives a number of invitations from service structures around the world asking us to participate in or observe A.A. events, such as conventions and conferences. Historically, the

G.S.O. staff member on the International desk has participated in overseas travel. In the past eight months I have traveled to countries I never dreamed I would visit.

In October 2009, Valerie O'Neill (your new Publications Director) and I were in Frankfurt, Germany, to attend the 15th European Service Meeting as observers. While there, we responded to requests to meet with delegates from more than half of the twenty-six countries that were in attendance. In addition, two A.A. employees of the Czech Republic G.S.O. drove several hours to meet and share with us.

Earlier that month, John Kirwin, our meeting planner, and I made a site-selection visit to Mexico City to choose a venue for the 21st World Service Meeting. We went armed with three outstanding bids. In the end, the Camino Real, a five-star hotel chain based in Mexico, was able to meet all of our needs in splendid fashion, including our bottom line.

A few short weeks ago, Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, and I attended the 34th Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous in Central America, held in Guatemala City, Guatemala. Historically, this event has been held over Easter weekend and it rotates from one country to another throughout Central America. Mixed in with the fun and fellowship, Jo-Anne and I had the opportunity to meet with staff and/or board members from several of the countries that were in attendance (Belize, Honduras, and Panama).

I have purposely saved for last my trip to Cameroon, West Africa, to attend the Second Zonal Service Meeting of Central and West Africa's French-speaking countries (RACO), which was held November 26th through December 1st, 2009. In addition, the 2nd A.A. Convention of Cameroon took place from 9 a.m. until 3 p.m. on Sunday, November 29th. Never in my wildest dreams did I ever think that I would get the opportunity to be a part of the growth of Alcoholics Anonymous in the land of my ancestors. It was my first visit to the African continent.

Both events were held at the Centre Spirituel de Rencontres de Bonamoussadi, a large Jesuit compound used for retreats and other spiritual meetings. I arrived at approximately 7 p.m. on Tuesday, November 23rd, after a long, but uneventful flight. By the time I was deposited at the Centre, it was after 10 p.m. At that time, I was informed that a national radio interview had been scheduled for the next morning and that I and Michel P., the representative from G.S.O. Paris, would be the primary interviewees.

The radio program, a one-hour regularly scheduled health forum, was dedicated entirely to Alcoholics Anonymous. Michel P., Emily E. (a local A.A. member), and I were asked many questions about the A.A. program. In addition, Michel and I were asked why we were in Cameroon at this time. Emily shared briefly on the extent of A.A.'s presence in Cameroon. All in all, it was a very productive broadcast.

With the arrival of delegates from seven French-speaking, West Central African nations (Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cameroon, Chad, Côte d'Ivoire, Democratic Republic of Congo, and Mali), RACO 2009 opened at 9 a.m. on Friday, November 27th. (Delegates scheduled to attend from Togo were unable to obtain visas.) Welcoming remarks were delivered by Michel P., followed by opening comments from Dr. E. Palomino, Class A trustee, chairman of France's General Service Board. Afterwards, I delivered the keynote address.

Next, first-term delegates were allotted approximately 15 minutes to provide country reports. All delegates reported on the growth of A.A. in their countries since RACO 2007. Nevertheless, several countries reported having less than a dozen A.A. groups. The country of Cameroon provided a bright note when their delegate reported having more than 40 groups spread be-

tween the cities of Douala and Yaoundé.

Over the next two days, the delegates met to discuss the goals and challenges of the West Central Africa Zonal Meeting (RACO), as well as the triumphs and difficulties of A.A. groups in their individual countries. Regarding RACO, there were several key issues discussed: 1. Will there be a RACO 2011 and, if so, should not the chairperson reside in the country hosting the event?; 2. Will RACO continue to receive the financial support of France and the U.S./Canada?; 3. The growth or lack thereof of A.A. in participating countries; 4. How to provide information to the general public, especially in Muslim countries where the use of alcohol comes with a tremendous amount of social ostracism; and 5. Understanding the concept of "sponsorship."

RACO was suspended for a day on Sunday so attendees could participate in the 2nd Annual Convention of A.A. in Cameroon. Over 150 A.A.s and friends of A.A. attended the day-long event, which featured welcoming and congratulatory addresses from G.S.O. France, G.S.O. U.S./Canada, delegates attending RACO, and several members of the political and professional communities. In addition, at the request of the convention committee, I led workshops on A.A.'s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

On Monday, the closing day of RACO 2009, each delegate was invited to share how he or she had experienced the four-day event, as well as what he or she would be taking back to the groups in his or her country. Afterwards, each delegate was presented with a small package of literature that was made possible because of the financial support of G.S.O. France and G.S.O. U.S./Canada. In my view, RACO 2009 was an overwhelming success and I would encourage continued support by the General Service Boards of France and U.S./Canada.

It has been very gratifying to witness first-hand the A.A. message of hope being spread around the world.

Warren Stafford, G.S.O. Staff

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE— "CARRYING THE A.A. MESSAGE"

Presentations on the English, Spanish and French versions of the Grapevine were moderated by Don Miller, general service trustee.

The A.A. Grapevine

As I sat down to compose my thoughts about the Grapevine and how it carries A.A.'s message, the mail arrived. There at my doorstep was a black plastic-wrapped parcel that I receive every month. How providential that the inspiration for my message was delivered at that very moment! Once again I was delighted to tear into my new "present," knowing it was filled with shared experiences of A.A. members, solutions for my daily struggles, and visions of hope for the future.

For over two decades the Grapevine has been a spiritual tool for me that has become a steady companion in my personal life. It has accompanied me to work and redirected my thoughts during a difficult day. It has traveled with me to appointments and on trips, reminding me to have gratitude for each sober day when faced with unpleasant decisions. It has literally been my "meeting-in-print" when physical recovery has prevented me from attending my usual A.A. groups. The Grapevine provides me with a much-needed recollection of the devastation of the disease of alcoholism, should I become lax in my practice of carrying the "principles" in my everyday affairs.

The Grapevine has always been a vital tool of communication within Alcoholics Anonymous. What began as a local newsletter

in New York, written by "six ink-stained wretches" in 1944, has developed into the Fellowship's principal magazine with world-wide circulation. It has evolved into a perfect vehicle to continue in our advancement of Twelfth Step work: carrying the message to alcoholics.

Many of Bill W.'s early writings, including his explanation of the Twelve Traditions, first appeared in the Grapevine as a means of communicating with the early groups. In later years several of his articles explained and clarified A.A.'s spiritual principles. From the beginning, carrying the message was the purpose of our magazine. As Bill wrote in 1946, "The Grapevine will be the voice of the Alcoholic Anonymous movement as a whole." The diversity of opinions in the articles has provided a forum for discussion and growth of our Fellowship, but with diversity can come controversy of thought at times.

At an area level, I have seen the Public Information committee deliver countless copies of the Grapevine to libraries, hotels, schools, senior centers, and health fairs. Our C.F.C. committee has been diligent in distributing the coveted copies of the Grapevine to correctional facilities. The Treatment committee makes them available to many newly-sober alcoholics, perhaps yet unable to comprehend an imposing-looking Big Book. The Grapevine's articles are used as topics for A.A. discussion and literature-based meetings.

However, as every valuable expression of our Fellowship develops, so follow its difficulties. Problems of funding, low subscription rates and other policy matters have arisen from its inception. In browsing through the Digital Archives of the Grapevine, many instances of this can be found from 1952 forward. Many changes in format have evolved, some received with enthusiasm, some with criticism and calls for change. The Grapevine clearly is a mirror of Alcoholics Anonymous, as these same issues have appeared in groups, districts, and areas throughout our movement.

I firmly believe that solutions must and will be found for these dilemmas if we adhere to the principles of the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts, fearlessly willing to search with determination to sustain the vision of the Grapevine's purpose of "carrying the A.A. message."

Bill W. reminds us, "All A.A. progress can be reckoned in terms of just two words: humility and responsibility. Our whole spiritual development can be accurately measured by our degree of adherence to these magnificent standards." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 271). I believe our reliance on these principles will light the path in sustaining the Grapevine for the next generation of our Fellowship.

Jean Smythe, Central and Southeastern Ohio

La Viña

What do we have with the Grapevine/La Viña? A friend told me that she only knew her dad as a man that drank too much for his own good. Later, in his sobriety, she found herself called upon to attend to him in his final years, and she would often leave him copies of the Grapevine. In spite of the fact he wasn't able to attend meetings, he met his Maker a sober man of some time.

We have all heard stories like this. Some stories, like that of my friend, touch us magnificently. Most of us, however, are more like me. I have only heard the stories. When freshly sober and an instant single father, with two in diapers and one in the third grade, I knew I wouldn't have time to read the Grapevine, so why get a subscription? It was a no-brainer. There was no time in my life for the Grapevine. To this day, decades later, significantly little has

changed. It was only a few years ago, while I was attending a Regional Forum, that I decide to finally purchase my first subscription. Because I also speak a little Spanish, I bought a subscription to La Viña as well. My thinking was, "I really should support Grapevine/La Viña, and maybe I will brush up on my Spanish at the same time." You know how when it comes to this program we can really short-change ourselves? I finally discovered what others had known for so many years—we don't support the Grapevine/La Viña, they support us!

I now make nominal time to read my Grapevine, perhaps one or two stories a month. That is the "little" part. Just that little part is pretty rewarding in itself. The significant part is that because these magazines really are our "meeting in print," and the old issues were piling up, something needed to be done. They are full of meetings, I am not a collector and there is absolutely no way I am going to throw an A.A. meeting in the trash. So we pass it on. We attend our meetings, listen, sometimes patiently, to others and we identify. We are united in our recovery. That same unity comes to me when I read an article of personal recovery. Now we have to pass it on. The easiest way is to take them to a meeting. I like giving mine to newcomers. A simple, "Welcome and this is for you..." I've just passed another meeting on. I definitely have time for that. A principle of this program demands I pass it on. Our co-founder, Bill W., used the Grapevine as a vehicle for the development of our Traditions.

The landscape of Alcoholics Anonymous, like everything around us, is constantly changing. Our co-founders have passed on to us the responsibility for the continuance of this great and life-saving movement. We cannot rest on our laurels. To fully participate in unity we must, when confronted with challenges to the Fellowship, say what is on our minds. The Grapevine/La Viña are accessible way to do just that. A couple of months ago I attended a workshop held by concerned members from all corners of our region that had to do with newcomers being preyed upon. Participation was in both English and Spanish. The first-hand accounts shocked me. Solutions were discussed, and sending these stories to the Grapevine/La Viña was one of them. The same as for the evolution of the Traditions. Our vehicle for unity in changing times is already in place, and available to us all. As a newcomer I could only listen; to participate I shared. To touch magnificently, we send in our stories.

Mike Peery, Southern California

La Vigne A.A.

Today, I am privileged to be able to speak about two good tools: The A.A. Grapevine and La Vigne AA—two of our publications with the same goal. They are both magazines that publish articles written by A.A. members who share their experiences, strengths, hopes and all aspects of the A.A. message: Recovery, Unity and Service. "In addition to personal experiences of gaining sobriety and working the program, articles deal with sensitive issues—often in topical sections grouping different points of view." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S85)

These two magazines are different in many ways, the first being their language (English for the A.A. Grapevine and French for La Vigne AA). The A.A. Grapevine is a monthly magazine sold mostly by subscription and distributed by mail. La Vigne AA is distributed bimonthly, also by subscription, but mostly distributed and sold with the help of our districts and groups, allowing us to minimize distribution costs.

In the end, both magazines have the same goal—"carry the message to those who still suffer." The French magazine is administered by the four delegates of Québec and the regional

trustee for eastern Canada. The other positions are: the editor-in-chief, the treasurer, the secretary, and those responsible for shipping. "The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is one of two operating entities of the General Service Board." (*ibid.*)

The international magazine *La Vigne AA* is a good example of the principles and unity of A.A. services. What is better than a group of people who get together and have the same purpose? Unity settles in, we have one enlightened group conscience, and one ultimate authority. We can have group inventory and service sponsors. Everyone can give their opinion and everyone listens. Everything is well thought out and enlightened decisions happen. What else is better to achieve unity? And then our ultimate authority can guide us. We have only to look around our Fellowship to see these principles in action. This week's Conference is the best proof we can have.

In conclusion, I would like to warmly thank all the volunteer members who work at *La Vigne AA* for their love, their enthusiasm, and for the gift of their time, which allows thousands of people to receive and read *La Vigne*. I would equally thank all the staff members of the A.A. Grapevine, who diligently carry A.A.'s message. These two publications reflect faithfully our Traditions and A.A.'s principles. *La Vigne AA* reaches French-speaking members in all Canadian Provinces, in the United States, Europe, Africa and Asia.

Thank you for giving me the privilege to express my gratitude!

Alain Desbiens, Northeast Québec

2010 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION PRESENTATION "A VISION FOR YOU"

As the excitement builds to San Antonio, it was perhaps fitting that the final Presentation/Discussion section was on the International Convention. Bill Clark, Class A trustee, was the moderator.

From July 1 to 4, 2010, an anticipated 45,000 to 50,000 people from around the world will stream into San Antonio for a celebration of the 75th Anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous. The city is loading up on coffee and ice cream, and street vendors selling a snowcone-like treat called a "raspa" will be out in force.

At the end of March, we had a total registration over 35,000, almost 5,000 ahead of the advance registration for Toronto at the same time. Members from 72 countries have registered, from Colombia to Kazakhstan and from Peru to Palau. All of the continents except Antarctica are represented, and there is yet time!

After a rocky opening on Tuesday, September 1, online registration soared. Almost 7,500 people from 40 countries registered in the first two days, and almost 1,500 hotel rooms were reserved. Making hotel reservations available to registered Convention attendees on a first-come, first-served basis got us off to a busy start. And of course, technology has changed things. In 2000, 35 percent of our attendees registered online; in 2005, about 70 percent registered online. So far for this Convention, over 89 percent of folks have registered online!

Ah, technology. Because it's now possible to post images, video and text online in a matter of seconds, we are putting special emphasis on anonymity in advance information about the Convention and in each meeting format on site.

Our Convention hotel block now includes over 100 hotels in the greater San Antonio area, as well as a university dorm. New hotels

are being added as needed. To help attendees get back and forth over the Convention weekend, a shuttle bus system is being organized, with a downtown loop and service to outlying hotel rooms.

Almost half of the folks who have registered have ordered the souvenir edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*. Pre-sales of a special issue of the Grapevine are ahead of "Comes of Age" by a nose. If even half the folks who order this fabulous book open it and read our history, we may be in for a new era of recovery, unity and service in A.A.

In San Antonio, the Registration and Hospitality Halls open on Wednesday morning, and the local Volunteer Host Committee will be ready to welcome Convention-goers. We are extremely grateful to the Volunteer Host Committee chair, Jim B., a past Area 68 delegate, and his co-chairs, Yoli F. and Bill T. They are heading an enthusiastic and well-coordinated local committee. Along with their subcommittee chairs, they're spending countless hours organizing the thousands of volunteers who will be greeting attendees at the airport, the train station, in hotel lobbies, at the stadium and in the convention center, on the streets and down on the River Walk.

A "Party in the Park" and several dances are scheduled to kick off the Convention on Thursday night. There will be music and dancing in HemisFair Park outside the back doors of the Henry B. Gonzalez Convention Center. Bands and a DJ are also scheduled inside the Convention Center itself, and in the Grand Hyatt and Marriott Rivercenter Hotels.

In all, more than 200 sessions are planned. At midnight on Thursday, marathon meetings start in the Hilton Palacio del Rio and will run until Sunday morning. Friday and Saturday from 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. meetings will take place in the Convention Center and at the Grand Hyatt and Marriott Riverwalk hotels. Meetings during the day will be held in many languages, including American Sign Language, and there will be simultaneous interpretation for the Big Meetings in the Alamodome.

The first Big Meeting will take place on Friday night with the opening Flag Ceremony and three speakers. On Saturday night, there will be the wonderful Oldtimers Meeting with members who have 40 or more years of sobriety throwing their names into the hat in hopes of being randomly selected to share for a few minutes. Finally, we will gather for the Convention closing on Sunday morning, when we will be presenting Nikkie Haggart with a copy of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* in gratitude for the role her father, Reverend Sam Shoemaker, played in the founding of Alcoholics Anonymous. A second presentation will also be made—the American Medical Association will receive the 30 millionth copy of the Big Book. The Convention will close with a three-speaker meeting.

In the summer of 1980, many of the members of my first home group loaded onto rented buses and drove from northern Minnesota to New Orleans for the International Convention. They were still bubbling over with enthusiasm when I got sober in September that year. I caught that spirit and haven't missed an International since. But I can tell you, I never imagined I would be coordinating one!

The theme of the 2010 International Convention is "A Vision for You." At each of the Conventions I have attended, I saw the city streets swarming with joyous folks sporting Convention badges. The hope of all involved in the planning of this Convention is that the sight and the stories of these A.A. members, Al-Anon members, their families and friends who are united on the high road to a new freedom, will truly be a vision for each attendee.

Rick Walker, G.S.O. Staff

International Convention coordinator

Reports from the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S., and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

Trustees' report: I have been inspired throughout the year by our Conference theme, *"Practicing A.A.'s Principles — the Pathway to Unity."* As your chair, and a nonalcoholic, it is truly humbling to be called upon to practice A.A. principles. And I hope in this first year of my service, I have walked the pathway of A.A. unity in doing all that I am capable of doing in bringing the Fellowship and the service structure closer together. We have had a challenging year from an economic point of view, yet we have had a productive year as well.

Our general manager, Phyllis Halliday, has completed her first year on the job and I think most of you would agree with me that she has done a tremendous job.

Our General Service Board has been blessed with the addition of some new folks. We've been joined by Class A trustees, Francis Brisbane and Corliss Burke and Class B trustees Don Massey, Don Miller, George Martin, El Nault and Pam Reising. New nontrustee directors on A.A.W.S. are Andrea Barthwell and Bill Noonan, and Nancy Haynes and Albin Zezula are now luminaries on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

The General Service Office was delighted to welcomed new staff members Mary Swart Cummings and Jim Malone on board, and they have hit the pavement running. And the hard working Michelle Mirza was appointed Director of the Archives—a well deserved promotion.

We've had some sad losses this year, as well. Past G.S.O. staff member, John Grant died in January. John worked at G.S.O. from November 1987 until November 1996. He was passionate about A.A. and, I'm told, he had a lilting tenor with which he used to serenade his colleagues at the office, singing his Irish ditties as he made his morning rounds as Staff coordinator, coffee in hand.

On February 16th, we also lost a great friend of Alcoholics Anonymous, Michael Alexander. Jim Estelle gave a beautiful overview of Mike's life at the opening dinner of the Conference. Mike was introduced to A.A. in the 1950s as a young attorney working in the same firm as Bernard Smith. He witnessed Bernard and Bill W. craft and hone the Conference Charter. He subsequently served as general counsel to the board and then as a Class A trustee from 1978-1985 and then as chair of the board from 1988-1993. He brought superb legal skills, keen insights and a love of A.A. to his service on the General Service Board. Another link in the chain of our history has fallen away—but Mike's influence and loving example of service will remain.

The General Service Board has met four times since our last Conference. Aside from the members meeting of the board at the Conference last year, the trustees held two of their quarterly meetings at the Crowne Plaza Times Square in New York and, for the first time in a very long time, we met at the Hilton Rye Town Hotel here in Rye Brook, New York, where we are now joyfully ensconced.

Since the 59th General Service Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Somerset, New Jersey; St. Cloud, Minnesota; Dallas, Texas; and Kalamazoo, Michigan. An "additional" Forum took place in Thunder Bay, Ontario and, also in Ontario, a Special "Remote" Forum was held in Moose Factory. Finally, there was a Local Forum for Spanish-speaking districts that took place in Mamaroneck, New York. All were attended by enthusiastic members interested in the participation of A.A.'s Three Legacies. One very creative innovation developed by Eva Sanchez, the G.S.O. Regional Forums Coordinator, was to introduce a Forum's Orientation Session at the beginning of these events to help those attending their first Forum get acquainted with what goes on during the sessions and to ask questions and meet some of the participants. I am sure that those who have so experienced this innovation will agree with

me that it is a highly successful addition to the Forum format.

As they do every two years, the G.S.O. staff rotated their assignments in July; this transition proved to be a smooth one as is generally the case.

There has been some exciting international travel to A.A. events overseas since our last Conference. Last May, Phyllis Halliday and Julio Espallat attended the 4th Sub-Saharan Service Meeting in Johannesburg, South Africa. In June, I had the privilege of attending the IX National Convention of A.A., along with Julio, in Bucaramanga, Colombia. It was an extraordinary experience to see another service structure functioning in many similar ways to ours, but at the same time adapting their structure to their own needs.

The 16th REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) and the 15th European Service Meeting were both held since the 59th Conference. Trustees-at-large for the United States and Canada, Don Massey and Jo-Anne Lowenberger, traveled to Arequipa, Peru, for the 16th REDELA from October 11-18, 2009. It was reported that countries like Mexico and Colombia continue to exhibit strong leadership in the zone by sharing a wealth of experience as well as other vital support. Warren Stafford, currently assigned to the International desk, and Valerie O'Neill, Publications director, attended the 15th European Service Meeting (ESM), October 19-26, 2009, which was held in Frankfurt, Germany. The European Service Meeting has been in existence for 30 years and continues to be organized by Great Britain's General Service Office and supported by their General Service Board. Valerie, along with Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, also attended the 8th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in Bangkok, Thailand, July 24-26, 2009.

I was personally inspired and strengthened by being present for the International Conference of Young People in A.A. (ICYPAA) in Atlanta this summer. The spirit of these young people is remarkable—enthusiasm for A.A., joy in living, caring for one another, the brashness characteristic of youth, emotional highs and lows, and hospitality for the newcomer and the stranger, including me.

As you may recall, the trustees met together in what some thought of as the "secretive" Executive Session. Well, we changed that. On Sunday, August 1, 2009, noting that in the spirit of dispelling an "aura" of secrecy that may adhere to this trustees' meeting being called an "Executive Session," and because the meeting had rarely been an actual executive session, it was decided to rename the gathering the "Trustees' Sharing Session." Since this was such a significant change in terminology and perception, I want to give the background to this change that I gave at the August board meeting so there is a record of this in the *Final Conference Report*. Hearing the history from our trustees emeriti, we recognized that this meeting was established to provide an opportunity for free and open discussion among trustees, particularly over issues where strong differences existed. Only rarely has it been a true "executive session" dealing with issues of personnel or misconduct.

We agreed that we need a time for open and honest sharing when we can explore new ideas, hear strongly held differences of opinion, and at times deal with personal conflicts. In a public meeting, trustees will not feel free to participate fully in such a sharing and, without appropriate opportunity, these needed conversations will happen in small groups out of the public eye, fracturing the unity we need as a Fellowship. We also agreed, because the trustees and staff work together as a team, it will be important to have the general manager present and occasionally invite other members of the staff as a resource for a particular topic. However, we also want to be clear that the right of participation and the need for transparency demand that the spirit of secrecy must disappear. We believe the principle of anonymity provides the key: What we

discuss in the Trustees' Sharing Session (principles) is open and will be reported; who said what (personalities) as well as truly exploratory ideas will not be appropriate to share as such reporting would damage the freedom of expression we feel is necessary. I think my fellow board members will agree that there is a lighter more open feeling now to our Sunday afternoon gatherings.

Moving on, at our Fall Quarterly Meeting in November 2009, the board received and accepted a report from its Subcommittee on Vulnerable Members in A.A. A serious question had arisen as to whether there was a role for the General Service Board in protecting minors in A.A. meetings. The subcommittee thought there were additional categories of vulnerable members in A.A. and expanded its scope of consideration. I'll quote the main points made in the subcommittee report, which was received by the General Service Board:

"The subcommittee members agreed that the General Service Board in its position at the bottom of the A.A. service structure would not have a role in setting any behavioral policy or guideline for the A.A. groups or members in regards to protecting any vulnerable member including minors coming into A.A. The A.A. groups and A.A. service entities such as areas and districts are autonomous and direct and guide their own affairs. The General Service Board has no authority, legal or otherwise, to control or direct the behavior of A.A. members and groups. This was corroborated by legal counsel...."

"The subcommittee members also agreed that it is the groups and individual members that need to ensure that all members feel as safe as possible in A.A. and that newcomers are provided with strong sponsorship and made aware that A.A. is a microcosm of society of the world outside the A.A. meeting room—that they may encounter a few members who do not have their best interests in mind about getting sober through the A.A. program of recovery."

"The subcommittee concluded that it would ask regional trustees to speak with their delegates about addressing the safety of all members who are in A.A., as well as those who may be potential members. It is hoped that the areas, districts and groups will discuss this important topic and seek ways through sponsorship, workshops and assemblies and committee meetings to raise awareness in the Fellowship and encourage the creation of as safe an environment as possible for the newcomer, minors and other members or potential members who may be vulnerable."

As all of you are aware, at last November's board meeting, we discussed at length concerns raised by some trustees and Conference delegates regarding the video Hope. We concluded that given the action of the Conference, which approved this video by substantial majority, it would be released as soon as possible and it did go out within days of that meeting. As a body, the trustees affirmed both the importance of minority views and the primacy of the Conference. We took the time to hear the minority, but clearly understand we are bound by the Conference action.

Now a bit about the future. Upcoming in October will be the 21st World Service Meeting. Our trustees-at-large and members of the G.S.O. staff will travel to Mexico City to share experience, strength and hope with delegates from all over the world. This event keeps the channels of communication open with A.A. communities in other countries and helps to strengthen our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service internationally.

And I know that we are all anxiously awaiting our upcoming International Convention, celebrating 75 years of Alcoholics Anonymous, which will be held over the July 4th weekend in San Antonio, Texas. So far 34,000 members, family and friends have registered for what will be a milestone joyous, spiritual experience. It's incredible to imagine that seventy-five years ago, Bill, at this time of year, was struggling to put together business deals and at

the same time failing to get drunks sober in his Brooklyn home. To think that he and Dr. Bob, in April of 1935, had no idea what an immense transformation in the world of recovery from alcoholism was about to take place—that when Bill dropped a coin into a hotel lobby phone in Akron a worldwide spiritualized society would be created that has embraced and saved millions of lives since then.

It is the legacy that Bill and Dr. Bob and Ebby and Rowland and Sister Ignatia and many others have left to us. The legacy of our pioneers has been turned over to us to continue at this 60th General Service Conference. May a loving God express himself to us through our informed group conscience during the coming week. Thank you and bless all of you.

Ward Ewing, D.D., chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, and the printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and the staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: G.S.O. staff, chief financial officer, publications director, human resources director, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of the A.A. Grapevine. A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. employees agree that our purpose, expressed through requested services and publication of A.A. literature, is to support members' and groups' Twelfth Step service, and to share A.A.'s solution with each suffering alcoholic.

Each year directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office, and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of my fellow directors.

The board met seven times since the 59th Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff, review updates on group services activity, track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations related to A.A.W.S., review financial reports, consider new budgets, price new and revised publications, consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and to address other pertinent matters.

The board utilizes the committee system to address extensive agendas, to thoroughly consider requests, and to gather background material. The board, in turn, discusses committee reports and votes on any recommendations presented by a board committee in these reports. In addition, each committee and the board as a whole conduct long-range and strategic planning. Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (considers the needs of all service assignments); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (oversees budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (suggests candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies).

Visitors and Special Guests — In 2009 G.S.O. welcomed 1,513 visitors, including several groups of 10-75 members. Many A.A. members have traveled great distances to visit G.S.O. and to express their

gratitude, in many languages, for their sobriety. One of the main highlights for members is a visit to the G.S.O. Archives where the welcoming Archives staff provides information and answers questions.

New Groups — A net total of 1,703 new A.A. groups were listed at G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact receives A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step activities. In most instances, we have been meeting or exceeding our goal for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s to have their new kits in-hand within 21 days of entering their information into the system.

Regional and Special Forums — Since the 59th General Service Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff have participated in five Regional Forums: Northeast Region in Somerset, New Jersey, June 26-28; Eastern Canada Region in Thunder Bay, Ontario, August 14-16; West Central Region in St. Cloud, Minnesota, September 11-14; Southwest Region, Dallas, Texas, October 9-11; and East Central Region in Kalamazoo, Michigan, November 13-15. In addition, two other Forums were held: a Special "Remote" Forum in Moose Factory, Ontario, February 14-15 and a Local Forum in Area 49 (SENY) for Spanish-speaking districts, September 20.

Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar, Rochester, New York, October 1-4 — Attending the 24th annual Seminar were: Ward Ewing, General Service Board chair; John Kane, Northeast regional trustee and A.A.W.S. chair; Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager; Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O. publications director; Bill Noonan, A.A.W.S. director; Eva Sanchez, G.S.O. liaison to Central/Intergroup Offices; and, Andrea Brennan, G.S.O.'s order entry manager, all of whom were invited to give a presentation. Two members of the Grapevine staff also attended.

Other Activities — Rick Walker is working full steam on the planning for our 13th International Convention, in San Antonio, which will celebrate A.A.'s 75th Anniversary, July 1-4, 2010. So far, 35,000 people have registered for this historic event. To use a Texas expression, it should be a "hum dinger."

The International Conference of Young People in A.A. (ICYPAA) was held May 29-June 1, 2009 in Atlanta, Georgia. Ward Ewing, Class A trustee and chair of the General Service Board, represented the Boards and the General Service Office.

Also, G.S.O. staff members were invited to attend and participate in many area service events, conferences and conventions. These trips help provide information about G.S.O. to A.A. gatherings and help staff to gather local experience to add to other collected experience available from G.S.O.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The board approved the Quarterly and Annual Web Site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

International — In 2009, trustees and G.S.O. staff members accepted invitations from A.A. in other countries to share experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures — these trips were reported out in the chair of the General Service Board's report. So far in 2010, two international trips have occurred: March 12-14, the 35th Anniversary Convention of A.A. in Japan took place in Nagoya, Japan; Class A trustee Bill Clark, and trustee-at-large/U.S. Don Massey took part in that event. April 1-3, trustee-at-large/Canada, Jo-Anne Lowenberger, and G.S.O. staff member, Warren Stafford, were invited to the 34th Central America Convention of A.A. in Guatemala City, Guatemala.

Financial (See details in Report of the Trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee) — **2010 Budget.** The A.A. World Services Board approved the 2010 General Service Office budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review. And now a look at last year's financial picture — For the year ended December 31, 2009, net sales of \$13,476,000 were approximately \$82,300 (.6%) less than budgeted. Gross margin from literature was calculated as \$9,843,300, approximately \$135,300 (1.4%)

over budget and \$1,032,250 greater than at December 31, 2008. Contributions received of \$6,296,100 were \$204,000 (3%) less than budgeted and \$166,700 (2.5%) less than the total for 2008.

Resulting total revenue (gross profit from literature sales, contributions, and interest earned on cash flow) was \$14,532,700. Total revenue was approximately \$299,000 more than budgeted and \$1,115,800 greater than 2008. Net profit for the year 2009 of \$1,273,600 compares with a budgeted profit of \$835,100 and was \$1,550,000 more than the \$275,300 loss reported for the year 2008.

Publications — In late summer, a letter was sent to Conference members announcing the appointment of Valerie O'Neil as Publications director. Valerie has worked at G.S.O. since September 1990 in a number of staff assignment areas and we welcome her to her new position.

Books-Unit Distribution — Total distribution of all books for the year 2009 was 2,212,348 units, up 5% from the same period in 2008, 2,113,574. For the year ending December 2009, total A.A. purchases amounted to 1,695,186 units, while non-A.A.s accounted for 517,162 units, or 30.6%. This percentage is much higher than normal, owing to a large order received from Hazelden prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase. Andrea Brennan, Order Entry manager, estimates that the Hazelden order represented two to three years' inventory for them. In 2008, non-A.A. purchases represented 20% of total units distributed.

Big Book Sales (All Formats) — For the year 2009, we distributed 1,224,346 units, compared to 1,111,906 units in 2008. The 1,224,346 units represents 55.5% of 2009 all books distribution.

Gross Sales — Budgeted gross sales for 2009 was \$13,900,000. Actual 2009 gross sales, unaudited, amounted to \$13,751,111 or 1.08% under budget.

Production — An attractive flyer with an order form and information about new products and formats was mailed November 25, 2009 in the Winter issue of *Box 4-5-9*. The flyer and the highly-anticipated "Young People's Video" DVD, with an explanation of revised credits in one segment of the video, were mailed to all Conference members on December 7.

Reprint Requests — Since its October 2009 meeting, A.A.W.S. has granted permission/did not object to 30 requests to reprint from A.A. literature, and denied permission (including lack of authority to grant permission) to 15 requests.

G.S.O. and Staff Operations — At year-end 2009, G.S.O. had 78 full-time employees, and 5 part-time employees.

New Staff — In 2009, we were delighted to welcome newly appointed G.S.O. staff members, Mary Swart Cumings and Jim Malone.

Contributions online — The G.S.O. Web site Contributions online project continued on schedule with final testing and reviews with staff throughout the year and the A.A.W.S. Board in October. The final steps, prior to the anticipated "go live" date in May, included a demonstration to the General Service Board in January and to members of the 2010 General Service Conference in April.

A.A. Directories — The G.S.O. Records Department has begun the process of coordinating with area registrars to update all records with the intention of printing Regional Directories in 2010.

G.S.O. Archives — We were very pleased to announce that, on November 1, 2009, Michelle Mirza was appointed as our new Archives director. Michelle has been with G.S.O. in the Archives Department since 1999 and prior to her appointment was serving as acting archivist. The Archives staff continues their efforts to digitize thousands of group records saved on deteriorating microfiche cards as well as digitizing its collection of administrative records and other collections. The A.A.W.S. Board approved a budget for renovation in the Archives vault storage, and the newly renovated area doubled the existing storage space.

John Kane, chair

Literature Distributed — 2009

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	560,953
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	466,736
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	49,640
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	142,809
Daily Reflections	160,090
Daily Reflections (large print)	13,301
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	179,165
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	8,513
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	186,568
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	23,519
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	56,924
A.A. Comes of Age	10,818
As Bill Sees It	34,650
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	30,361
As Bill Sees It (large print)	5,674
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	10,904
"Pass It On"	9,209
Experience, Strength & Hope	10,322
Total	1,960,156

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	24,761
Living Sober	156,347
Living Sober (large print)	7,434
Came to Believe	58,298
Came to Believe (large print)	3,621
A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate	18,607
Total	269,068

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	12,914
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	23,932
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	31,971
A.A. for the Native North American	14,605
A.A. for the Woman	105,776
The A.A. Group	89,269
A.A. in Your Community	43,009
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	18,543
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	23,547
The A.A. Membership Survey	30,594
The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs	91,111
A.A. Tradition—How It Developed	26,656
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	12,552
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	125,809
Circles of Love and Service	46,744
Bridging the Gap	29,691
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	18,164
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	13,775
Do You Think You're Different?	113,636
Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.	235,511
Frequently Asked Questions About A.A. (large print)	6,897
G.S.R.	42,880
Grapevine—Our Meeting in Print	16,412
How A.A. Members Cooperate	15,583
How It Works	62,429
If You Are a Professional	33,910
Inside A.A.	45,379
A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic	24,319
Is A.A. for You?	384,050

Is A.A. for Me?	94,240
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	20,776
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	75,156
It Happened to Alice	36,942
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	37,971
The Jack Alexander Article	20,631
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends*	11,717
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	47,309
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	33,151
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	11,194
A Newcomer Asks	333,047
Problems Other Than Alcohol	111,112
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	299,931
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	15,540
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	31,070
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	61,318
Twelve Tradition Flyer	7,064
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	48,921
This Is A.A.	294,258
This Is A.A. (large print)	5,592
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	17,409
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (large print)	55,720
Too Young?	70,079
Understanding Anonymity	59,997
What Happened to Joe	38,437
Young People and A.A.	104,066
Total	3,682,316

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	288,129
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	41,650
Wallet cards-Anonymity	34,064
Anonymity Display Card	1,616
Parchment scrolls	2,046
Placards	513
C.P.C. Workbook	1,452
Archives Workbook	690
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,080
P.I. Workbook	1,748
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,490
Treatment Facility Kit	407
Big Book on CD ROM	81
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk 15	
A.A. Guidelines	82,622
Group Handbook	2,650
Wire Racks	1,784
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	62
Audio CDs	978
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	312
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th ed. cassette album)	18
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th ed. cd album)	2,133
A.A. Comes of Age (cd album)	629
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	122
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cd album)	1,380
TV Public Service Announcements	565
Radio Public Service Announcements	218
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,845
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,758
Fact File	2,146
Table Top Display 12 & 12	448
Pioneers of A.A. (cassette album)	7
Pioneers of A.A. (cd album)	116
Living Sober (cassette album)	11
Living Sober (cd album)	442
Total	475,227
Grand Total	6,386,767

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	13,247
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	13,015
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	7,400
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous Large Print)	4,844
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	4,807
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,543
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,683
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	3,383
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	8,687
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	13,360
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./ Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	4,212
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	21,555
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	5,589
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	4,922
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	4,207
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)	5,050
De las tinieblas hacia la luz	4,726
Total	125,230

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	8,820
Preguntas Frecuentes acerca de A.A. (Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.)	28,427
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	23,055
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	63,299
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	9,178
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	4,163
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	1,642
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	1,352
Seamos amistosos con nuestros amigos (Let's be Friendly with our Friends)	710
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,943
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	9,482
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	3,880
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	8,875
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	1,962
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	10,876
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	8,831
El Miembro de A.A.—Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs)	3,785
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	3,582
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	888

Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	15,209
La Tradición de A.A.—¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition—How It Developed)	1,604
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	12,749
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	2,446
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	6,878
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	3,812
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,312
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,616
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,711
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,560
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	4,276
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	7,221
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	6,450
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	2,818
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	11,646
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,717
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,768
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	13,702
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	5,077
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	5,908
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,976
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,454
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	3,067
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	2,321
El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A. Legacy of Service)	1,565
Si Usted es un Profesional (If you are a Professional...)	2,209
El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A. (Grapevine...Our Meeting in Print)	1,281
¿Demasiado Joven? (Too Young?)	2,843
Total	324,946

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	11,349
Parchments, Spanish	360
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	10,862
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	88
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cd album) (Big Book on cd)	116
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	22
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (cd album)	1,187
Total	23,984
Grand Total	474,160

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format relie)	5,161
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format souple)	1,462
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format poche)	521
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,633
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format souple)	761
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format poche)	285
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	397
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,007
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,961
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	400
(Expérience, Strength and Hope)	
(Experience, Strength and Hope)	355
Transmets-Le	
(Pass It On)	720
Total	17,663

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus à croire (Came to Believe)	1,641
Vivre...sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,965
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,309
Total	5,915

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	9,840
Foire aux Questions sur les A.A. (Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.)	2,910
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	14,062
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	3,016
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	434
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,476
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue (The A.A. Member—Medications & Other Drugs)	2,846
Les A.A.—Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	636
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	393
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,773
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,392
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	364
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	761
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	957
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	569
Jean face à son problème d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	492
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,168
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,450
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	645
Les Douze Traditions illustrées (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,452

Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	234
Ça vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	1,219
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	2,189
Les membres du clergé se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	516
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	919
Message à l'intention d'un détenu (Memo to an Inmate)	718
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	370
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,455
Les Douze Concepts illustrés (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,510
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,546
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	1,226
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,197
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,720
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	633
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	3,316
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,204
L'Héritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	512
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,832
Vous croyez-vous différent? (Do You Think You're Different?)	111
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2,123
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	2,292
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,267
AA pour l'alcoolique plus âgé (AA for the older alcoholic)	1,692
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	4,413
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,238
Favoriser le rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	652
Les Douze Etapes Illustrées (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,338
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	348
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amérique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	259
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	2,835
Total	91,520

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	4
12 & 12 (cd album)	481
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,318
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	996
Carte Je Suis Responsable (I am responsible wallet card)	427
Video Cassettes	15
Notre Méthode (How It Works)	14,856
Manuel de Groupe	45
Pochette de l'Information Publique	17
Pochette des Centres de Detention	10
Pochette de la CMP	28
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	91
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	5
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	319
Total	19,612
Grand Total	134,710

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Director's report: Alcoholics Anonymous (A.A.) Grapevine, Inc., one of the two operating corporations of the General Service Board, publishes the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous in print and in audio, along with collections of Grapevine magazine articles in books, CDs, and on the Web site. With the financial support of the General Service Board, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., also publishes *La Viña*, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and collections of *La Viña* stories in CDs and other formats. Sharing the experience, strength and hope of current members and their friends, the magazines carry the A.A. message to about a quarter million people a month in current and back issues, when using the conservative estimate of each issue being passed on to at least one other person.

Circulation — Average monthly Grapevine print circulation was 102,281 in FY 2009. Average bimonthly circulation of *La Viña* was 9,663. In addition, A.A. Grapevine, Inc. distributed 77,094 books, 10,748 CDs, and 31,339 other items in Spanish and English. This included a new collection of stories by long-timers, *Voices of Long Term Sobriety*; a collection of Grapevine cartoons and jokes, *A Rabbit Walks into a Bar*; a new *La Viña* CD with stories about the Traditions, and English- and Spanish-language CDs of selected stories from *The Home Group*.

Board Structure — A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is overseen by the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, which normally consists of nine directors: two general service trustees; one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; and the executive editor. However, this year, the board operated with eight, because the Class A trustee position remained vacant. The 2010-2011 slate of Grapevine directors includes two new directors: Class A trustee Frances Brisbane, Ph.D., nominated to fill the Class A vacancy, and Southeast regional trustee Eleanor Nault, nominated to fill the position that will become vacant when Southwest regional trustee Conley Byrd rotates off the A.A. Grapevine Board (but not off the General Service Board) after the Conference.

The purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board, an affiliate service corporation of the General Service Board, is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts.

To fulfill its mission, A.A. Grapevine directors have met in person eight times since the last Conference — three times as a Corporate Board for quarterly meetings; four times as a Planning Committee; and once at a joint dinner meeting with the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board. They held several additional meetings via conference call this year. The directors are scheduled to hold a fifth Planning Committee meeting on the Saturday before the Conference, and during Conference week a meeting with the General Service Conference Committee (G.S.C.) on the Grapevine, their spring quarterly board meeting, and their annual members' meeting. It is worth noting that in an effort to conserve the limited resources of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., the board met outside of New York three times for Planning Committee meetings, resulting in considerable savings to the corporation.

Much of the board's work is accomplished in committees. The A.A. Grapevine's Board has only one standing committee: the nominating committee, which facilitates the selection of candidates for the board and oversees the By-Laws of the corporation.

This year, it was chaired by Conley Byrd. Five other committees were appointed on an ad hoc basis by the chair in 2009-2010, to focus on specific areas. The finance and budget committee, chaired by Ken Brueggemann, developed the 2010 budgets for A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and *La Viña*. The Committee on the History of Advisory Actions, also chaired by Ken, drafted a report on the history of Grapevine Conference Advisory Actions and on the corporation's decision-making process, at the request of the 59th General Service Conference Committee on the Grapevine. The Committee on *The A.A. Service Manual*, chaired by Ginger Rhoades Bell, suggested revisions to the chapters on A.A. Grapevine in *The A.A. Service Manual* and the rationale for each revision, as requested by the 59th Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The Committee on the 2010 International Convention, chaired by Nancy Haynes, discussed A.A. Grapevine's presence at the Convention and suggested, among other ideas, holding a workshop on the Digital Archive. They also discussed reporting on the Convention in the magazines and on the Web to raise awareness of the event. The Committee on the A.A.G.V. Directors' Handbook, chaired by Albin Zezula, reviewed the A.A.G.V. Directors' Handbook and made several suggestions for improvement.

In addition to the work it did in committees, the A.A. Grapevine Board focused on the following areas this year: activities to enhance the communication with the Conference Committee on Grapevine (two teleconferences were held); board development, beginning with a full board orientation that included a focus on using the principles of A.A. (Traditions and Concepts) in our work on the board, and a presentation of the legal responsibilities of directors in a not-for-profit organization, conducted by the General Service Board's corporate attorney; an update of the SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats) analysis of the corporation; and strategic planning activities. A two-day Planning Meeting was held in December, where the board devoted a full day to focus on the short- and long-term financial health of the corporation. In December, the external directors of the board made the decision to obtain the services of a professional organization development consultant to assess the overall effectiveness of the corporation, and of the corporation's strategic business plan. Moreover, the board assessed its own effectiveness by conducting an inventory of itself, at its March Planning meeting, using past Southwest regional trustee Ann Bruning, as facilitator.

Editorial Advisory Boards — Grapevine Board and staff are supported by two editorial advisory boards, groups of A.A. members with professional experience in publishing, public relations, or related fields. This year the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board met six times to assess the Grapevine's redesign and to discuss new publications and the Web site. Re-established in May 2008, *La Viña's* Editorial Advisory Board met four times to discuss how to encourage more A.A.s to write for the magazine, offer feedback on the magazine, and deliberate on the search for a new editor. Members of *La Viña's* Editorial Advisory Board gave presentations on the magazine at three Regional Forums, several state conventions, the local Hispanic Forum, and the National Hispanic Convention.

Grapevine Financial Report — The Grapevine realized a loss of \$132,594, versus a budgeted net loss of \$167,360 for FY 2009. This was ahead of budget by \$34,766. Total A.A. Grapevine income, including cash flow interest and interest from the Reserve Fund, was \$1,830,511, which was \$58,585 ahead of budget and \$23,894 more than last year. Circulation was 102,281. This was 2,281 more than budgeted but 2,712 less than last year. Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,247,171 was approximately \$175,000 greater than budgeted and \$2,000 less than the previous year. Gross profit on other publishing items of \$537,440 was \$95,530 less than budgeted. It was, however, \$46,240 greater than 2008. Total editorial, business, and administrative costs and ex-



Exhibit of Grapevine literature on display at the 2010 Conference, Hilton Rye Town.

penses were \$1,963,105. This was \$23,819 over budget and \$18,032 more than last year.

La Viña Financial Report — La Viña is published by A.A. Grapevine at the request of the General Service Conference and funded by the General Service Board. Bimonthly circulation of La Viña averaged 9,663 for FY 2009, this is 337 below budget, versus 10,404 in 2008. Gross profit on the magazine was \$29,491. This was \$8,576 better than budgeted and \$6,880 more than the same period in 2008. Gross profit on related items was \$20,915, which was \$8,114 behind budget. Net loss for the year was \$54,472. This was \$41,304 better than budgeted and \$21,792 better than last year. Costs and expenses for the year were \$104,878. This was \$40,842 less than budgeted.

A.A. Grapevine and the Reserve Fund — A.A. Grapevine makes deposits to the Reserve Fund. A.A. Grapevine also invests in the Reserve Fund to fund the subscription liability. As of December 31, 2009, the amount of A.A. Grapevine dollars held in the Reserve Fund for Grapevine subscriptions totaled \$1,716,400. The A.A. Grapevine is not permitted to accumulate funds or borrow money to fund strategic projects and update technology. Therefore, A.A. Grapevine has turned to the Reserve Fund to fund special projects or when additional operating capital was needed. When the total amount of dollars withdrawn from the Reserve Fund for normal operating activities is added up and the deposits A.A. Grapevine has made to the Reserve Fund (1990 to February 2010), not including funding the subscription liability, are subtracted, the net withdrawal made by A.A. Grapevine to date is \$475,107.

The A.A. Grapevine has, since its inception, been committed to making the magazine available to as many people as possible. Consequently, subscription prices have been kept low and price increases have lagged behind increased costs. In the last five years, those costs have increased dramatically, especially those for

postage and pension funding. Therefore, last year A.A. Grapevine's subscription price was increased to \$27 and La Viña's to \$12 to catch up with these escalating expenses. Assuming circulation stays on budget, the price increase is expected to help A.A. Grapevine, Inc., break even in 2011. Until then, A.A. Grapevine will have to draw money from the Reserve Fund to help cover operating expenses and catch up with updating technology in 2010. Reserve Fund withdrawals since the last Conference include \$50,000 November 2009 and \$138,000 in February 2010. Additional funds may be needed to cover the 2010 budgeted deficit, which was approved by the General Service Board at its February 1, 2010 meeting.

Why is A.A. Grapevine in deficit? A.A. Grapevine is charged with trying to support its operation solely through the sale of subscriptions, books, and other items. Grapevine does not carry advertising or receive funding from groups or individual members. Nor does it promote or sell

the magazine and other publications in stores, other magazines, non-A.A. outlets, or even in A.A. groups, except through the service work of Grapevine and/or La Viña representatives. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. must depend primarily on the service structure and subscribers to spread the word about the magazine and to "sell" subscriptions and other A.A.G.V. products. All of this makes it very difficult for the corporation to be self-supporting. It should be noted, however, that over its 66 year history, A.A.G.V. has exceeded its operating costs by \$350,000, and broken even 37 of the 66 years.

Insufficient price increases have been one factor contributing to the deficit. Another has been declining circulation of the print magazine, which has gone from 120,000 to an average of 102,000 (FY '09) over the last 15 years. It is interesting to note that Grapevine circulation as a percentage of A.A. membership has dropped less than three percent in the last fifteen years (2.6%) ranging from a high of 10.22% in 1996 to 7.62% in 2009, comparable to the drop in the percentage of groups contributing to G.S.O. in the same period (3.14%). La Viña circulation has also dropped as a percentage of membership subscribing to the Spanish-language magazine since its inception, ranging from a high of .84% in 2007 to .72% in 2009. If, however, the statistics on Hispanic members of the Fellowship are used to calculate penetration, the overall percentage of members subscribing to La Viña is greater than the percentage subscribing to Grapevine: 17.4% in 2007 and 15% in 2009. When discussing these statistics it is important to keep in mind the caveat that there is no reliable way of identifying the number of English-speaking subscribers to La Viña, and that therefore the percentage of Hispanic members should be considered an estimate. Even with the recent decline in circulation, the percentage of subscribers to La Viña has grown by 16.5% since its inception.

Nonetheless, the Grapevine staff and board have been taking a hard look at declining circulation overall, particularly since the decline has continued in 2010 (95,752 for GV as of February 2010 and 8,883 for Jan./Feb. La Viña). Some of the factors that may be contributing to the decline are:

- The information and technology revolution. (During the last 15 years, readers have been getting information from the Internet at an exponentially increasing rate. That movement took off with the advent of the iPod, and escalated even faster last year with instant access to information via digital readers and mobile phones.)
- Competition for readers' leisure time (65 % of former subscribers surveyed gave this as #1 reason for not renewing subscriptions).
- Natural attrition of an aging readership (73 % of GV subscribers are over age 50).
- Free or low-cost issues available at meetings (27 % of respondents to a survey of former subscribers said they now pick up issues at meetings; 58 % of those get them for free; 70 % say they give their issue away after reading it).
- Availability of information about alcoholism and A.A. from other sources (39 % of former subscriber respondents gave this as the reason for discontinuing their subscription).
- Limited access to alcoholics who don't subscribe, and for five years, no sustained circulation program to build and maintain circulation.

Steps A.A. Grapevine has taken:

- Made the magazines more attractive to newcomers and younger A.A.s by updating the designs and including more art and articles from younger readers.
- Hired a new circulation director to maintain communication with the alcoholics we can reach and Grapevine and La Viña reps, and to oversee fulfillment and customer service, and gather information about readers' needs.
- Hired a new La Viña editor and bilingual production assistant to improve the magazine and communication with readers.
- Requested funding from the Reserve Fund to update the Grapevine's software and design and to make aagrapevine.org more useful and cost effective. Also requested funding to make online ordering easier. [Note: Funding was approved by the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee and the General Service Board at the Winter Quarterly Board Weekend.]
- Drafted a strategic business plan that, while we continue to publish our meeting in print, would help us make Grapevine and La Viña stories available in the digital media that an increasing number of alcoholics are using. The plan also looks ahead to a time when Grapevine will be able to keep up with the changing needs of readers and support more of Grapevine's operations from subscriptions to Grapevine and La Viña stories in other media.
- Obtained the services of a professional publishing consultant to assess the feasibility of our 2010-2013 strategic business plan and to make recommendations to assist the A.A.G.V. in maximizing the probability of success in relation to planned and proposed initiatives for the corporation.

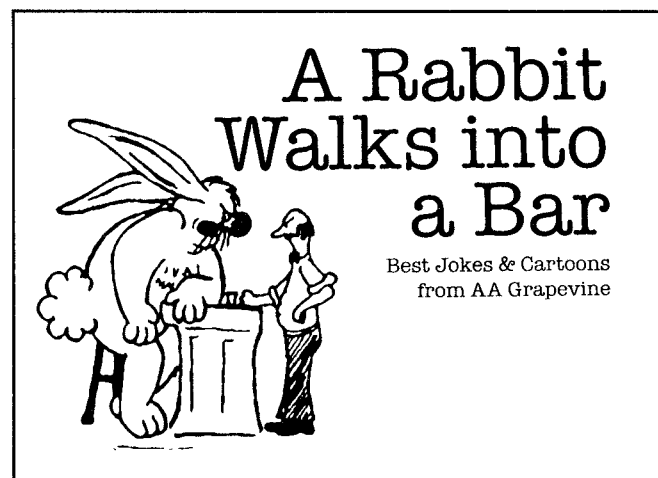
Ultimately, though, the future of A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is in the hands of the Fellowship. When convincing Dr. Bob of the need for the General Service Conference, Bill W. said, "...Do we not have the clear duty to see that the foundation, Grapevine, and office are put in good order and delivered into the direct keeping of A.A. as a whole?" ("Pass It On" — *The Story of Bill Wilson and How the A.A. Message Reached the World*, p. 332). This statement clearly identifies the real ownership of the Grapevine. The A.A. Grapevine belongs to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous,

and it is the Fellowship that must decide if the Grapevine will be here for the alcoholic "who still stumbles in the darkness," as Bernard Smith said in explaining why we need a Conference. Bill W. expressed his hope for the A.A. Grapevine in a June 1944 article: "...May its rays of hope and experience ever fall upon the current of our A.A. life and one day illumine every dark corner of this alcoholic world." This statement suggests that what we should strive for today and what should provide fuel for every idea that is proposed for A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is how it can be used to carry the A.A. message better to alcoholics in and outside the rooms of A.A., directly or indirectly.

If the Fellowship wants the Grapevine and La Viña to be there for today's and tomorrow's alcoholic — many of whom don't know that A.A. has a magazine — the service structure and subscribers need to commit to making the magazines an integral part of the program and, if the magazines continue to prove useful, an integral part of their Twelfth Step work. Only the Fellowship can decide that, which leads to the following important questions: Is A.A.G.V. still relevant today? Is there still a need for it? Does it contribute to our carrying the message of A.A.? We need to answer these questions and if the answers are yes, that means that we must seek to identify how we can get a Grapevine and La Viña in every group so that the magazines are there for shaky newcomers, the still-suffering alcoholics, and others. That means making sure we give subscriptions to alcoholics in hospitals and rehabs the way we give magazines to alcoholics in prisons. That also means including the Grapevine and La Viña in our other committee work, such as Public Information and Cooperation With the Professional Community. And it means understanding that in order to ensure and support the future of A.A.G.V., Inc., an investment is required to produce the Grapevine and La Viña not only in formats that the alcoholics of today are using, but in formats that the alcoholics of tomorrow will use as well.

A.A. Grapevine has been here for alcoholics for 66 years now, and it is looking forward to celebrating A.A.'s 75th anniversary with you in San Antonio. Please encourage the members of your area to come by and meet Grapevine and La Viña reps, staff and board at the booths and workshops, and to share their ideas on how we can continue to carry the message better to the alcoholic, directly and indirectly, through the A.A. Grapevine. If they are not going to the Convention, please invite them to celebrate A.A.'s 75th birthday with us by reading Grapevine stories about the Convention online or in print, and by using all the recovery tools of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to carry the message of A.A. into the Fellowship's 76th year.

Dorothy L. Hurley, chair



AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2009

Books and Booklets

Best of Bill (Hard Cover)	2,843
Best of Bill (Soft Cover)	6,813
Best of Bill—Large Print (Soft Cover)	1,112
Best of Bill—French (Soft Cover)	1,549
The Home Group—French (Soft Cover)	499
Le Langage du Coeur	614
Best Of The Grapevine I (Soft Cover)	1,103
Best Of The Grapevine II (Soft Cover)	639
The Language of the Heart (Hard Cover)	4,755
El Lenguaje del Corazón	2,159
Best of the Grapevine III (Soft Cover)	876
A.A. Around the World	796
The Language of the Heart (Soft Cover)	2,873
Thank You For Sharing	985
Spiritual Awakening	6,209
The Home Group Revised (Soft Cover)	2,264
I Am Responsible: The Hand of AA (Soft Cover)	1,859
Emotional Sobriety (Soft Cover)	8,460
The Language of the Heart (Large Print)	574
In Our Own Words	3,422
Beginner's Book	10,951
Voices of Long-Term Sobriety	6,917
A Rabbit Walks Into a Bar	3,871
Best Of Bill—Spanish	2,867
Lo Mejor de la Viña	1,284
El Grupo Base	1,860

Total: 77,094

Cassette Tapes

Total: 302

CDs - English

Pathways to Spirituality CD	598
Classic Grapevine CD, Vol 1	185
Classic Grapevine CD, Vol 2	124
Classic Grapevine CD, Vol 3	119
Not for Newcomers Only CD	327
Partners on the Journey CD	302
Story of AA	407
What It Was Like	288
The Twelve Traditions	263
It Works if We Work It	382
Best Of Bill CD	504
A Lifetime of AA	254
Attitude Adjustment	617
Powers of Example	336
Emotional Sobriety CD Vol. I	721
Emotional Sobriety CD Vol. II	525
Spiritual Awakenings CD Vol. I	507
Spiritual Awakenings CD Vol. II	421

Sub-Total: 6,880

CDs - Spanish

Historia de La Viña CD	350
Historia de La Viña II CD	433
Historia de La Viña III CD	350
Lo Mejor de Bill	733
La Historia de AA	671
Despaertares Espirituales Vol. I	552
Despaertares Espirituales Vol. II	514
Las Doce Tradiciones Vol. I	134
Las Doce Tradiciones Vol. II	131
Spanish CD's Sub Total:	3,868

Total: 10,748

Miscellaneous

Facsimile of First Grapevine	466
Slogans—French	139
Victor E. Poster—French	2
AA Preamble	1,079
Grapevine Binder	374
Man on the Bed	1,220
Slogans	1,127
Serenity Prayer	2,514
Victor E. Poster—English	98
Wall Calendar	6,324
Pocket Planner	8,968
Grapevine Workbook	4
Co-Founder's Memorial Issue	1,061
Co-Founder's Memoria Issue—French	5,047
Traditions Checklist	653
Victor E. Poster—Spanish	92
Spanish—Preamble	175
Spanish—Slogans	234
Spanish—Serenity Prayer	600
Spanish—Tradition Checklist	1,162

Total: 31,339

Grand Total: 119,483

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2010	APRIL 2009	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	732	813	(81)
Alaska	492	497	(5)
Arizona	1,668	1,726	(58)
Arkansas	515	568	(53)
California	8,516	8,930	(414)
Colorado	1,707	1,808	(101)
Connecticut	1,378	1,448	(70)
Delaware	397	392	5
District of Columbia	166	171	(5)
Florida	4,795	4,949	(154)
Georgia	2,278	2,377	(99)
Hawaii	479	520	(41)
Idaho	656	676	(20)
Illinois	3,158	3,348	(190)
Indiana	1,313	1,417	(104)
Iowa	937	1,006	(69)
Kansas	967	1,080	(113)
Kentucky	762	865	(103)
Louisiana	726	763	(37)
Maine	507	590	(83)
Maryland	1,160	1,314	(154)
Massachusetts	2,290	2,494	(204)
Michigan	2,855	3,088	(233)
Minnesota	2,301	2,410	(109)
Mississippi	435	456	(21)
Missouri	1,398	1,510	(112)
Montana	600	632	(32)
Nebraska	779	836	(57)
Nevada	575	644	(69)
New Hampshire	628	738	(110)
New Jersey	2,528	2,810	(282)
New Mexico	652	683	(31)
New York	4,959	5,501	(542)
North Carolina	2,117	2,273	(156)
North Dakota	310	348	(38)
Ohio	2,382	2,577	(195)
Oklahoma	788	819	(31)
Oregon	1,417	1,413	4
Pennsylvania	4,730	4,941	(211)
Rhode Island	346	380	(34)
South Carolina	870	917	(47)
South Dakota	350	383	(33)
Tennessee	1,101	1,210	(109)
Texas	3,638	3,958	(320)
Utah	545	571	(26)
Vermont	346	356	(10)
Virginia	2,001	2,228	(227)
Washington	2,830	3,065	(235)
West Virginia	338	483	(145)
Wisconsin	2,326	2,471	(145)
Wyoming	266	306	(40)
Puerto Rico	27	31	(4)
U.S. Possessions/APO	82	100	(18)
Virgin Islands	43	42	1
Subtotal US	80,162	85,932	(5,770)
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	868	880	(12)
British Columbia/Ykn	1,043	1,102	(59)
Manitoba	425	429	(4)
New Brunswick/PEI	258	346	(88)
Nova Scotia/ New Foundland/Labrador	400	400	-
Ontario	3,155	3,358	(203)
Quebec	284	250	34
Saskatchewan	390	384	6
Subtotal Canada	6,823	7,149	(326)
FOREIGN	1,107	1,248	(141)
Grand Total	88,092	94,329	(6,237)

LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*

	Mar./Apr. 10	Mar./Apr. 09	Diff.
	6,623	7,037	(414)

(*does not include monthly orders)

■ Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: During the last year the committee approved a minor revision to the Photocopying Policy to clarify and acknowledge the authority of A.A. World Services, Inc. The Archives committee continues to encourage the work of local A.A. archivists in the areas, districts, and central/intergroup offices in preserving A.A. history in their regions and provides professional guidance and sharing of experience. The committee received a report from the Archivist that included a graphic chart reflecting research responses for the last decade, an update on plans for the 2010 International Convention, ongoing preservation efforts and future Web site development ideas. In response to a request of the 2009 Conference Archives Committee, the Archivist prepared a report on the feasibility of developing a self-guided online tour of G.S.O.'s Archives, which the committee has forwarded to the 2010 Conference Archives Committee.

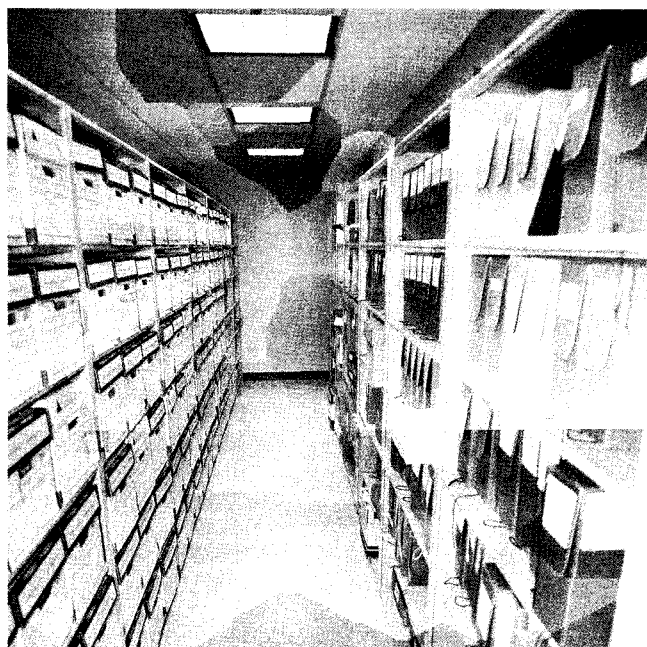
During the year Michelle Mirza, who had been serving as interim Archivist, was named the G.S.O. Archivist. She is only the fifth person in the history of the G.S.O. Archives to hold that position. The committee thanks her for her outstanding work during the year. The Fellowship is truly blessed to have someone with Michelle's professionalism, dedication, and industry in managing, maintaining and preserving our wonderful archival collection.

George Martin, chairperson

Staff report: The year 2010 marks the 35th anniversary of the G.S.O. Archives. Since our auspicious opening, we have continued in our unrelenting pursuit of preserving A.A.'s history. Just as the anthology, *Experience, Strength and Hope* is a collection of personal recovery stories, the Archives is a collection of thousands of personal letters portraying a crosssection of recovery experience as well as letters that contain invaluable information about the growth of the Fellowship and the development of our service structure. According to Nell Wing, G.S.O.'s first archivist, "We owe it to future A.A. members, as well as to historians, scholars and researchers, to maintain as complete a record as we can of this society at all times, so its message, meaning, and contributions, not only to alcoholics but in other problem areas, can be recalled and assessed for whatever future purpose, fully and accurately."

We continue to digitize thousands of group records, initially scanned on microfiche cards, that are now deteriorating. Since the project's inception about two years ago, we have scanned close to two thousand of these cards.

In 2009 we responded to over 1,200 requests for information, amounting to over 1,700 hours in research time. We welcomed many new area archivists and extended assistance and support



In 2009 G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives underwent extensive renovation to the vault area, doubling the storage space to accommodate A.A.'s expanding archival collection.

whenever possible. Our rotating exhibits are intended to stimulate interest and inform and enlighten visitors about our treasured past. We highlighted A.A.'s Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, from manuscript through all editions and formats in honor of the book's 75th Anniversary, observed April 2009. For those members unable to visit our office, we designed a digital archives exhibit that depicts our astounding mosaic of memoirs. We invite everyone to find out more about defining moments in our history through the decades with our photo galleries, available on the Archives section of the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.

We were very excited about the recent renovation project. The Archives vault was reconstructed to accommodate our growing collection and the renovation doubled the Archives storage space and added a new workroom to process collections.

The Archives staff extends gratitude to those who have graciously donated material to the Archives within the past twelve months. We received many wonderfully rich collections, including a unique 1948 recording of Dr. Bob and Bill W.; a collection of early materials from the New York Rye Group; oldtimers interviews; and more.

Michelle Mirza, archivist

AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: This committee is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in exec-



utive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

Madeleine Parmley, chairperson

COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: This committee consists of at least four trustees. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The Compensation Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

George Martin, chairperson

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the 2009 Conference, including the theme chosen for the 60th General Service Conference, "Practicing A.A.'s Principles—The Pathway to Unity." We also discussed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires and a Post-Conference Sharing Session.

The committee developed and approved the schedule for the updated 2010 Conference week and agreed to implement the following changes:

- a. The 60th General Service Conference will start earlier on Sunday, April 18, 2010. Registration and the Opening Session will begin before lunch.
- b. The trip to G.S.O./Grapevine Offices is now scheduled for every other year, alternating with the visit to Stepping Stones. In 2010 Conference members will visit Stepping Stones and in 2011 visit the G.S.O./Grapevine offices.

Workshop questions for the 60th Conference were approved for distribution in the Communications Kit. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Conference committee agendas and background material continue to be made available for all Conference members on an Online Dashboard (in addition to the formats currently available) on an experimental basis for an additional two years beginning with the 2010 General Service Conference.

We reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2010. Forty-two items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference Committees, or to the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards. This total does not include any items that may have been submitted directly to committee secretaries or to the two corporate boards.

The General Service Board in response to a recommendation from the 2009 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee to develop a plan for the General Service Conference to conduct an inventory of itself, asked the trustees' Committee on the Conference to explore this idea further. A subcommittee was appointed to develop a plan and their report was accepted and sent to the General Service Board. The General Service Board forwarded the report to the 2010 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

The following proposed agenda items, that could be addressed when the General Service Conference conducts an inventory of itself, were tabled until the July 31, 2010 Summer quarterly meeting:

- Request "to extend the length of the General Service Conference schedule to adequately accommodate all agenda items."
- Discuss suggestion to prioritize Conference agenda items.
- Request to "Establish guidelines for the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee to communicate and interface for approval of any/all proposed General Service Conference agenda items."
- Discuss request that each Conference committee have an agenda item specifically designated for review of past Advisory Actions for compliance, outdated actions, and/or items not in practice.

The committee approved the request from the General Service Office of Venezuela for two representatives from their A.A. General Service Structure to attend the 2010 General Service Conference as observers and forwarded the request to the 2010 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

We reviewed and took no action on a proposal regarding "Education on Singleness of Purpose." The committee agreed that A.A. does not provide educational services and that there is ample information in current A.A. literature, and suggested that the submitter contact local trusted servants who may be willing to share information with the Fellowship and/or about A.A.'s Singleness of Purpose.

The committee reviewed the subcommittee report "Review of Processing of General Service Conference Floor Actions" that included a recommendation not approved by the General Service Board at the November 2, 2008 meeting, which was referred back to the committee.

The committee discussed a revision to the current version in the section "Floor Actions" in the document "How the General Service Conference Operates/Summary of Conference Procedures" and agreed that by placing the discretion to consider a Floor Action or to decline a Floor Action directly with the Conference body, the following recommendation would address the perceived problem. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the following statement in the section on the procedure for Floor Actions in the document "How the Conference Operates," which reads:

All Floor Actions will be heard unless there is a motion that the Conference decline to consider a Floor Action. A motion to decline to hear a Floor Action:

- *Must be made without comment.*
- *Is not debatable.*
- *Requires a two-thirds majority.*

be replaced with the following statement:

When a Floor Action is to be heard, its maker will be given two (2) minutes to state the rationale behind the action, after which the chair shall ask if there is a motion that the Conference decline to consider the Floor Action. A motion to decline to hear a Floor Action:

- *Must be made without comment.*
- *Is not debatable.*
- *Requires a two-thirds majority.*

The committee reviewed the section of the report on "Recommit to Committee" and took no action on the recommendation that the parliamentary procedure "to commit or refer to committee" and to "recommit to committee" not be used at future Conferences nor incorporated in the procedures of "How the General Service Conference Operates/Summary of Conference Procedures."

The committee reaffirmed the 1986 Conference Advisory Action: "When matters of great significance having a long-term effect

on the Fellowship or of substantial expense are presented to the floor in the waning hours of the Conference, such matters be referred to the appropriate committee at the next Conference in order for the group conscience to be as informed as possible."

We also noted that there have been instances where following floor discussion, the Conference has requested a trustees' committee to further review and provide additional background on an agenda item for the following Conference to consider.

Madeleine Parmley, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the summer edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Adrienne Brown

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

Trustees' report:

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

The committee worked with the Publications Department, in response to an Additional Committee Consideration from the 2009 Conference Committee on C.P.C., to complete production of consistent voice-over text regarding anonymity and singleness of purpose in the three C.P.C. video segments. A single compilation DVD containing the three segments was produced and is now available for purchase. The committee agreed to include the DVD in the contents of the C.P.C. Kit.

We reviewed a request from the 2009 Conference Committee on C.P.C. to develop, for inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook, a brief sample survey-style follow up letter and, after discussion, created a contact assessment follow up postcard for inclusion in the C.P.C.

Workbook. The committee also discussed and implemented a request from the 2009 Conference Committee that references to the A.A. Grapevine in the C.P.C. Workbook would be updated to include La Viña and La Vigne where appropriate. We discussed an additional consideration from the 2009 Conference Committee to add specific wording to the Workbook about possible uses of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in C.P.C. endeavors. The committee developed revised wording describing the application of these resources for the Workbook at its next printing.

In response to a request from the 2008 Conference Committee on C.P.C. to discuss further possible projects directed toward legal/criminal justice system professionals, the committee completed development of and approved the final version of a new informational service piece "A.A. as a Resource for Drug & Alcohol Court Professionals" and agreed that it be included in the C.P.C. Kit. The committee asked the secretary to send the completed service piece in the next Activity Update to all C.P.C. chairs for use in their service with drug/alcohol court professionals.

The committee reviewed and discussed the Fellowship sharing on the use of full faces in video projects produced by A.A. World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) in preparation for a possible agenda item for the 2010 General Service Conference and agreed to forward this item to the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

As a result of G.S.O. staff concerns over the past few years about the validity of the data on the Exhibit Evaluation Forms that play a large role in determining which events to attend, the committee reviewed the process of evaluating C.P.C. exhibits coordinated by G.S.O. and has implemented a revised Exhibit Evaluation Form. Offers to exhibit at national professional conferences are also considered based on expanding the range of professions who may be interested in A.A. as a resource and on new geographical locations. The committee reviewed the 2009 Exhibit evaluations and the 2010 Exhibit schedule.

Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities — When the scope of the committee was expanded, the committee accepted responsibility for the 2009 Conference Advisory Action which requested development of a recovery pamphlet for newcomers or prospective members with special needs, to include stories solicited from A.A. members with a wide variety of challenges, such as autism, brain damage, learning disabilities, blindness, deafness or hearing impairment, confinement to wheelchairs, etc. Stories were solicited through letters to Special Needs Committees, delegates, and an article in *Box 4-5-9*. The Publications department prepared an outline of the proposed pamphlet for consideration by the trustees' committee, and by March 2010 a subcommittee began looking at a total of 39 anonymity protected stories that had been submitted.

The committee considered a suggestion "to consider developing a poster depicting alcoholics with special needs to help inform those in and out of the Fellowship that Alcoholics Anonymous does provide Twelve Step services for individuals with special needs" and took no action. The committee determined that there was no feasible way at this time to implement the suggestion without further direction about content and concept.

We reviewed the production status of the revised video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*, and noted that a single DVD would be produced containing all three languages (English, Spanish and French), including both dubbing and subtitles as options. A copy of the DVD was sent to all Treatment Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap area chairs with a request that their committees view the DVD as a tool for carrying the message into treatment centers and settings of all kinds. A copy of the DVD was also included in the Treatment Facilities Kit as requested by the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

The committee reviewed ways to carry the A.A. message into out-patient treatment settings, and also approved a suggestion requested by the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for changing terminology in the Workbook to reflect carrying the message into out-patient treatment settings as well as in-patient treatment facilities.

The committee agreed to forward to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs/Accessibilities a suggestion to consider two locally created forms for treatment facilities temporary contact service, one for residents coming out of treatment facilities and one for A.A. members willing to serve as temporary contacts, for consideration as potential suggested service material and/or inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

Conley Byrd, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet relatively few know what A.A. is or what we do, and even fewer have been to an "open" A.A. meeting. The staff member on the Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) assignment, along with an assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2009, 595 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. is the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* One issue of *About A.A.* was published in 2009. The Winter issue featured an in depth article that explored spirituality in A.A. Currently, more than 10,000 professionals receive *About A.A.* About one quarter of the list receives the newsletter via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system.

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 39 national or international conferences of professionals in 2009. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space, display and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. In addition, 25 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees. G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future Box 4-5-9 articles, which have created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are

helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Mary Swart Cummings

Treatment Facilities/Special Needs/Accessibilities — Within the past year, the task of communicating with Special Needs/Accessibilities service committees within the A.A. Fellowship has been given a permanent home on the Treatment Facilities assignment. The assignment currently communicates with: area and district Treatment Facilities (TF) committee chairpersons, area and district Bridging the Gap (BTG) committee chairpersons, area and district Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons and, since July 2009, area and district Special Needs/Accessibilities committee chairpersons. The total list comprises about 650 T.F., and 200 Special Needs committee chairs

A welcome letter is sent along with some service materials that might be helpful as the committee chair starts out in the new position. While physical materials are still sent through the post, the new trusted servants are also directed to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site (www.aa.org) where A.A. Guidelines, service committee Workbooks, and other service materials may be read and/or printed directly from the service committee "buckets."

Correspondence from newly sober clients in treatment centers, and from professionals in those facilities, is always welcome. In addition, communication is received from alcoholics with special challenges (blindness, deafness, brain injury, etc.) asking for A.A. literature in a format that they can understand. Each of these receives a response from the staff member, with as many links as possible to an A.A. member or committee in the Fellowship who can serve as an additional resource.

The staff member on this assignment serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs/Accessibilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

CHARLES B. TOWNS HOSPITAL
333 Central Park West
New York 21, N. Y.

NAME: W. S. Wilson
ADDRESS: 182 Clinton St. B'klyn N.Y.
NEAREST RELATIVE: [blank]
REFERRED BY: [blank]
ACCOMPANIED BY: [blank]
DIAGNOSIS: [blank]
ADMITTED: DATE 12-18-34, HOUR 11:34 P.M.
DEPOSIT: PRE 12.50
RELATES: [blank]
RECEIVED: [blank]
CONDITION: [blank]
DATE PAID: 12-18-34
HOW PAID: [blank]
DATE PAID: 12-18-34
BY WHOM: [blank]
TO WHOM: [blank]

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Volume 21
AGE 38

Bill for \$125 for Bill W.'s last detox at Towns Hospital,
December 18, 1934. Bill's A.A. Anniversary
was December 11, 1934.

In addition, the staff member on this assignment coordinates the Loners/Internationalists and Homers Correspondence Service — a vital means of sharing for A.A. members who are not able to attend A.A. meetings, either because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance, or because they are not able to leave their place of residence to attend a meeting. The total number of *LIM* participants is around 500. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity; Internationalists, A.A. members working on seagoing vessels for long periods of time. The assignment also coordinates a *confidential* bimonthly bulletin (*LIM*) sent to Loners, Homers, Internationalists, and to Loner Sponsors and Port Contacts. The bulletin contains excerpts from *LIM* members' letters, and includes full names and addresses.

A small but significant outgrowth of the *LIM* is "Sober Soldiers." Military and nonmilitary personnel going to Iraq or Afghanistan may participate in *LIM*, but this office also provides them with a way to make confidential contact with each other and to learn about A.A. meetings on bases or in camps.

This assignment also provides a central point for shared experience about Remote Communities in A.A., serves as the G.S.O. liaison to A.A. members involved in this service, and works with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting. Remote Communities resource materials housed at G.S.O. include pieces of A.A. literature (Serenity Prayer, Steps, and Traditions) that have been translated locally in a variety of Native North American/Aboriginal languages.

Gayle Solheim Riese

CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings.

In response to an Additional Committee Consideration from the 2009 Conference Committee, we reviewed costs associated with adding the book *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* to the Corrections Kit, and requested that this addition be implemented as soon as possible.

We also discussed the Advisory Action from the 2009 Conference Committee "that the trustees' Committee on Corrections undertake a revision of the pamphlet 'It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell,' which will take into consideration: more stories drawn from 'Sharing From Behind the Walls,' Box 4-5-9, or other available sources; less use of 'directive' language (such as that used in the section on H.A.L.T.); including photographs that reflect current times, and that a draft pamphlet or a progress report be brought back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections." A subcommittee was formed that took the following steps: a thorough inventory of the current content of the pamphlet was conducted; the Publications Department was consulted on matters regarding the "revising" of existing stories; a "call for submissions" was put out by the staff member via several channels (Box 4-5-9, Grapevine and a Corrections desk activity report); and an inventory of existing stories from other A.A. sources (past issues of Grapevine, earlier edition of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*) was begun.

The committee discussed the 2009 Additional Committee Consideration that sharing from the A.A. Fellowship regarding the signing of "sponsorship agreements" or legally binding documents be gathered by the staff member and the trustees' Committee on Corrections and be sent to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections. A subcommittee was formed that took the following steps: a "call for sharing" was issued by the staff member; a thorough inventory of all existing service material related to corrections was conducted to determine if guidelines/suggestions already

existed; additional language for the Corrections Workbook and Guidelines on Corrections was drafted, and recommendations for including additional language in several Conference-approved pamphlets were prepared.

In discussing the 2010 budget for our committee, we agreed to continue the purchase of the *American Correctional Association Directory of Adult and Juvenile Correctional Departments, Institutions, Agencies* on a biennial basis; the contact information therein will be sent to Corrections committee chairs when requested, as a fiscally prudent alternative to the previous automatic biennial mailing. The staff member will notify Corrections committee chairs annually of this resource.

The committee agreed that an appointed committee member (ACM) with appropriate background and experience would benefit the committee's current project of revising the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The subsequent search yielded an extremely qualified pool of candidates, and resulted in the selection of Diane Marie Olsen, from Cupertino, California. Diane began serving on this committee at the January 2010 Board weekend.

In our January meeting, we agreed to forward six items to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections: (1) a progress report on revision of the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell"; (2) a progress report on the signing of "sponsorship agreements" and legally binding documents; (3) changes to the Corrections Workbook and the Guidelines on Corrections Committees as background for the yearly review of the Corrections Kit and Workbook; (4) a request to consider adding two sentences to the pamphlet "Carrying the Message into Correctional Facilities" regarding prior review of regulations and paperwork related to Twelve Step corrections work; (5) a request to consider adding a phrase to the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" regarding the signing of volunteer agreements; and (6) a request to consider adding two sentences to the pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" regarding communication between A.A. members and prison administrators about the specific regulations of individual facilities.

Kenneth Brueggemann, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Around 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a prerelease contact.

When inmates request free literature, they can be sent a Big Book and a selection of pamphlets, and often the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, with an explanation that the enclosed literature is made possible through the voluntary contributions of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada. Any additional literature needs are usually referred to those A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service. This assignment tries to avoid being viewed as the primary source of A.A. literature, since "carrying the A.A. message" in this way is an A.A. service opportunity. This practice is also in keeping with past recommendations of Conference and trustees' Committees on Corrections.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.), coordinated by this assignment, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many alcoholics who are incarcerated are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. To fill their requests, this assignment puts out regular pleas to the Fellowship through various channels for new correspondence volunteers — especially males. In 2009 we added 898 more male alcoholics in prison to

the C.C.S., and 373 female alcoholics. In order to meet those requests, we needed to be able to match the inmates with 1,271 outside A.A. members. Even while many of those volunteers offered to write to more than one alcoholic behind the walls the number is still large.

One of the most gratifying aspects of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap Committees. Two or three times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs with updated information about new tools or shared experience on how to use those tools. G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site has a special section where several pieces of Corrections service material can be found, including current and past issues of *Sharing From Behind the Walls* (SFBTW), which contains excerpts of sharing from A.A. members in prison who wrote to G.S.O.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the alcoholic in prison identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions sometimes require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities, are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Jim Malone

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2009 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$901,000, which after Conference actions resulting in mid-year budget adjustments, was reduced by \$67,000 to \$835,100. For the year 2009, however, G.S.O. turned in positive results from operations of \$1,273,600.

While expenses for the year were approximately \$140,000 (1 %) under budget, total revenue was approximately \$298,800 greater than budgeted. The most noteworthy deviation from budget and a change in trend was that total contributions for the year finished \$203,890 less than budget. This is the second year in a row that contributions have declined, so it appears that the economy is hitting the Fellowship. At the end of 2009, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 9.5 months of operating expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions from members. As noted above, contributions declined for the second year in a row. The last four months of 2009 turned in positive results, however, only the future will tell as to 2010. Contributions of \$6,162,994, received from groups and members were approximately \$198,000, or 3 % less than budgeted, and \$218,600 (3 %) less than in 2008. The \$6,163,000 in contributions came from 27,295 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents approximately 44.3 % of the 61,613 groups listed with G.S.O., just about even with the 44.1 % reported last year. Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,296,110, reflected in our 2009 financial statements, include approximately \$133,715 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2008, \$137,600; 2007, \$144,400; 2006,

\$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000. While total contribution dollars were lower this year, the number of groups listed at G.S.O. was 61,613, slightly greater (1,520 more groups) and the number of groups contributing increased slightly as well (776). It is important to remember, however, that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$13,475,716, which was \$112,000 (.008 %) less than budgeted, but approximately \$1,000,000 higher than 2008. During 2009, approximately 1,220,000 Big Books were sold compared with 1,110,000 in 2008. We must remember that a significant number of books was purchased prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase. Printing and manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were less than budgeted by approximately \$588,000. This is partly a result of better than anticipated manufacturing costs and reductions in fuel surcharges pass along by the trucking industry. In the previous year significant costs were incurred for such fuel charges. In addition, our print purchasing team was able to take advantage of printers wanting to keep their employees working, thus they negotiated better deals. The gross profit of \$8,235,374 was \$505,500 greater than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$14,532,669, approximately \$299,000 greater than budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2009 were \$13,259,109, approximately \$139,700 less than budget and \$433,100 less than 2008 as well. One significant part of this decrease is the travel and meetings category. Costs were lower due to the reductions in the cost of travel in general and the fact that the World Service Meeting occurs every other year. When compared with budget, the higher revenues combined with lower expenses resulted in a 2009 positive operating bottom line of \$1,273,560.

Expanding a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2009, \$8,783,762 was spent on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$663,000 less than was spent in 2008. This compares with \$9,447,300 in 2008, \$8,528,100 in 2007, \$8,272,000 in 2006, \$7,443,300 in 2005, and \$7,622,288 in 2004.

The 2009 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services, 32 % (which includes the Group Services assignment; *Box 4-5-9*; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 14.5 %; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 9.8 %; trustees' and directors' activities, 5.8 %; Regional Forums, 5.4 %; Archives, 7.8 %; C.P.C., 5.4 %; Public Information, 5.4 %; Correctional Facilities, 4.3 %; International Convention, 4.1 %; and Treatment Facilities, 2.1 %; Special Needs, 1.4 %, Nominating, 1.5 %; other various, 0.5 %.

Contributions provided 71.7 % and 28.3 % came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 68.1 % and 31.9 % in 2008; 76.5 % and 23.5 % in 2007; 73 % and 27 % in 2006 and 2005; 68 % and 32 % in 2004; 72 % and 28 % in 2003; 71 % and 29 % in 2002; 70 % and 30 % in 2001; and 73 % and 27 % for 2000.)

2010 G.S.O. Budget — Turning to 2010 (after accounting for the large purchases prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase), the G.S.O. budget anticipates approximately level sales when compared with 2009. Even though Contribution revenue has shown positive movement for several years, total Contributions received for 2009 were less than the 2009 budget and 2008 receipts as well. G.S.O. was hit hard during the last quarter of 2008 as was the country at large. During 2009, there were 5 down months and 7 up months

when compared with the same months in 2008. The last 4 months of 2009 showed positive results when compared with 2008 and this gives us hope.

The 2010 G.S.O. budget includes a full year impact of the increases in prices of many of the books and booklets that was effective July 1, 2009, which was anywhere from \$.25 to \$2.00. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower overall gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages and make price increases necessary from time to time.

Recent pricing history: In 2005, after reviewing financial matters, trusted servants recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed by one year the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. Previously, the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), reducing the expected gross profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years.

In keeping with our positive feeling about the Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget anticipates about a 1% increase in contributions. The budget anticipates approximately a 3.8% increase in costs when compared with 2009 actual results, and is just slightly more than the 2008 actual costs. The year 2010 is a World Service Meeting year and the net costs of that meeting not covered by participating countries contributions falls to G.S.O. Based on these preliminary assumptions – approximately even unit sales, a 1% increase in contributions, and an increase in total operating expenses—including the World Service Meeting – the projection for 2010 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$1,043,000. For the 2009 budget, management was charged with producing a budget that would allow the General Service Board's Reserve Fund to maintain approximately a nine-month balance at the end of three years, and the 2010 budget is following that charge. Management continues to assess expenses and operations with an eye toward reduced costs.

The Reserve Fund (and Historical Reference for price adjustments) — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments. As noted previously, G.S.O. management was charged with presenting a 2009 budget with sufficient revenue that, with all things being equal, would maintain the Reserve Fund at a nine-month level of operating expenses after three years. The adjusted balance used for the calculation at December 31, of \$12,136,000 amounts to about \$197 per listed A.A. group. The balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has increased approximately \$200,000 from last year. Dividing total Contributions received (\$6,296,110) by the 61,581 groups listed gives us an average of about \$102, while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$143.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, gross magazine income was approximately \$51,000 greater than the prior year and the average paid circulation of 102,281 for 2009 was approximately 2,700 less than 2008. The average paid circulation of 102,281

compares with 104,993 for 2008, 106,099 for 2007, 103,878 for 2006, 104,356 for 2005, 108,426 for 2004, 112,614 for 2003, 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,247,171 was \$2,000 less than last year, but \$175,000 greater than budgeted. Other publishing income was \$147,200 less than budgeted but \$35,000 greater than 2008. Gross profit on magazine related items was approximately \$96,500 less than budgeted, and it was \$46,200 greater than 2008. Total income, including interest earned, was \$1,830,500, \$24,000 greater than 2008, but \$58,600 greater than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,963,100. Costs and expenses were \$18,000 more than 2008, and \$23,800 higher than budget. Excluding La Viña, the Grapevine reported a loss from operations of \$132,594, which was approximately \$6,000 less than the 2008 loss of \$138,456, and \$34,764 better than the budgeted loss of \$167,358.

The Grapevine's 2010 budget, excluding La Viña, anticipates magazine income of \$2,340,238 (approximately \$212,973 more than the \$2,127,265 realized in 2009), an increase in magazine direct costs of \$52,864, and a gross profit of \$1,407,280 (an increase of \$160,100 from 2009). Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$79,000, while interest income is estimated the same as 2009. A loss for 2010 of \$245,741 is anticipated, compared with the \$132,594 loss for 2009. The 2010 Grapevine budget includes the effect of an increase of prices of other items, January 1, 2009, and the magazine, July 1, 2009.

La Viña — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2009 average circulation of 9,663. This compared with a 2008 average circulation of 10,404, a 2007 average of 10,979, 2006 of 10,223, a 2005 of 9,453, a 2004 of 9,316, a 2003 of 9,222, 2002 of 9,000, 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997. Our hope is that La Viña will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past twelve and one-half years. During 2009, subscription income was \$96,660 and direct costs of publishing were \$67,169, resulting in a \$29,491 gross profit. During 2009, La Viña realized approximately \$20,914 from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$104,877. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on La Viña for the year was \$54,472, compared with a loss of \$76,260 for 2008 and a loss for 2007 of \$67,047.

For 2010, the loss on the La Viña magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$78,964 (approximately \$24,500 greater than 2009), with circulation being projected to decrease slightly to 9,300 copies. The 2010 La Viña budget includes the effect of price increase of the magazine effective July 1, 2009 as well. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the magazine, approximately \$1,265,000 has been invested in La Viña in excess of revenues generated. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

Other items — Working Capital (cash) level: The committee addressed the recommendation from the Grapevine Board requesting that the "Working Cash" level be increased to \$375,000. The "Working Cash" level had not formally been reviewed for many years. The Grapevine Board recommended the new level of

\$375,000 after reviewing appropriate information and consulting with our outside auditor. The trustees' Finance Committee recommended to the General Service Board that a new A.A.W.S. Working Cash level of \$375,000 be adopted.

As noted in prior reports, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2006 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side and consideration of long-term obligations help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. While the economic outlook for 2010 may be uncertain as the economy unfolds, we will continue to monitor events with our goal to insure the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

Terrance Bedient, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 59th General Service Conference, the board has held three General Sharing Sessions. Following is a summary of each session.

August 2009 — "Full Face Videos" — Vic Phillips, Western Canada regional trustee, shared on "Full Face Videos: Does Our Practice Match Our Principles?" He said members have conveyed to him a variety of opinions. Many concur with the new way of showing full faces with actors as A.A. members in our videos; others agree full faces are okay but need strong disclaimers, and a great number are "horrified" and have serious concerns. The thrust of his presentation focused on the importance of unity, so that "When debate on a practice, or proposed practice, turns to questions of (A.A.) principle, action must be delayed until there is a broad and searching discussion. . . ." He noted that we "learn to lead by following" and that the Conference is the venue to seek an informed group conscience on a topic as important as the use of full faces in A.A. videos.

Presenter Dorothy L. Hurley, general service trustee and Grapevine Corporate Board chair, asked three primary questions: "Is our principle of anonymity relevant today?; If so, does using full-face videos compromise or distort our principle of anonymity?; If we believe it does, what steps should we consider taking to remedy the situation?" She noted that it is the collective conscience of the Fellowship that decides if a Tradition is relevant or not. She expressed concern that the boards may have " . . . become lax in seeking wide consultation on sensitive and important matters." Dorothy concluded that "I believe that using a visual image that contradicts a written message creates at the very least confusion, if not distortion, of the principle of anonymity, and I am convinced that anonymity is as relevant today as it has always been."

In the subsequent sharing, there was a strong sense expressed by most that the topic of using full faces of actors pretending to be A.A. members in A.A. videos should get wider Fellowship input and possibly be a topic discussed at the next Conference. It was pointed out several times that there is confusion not only in the public arena on A.A.'s anonymity but even within the Fellowship itself; for instance, hundreds of groups meet on an Internet social networking site where they display the members' full faces. One trustee emphasized that within the Fellowship it was good sponsorship that was going to be the solution to confusion regarding any of the Traditions, and that we should seek better ways to reach

out to the media regarding anonymity. A staff member spoke of the importance of inventory in going over past Actions and that a past group conscience represented the best decision at the time it was made. Another staff member expressed that any material produced by the Conference, boards and G.S.O. should be held to the highest standards when it comes to the Traditions.

October 2009 — "Addressing Spirituality in A.A. — Do Our Practices Match Our Principles?" — Gayle Solheim Riese, G.S.O. staff member, shared that, based on her experience in terms of spirituality in A.A., our practices are sometimes exclusive when compared to our principles. On the one hand, when she came to the A.A. rooms and heard our stories she felt for the first time she had found a place where she belonged — she found hope. On the other hand, when at the end of the meeting everyone held hands and recited the "Lord's Prayer," she felt despair and loneliness because, although the prayer itself was "a perfectly lovely prayer," she associated it with church.

She recounted her challenges in taking the Third Step, struggling to get "it" in terms of an understanding of "God." A March 1989 Grapevine article written by an atheist member suggested that it was important to listen to what people actually do when they take Step Three rather than what they say they believe. This worked for Gayle as a practice. Her first sponsor told her that her beliefs were nobody else's business. As she became more deeply involved in service, she was delighted to find that others felt as she did. Putting her convictions to practice, Gayle made a deliberate decision to step back from the circle at the closing of the meeting, in part to let newcomers and others know that it could be done as a choice.

She has more recently joined in the closing circle because more frequently meetings are closing with the "I Am Responsible" or with the Serenity Prayer that she does not associate with church. Gayle continues to believe that "some prayers belong in churches and not in A.A. meetings." She hopes that all members will strive to match our practices with the spiritual principles of A.A., " . . . to be inclusive in our behavior and our words rather than exclusive."

The next presenter, Ward Ewing, Class A trustee, noted that if our Third Tradition is clear — "'The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking,' — why are people concerned about feeling included or excluded? Everyone who desires to stop drinking should feel included. Right!" He noted that many newcomers balk at any talk " . . . of God, God's will or turning one's will and life over to God as we understand Him." Newcomers may have "loads of guilt that has been reinforced by churches, which are all too ready to judge, advise and condemn."

Religious language can be difficult. It is important to make a distinction between religion and spirituality. He then described the structure of organized religion with its set of a core theology with codified beliefs, its focus on an hierarchical ordained clergy, regulated style of worship with set prayers and frequently clear boundaries of who is "in" and who is "out." He went on to say that "spiritual" as opposed to "religious" is broad and inclusive. The A.A. spiritual life is founded on experience, not doctrine.

Ward seeks to sort through all the stuff of institutionalized religion; one tool he uses is to seek his personal, core experiences. When he does that, he becomes free, free to let go of the need to protect God, free to let go of the need to control, free of the need to judge others. He believes the fundamental spiritual experience of A.A. is the movement away from being self-directed and toward being directed by a power greater than self. And at its most basic understanding, the term "Higher Power" within the A.A. Fellowship means simply that which keeps one sober.

He concluded, "For those of us who are comfortable with traditional language for God, we must remember others are not so comfortable; the language is not all that important. What is im-

portant for those who are members of this Fellowship and for those who walk through the door for the first time is to be able to discover the hope that is the spiritual foundation, which will bring sanity and serenity to his or her life. Clearly, such spirituality welcomes all who desire to stop drinking."

In the sharing that followed some participants spoke of their difficulties reconciling "spirituality" with organized religion. One trustee related that he once went to a Franciscan friar for guidance. The friar was happy to know that he was continuing to go to A.A. meetings and had not stopped going because he may have found "the Lord." A director shared that when she first joined A.A., the Lord's Prayer was used at all meetings in her community. It was not until she got involved in general service that she became aware that some members were uncomfortable with the practice. This helped raise her awareness and her group eventually began to close with alternative prayers. Another trustee concluded that spirituality in A.A. is more about one's personal spiritual journey and one's own definition of a "higher power," rather than trying to impose ones' "truths" on others.

A director talked about her area's enthusiasm to debate this topic. When new, she had no difficulty with "God" and did not focus on the word. Based on her experience, the spiritual journey is the transformation of "I" to "We" and that it is about something beyond oneself. One guest from the G.S.B. of Mexico shared that it is the spirituality of A.A. that has allowed him to live a life of respect and love for others.

A trustee shared that following a family tragedy, a member of the clergy said that "the only way to change the world, is to change oneself; and, the only time to do it is now." In A.A. we learn love and tolerance and to give it away. He added that love is the essence of spirituality.

A director said that he was raised in a family that did not teach tolerance. In A.A. he learned to see God in others and to live by spiritual principles. A trustee shared that he sees A.A.'s spirituality as finding one's sense of a "higher calling," and told the story that a Native American elder once answered, "It is a great mystery," to the question "what is a higher power?"

A G.S.O. staff member shared that he was raised in a specific religion that he was very comfortable in until he went to Vietnam, where he abandoned his religious upbringing. He tried other religious faiths, and not until he was sober in A.A. did he learn to live along spiritual lines and feel comfortable again. Another staff member shared that in A.A., we learn that we all have the capacity to believe in something and that there are options.

January 2010 — "Selection Process of General Service Conference Agenda Items" — The first presenter was George Martin, general service trustee and A.A.W.S. director, who spoke to the question: "What role would a General Service Conference committee have in selecting final General Service Conference agenda items?" George noted that until 1973 the Conference Committee on Agenda/Admissions and the trustees' General Policy Committee consulted on items submitted as possible Conference agenda items. He referred to the Concepts related to "ultimate authority" and the "right of decision" and the relation of the Conference to the General Service Board in creating a Conference agenda. He posed the question, "Should we go back to the pre-1973 system?" He expressed that "our modern technology suggests that a return to pre-Conference communication with Conference Committees is not only feasible, but potentially much more productive than it was forty years ago." The challenge, he asserted, was in the lack of time to thoughtfully consider possible agenda items prior to the Conference. Rather than having January 15th as a deadline for agenda items to be submitted, he suggested August 15th as a deadline that would give all parties a chance to ponder and consult thoughtfully on each item and to prioritize, shape and formulate an

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2010¹

	Groups	Members
United States	56,694	1,264,716
Canada	<u>4,887</u>	<u>94,163</u>
Sub-Total	61,581	1,358,879
Correctional facilities ²	1,589	39,731
Internationalists	3	-
Lone Members	-	<u>157</u>
Total	63,173	1,398,767
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>52,600</u>	<u>704,266</u>
Grand Total	115,773	2,103,033

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent and actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 60 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figure.

effective agenda. It would also allow each Conference committee to have the time during its Conference meeting to begin shaping agenda items for the next year's Conference.

General service trustee and Grapevine Corporate Board director, Don Miller, gave the presentation entitled, "Is our present practice of selecting final General Service Conference agenda items working?" Don posed the question in other words, "Does our present practice of selecting final General Service Conference agenda items reflect the best that we can do?," and suggested the following criteria for effective final agendas for the General Service Conference:

1. Contain items affecting policies of the General Service Structure that affect A.A. as a whole that require widespread debate and decision making.
2. Not contain items which have been agreed upon by tradition or other method(s) that do not affect the General Service Structure of A.A. as a whole.
3. Be constructed and decided in a manner to allow for a timely collection, distribution and discussion of background material throughout the entire Fellowship.
4. Honor the limited amount of time available for the annual week-long Conference meeting.

Don suggested that the process we use should perhaps do more than just create a useful final Conference agenda. It should:

1. Enhance trust between the A.A. groups and the General Service Conference.
2. Enhance trust among the actively participating members of the General Service Conference.
3. Act as a form of institutional memory.

He encouraged everyone to start with building and enhancing

trust. He noted that one of the most effective ways to build trust is "...to make sure that we use a 'fair process' for decision making." He concluded that the current process for choosing agenda items works "...and can, of course, always be improved."

A summary of the sharing that followed: A G.S.O. staff member shared that an item coming to the trustees that may not fall into any easily identifiable category is no longer "programmed" as a possible workshop or presentation but either forwarded as an agenda item or has no action taken. The issue may cut across several committees' responsibilities. Is it appropriate to force it into one committee? Is there a way for the whole Conference to discuss such matters before any decisions are made? A regional trustee agreed, noting that we have problems when we don't know where to send items received. The G.S.B., A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards all have to have an easier way to take such problems to a higher authority, which is the Conference. We have issues that we call "policy," but they are really principles needing Conference interpretation. Perhaps we need a Conference Committee on Traditions. There are major issues, such as anonymity, in this electronic age where we need guidance from the Fellowship for the trustees so they can administrate. Another trustee followed up on this topic, expressing the need for collaboration throughout the Fellowship so we can all work together. He noted that when it came to principles, there could be no compromise; however, knowing what a principle is can sometime be hard. He said that he had to separate principle from his ego, "I need to find serenity between what's a principle and what's a good idea?"

A delegate chair expressed a concern that possibly, additional year-round involvement and work load by Conference committee members in assisting in setting the agenda might discourage someone from standing for delegate. A regional trustee was glad that the Conference might do an inventory, because it might be an opportunity to examine the structure and look at ways to determine how important issues, which may not fit into any one committee's oversight, can be addressed. A delegate chair noted that Advisory Actions need to be followed and if they are no longer applicable to current circumstances, we should get rid of them, but we should not arbitrarily pick and choose what actions we follow. Another delegate chair suggested that items upon which the trustees took no action might be used as a source for presentations for the following year. A Class A trustee observed that A.A. had always adjusted itself to change when change was necessary. Change is hard, but it can be a healthy, exciting process if transparency and the use of many communication channels are used; such a process builds trust. The current structure serves us well and a new structure will serve us just as well when the time for change comes. Today, we are sharing a collaboration and partnership in what we are addressing — that also builds trust.

A Grapevine director noted that there were all kinds of solutions in the Fellowship and some items come prematurely to the trustees' and Conference committees before they are widely discussed and that may be a major reason why no action is taken. A trustee concurred that items should not come forward too soon. Sharing on her experience at the last Conference, one delegate chair despaired at one point during the session, wondering what was going to happen to A.A., but there was a transformational point when she realized that everyone involved loved A.A. as much as she did.

In conclusion, two trustees shared that learning to trust and be trustworthy is important as an A.A. servant. One trustee said, "At the Conference we make group decisions; and sometimes we have an informed group conscience — a loving God expressing Himself through us."

Conley Byrd, chairperson

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office report: It's been a productive year for the A.A. Grapevine office. Since the last Conference, it has produced 18 issues of the redesigned Grapevine and La Viña. Other products include the updated GVR/LVR handbooks; a 2-volume Spanish-language *Traditions* CD; the 2010 wall calendar and pocket planner; *A Rabbit Walks into a Bar* humor book; and 12 issues of the e-newsletter, "Heard It Through the Grapevine." In addition, the office is in the process of relaunching the Web site in a content management system. There has also been a move to a new fulfillment house and the process of updating the online catalog is in progress.

The A.A. Grapevine staff currently consists of 11 full-time and 3 part-time employees, who work on the production of the publications; circulation and public information; finance and shipping; and customer service. Plans are in place for a full-time Web editor and full-time La Viña editor to join staff this winter/spring. Also, over the course of the past year, consulting editors have been editing La Viña. Web consultants have been assisting with web updates and relaunch. A freelance art director joined the GV team in June and has done an exemplary job of executing the redesign and building the member art stable of contributors. Once the full team is in place, the department will then turn their attention to developing the editorial content of A.A. Grapevine's Web site, which post-relaunch can be updated easily and cost-effectively.

During the past year La Viña's Editorial Advisory Board, a group of A.A. members with substantial professional experience in publishing, business, and communications, have helped guide the magazine and evaluate manuscripts. La Viña's Editorial Advisory Board met with staff five times this year to guide the editorial direction of La Viña, discuss circulation and the development of stories, and assist the consulting editor. The Grapevine's long-standing Editorial Advisory Board lent similar support to the Grapevine, meeting with staff five times this year to review the magazine redesign, review topics for upcoming issues, books and other products, and discuss ways to encourage the Fellowship to submit stories and use Grapevine publications in their Twelfth Step work. The Editorial Advisory Board also met with the board to discuss unifying the look and feel of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s products.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. welcomed a new circulation director this year, who joins the staff with an extensive magazine circulation background. The circulation director supervises customer service and maintains steady communication with readers, Grapevine/La Viña reps (GvR/RLVs), intergroup/central offices, and Conference members with letters, press releases, and other materials highlighting the audio Grapevine and other publications. He has also researched and made recommendations on the fulfillment house and is managing the project of updating the online catalog.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s chief financial officer, the controller, drafts Grapevine and La Viña's budgets in collaboration with the board's finance committee, reports on the GV and LV's financial standing each quarter and keeps a close watch on company expenditures and cash flow. The controller also supervises copyrights and freelance contracts, and in-house shipping, serves as chair of two trustees' retirement committees, and plays a key role in strategic planning. He and the rest of the Grapevine team also help the Fellowship understand that A.A. Grapevine, Inc. strives to be self-supporting and does not receive group contributions to cover the cost of its operation. Its mission is to carry the A.A. message, and break even, with the help of the Fellowship.

Amber Eden, managing editor

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.



A.A. literature has been translated into 75 languages; the Big Book, Alcoholics Anonymous, is in 59 languages.

World Service Meeting — The 21st World Service Meeting (WSM) will be held October 17-21, 2010 in Mexico City, Mexico, with the theme "Sponsorship: Our Responsibility." We are anticipating approximately 50 delegates representing an estimated 40 countries or zones. Don Massey, trustee-at-large/United States, will be the first-term delegate, and Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, will be the second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager, Phyllis Halliday, will be presiding at the event and staff member Warren Stafford will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Mary Clare Lynch, Gayle Solheim Riese, and Eva Sanchez. John Kirwin will be the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and liaison to hotel staff.

Literature Assistance — The 2010 Literature Assistance budget of \$115,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 2009, 16 translations and over 40 reviews of proposed translations were completed.

Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at five zonal service meetings in 2009, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In May 2009, Phyllis Halliday, Jo-Anne Lowenberger, and Julio Espailat attended,

as observers, the 4th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM), which was held in Johannesburg, South Africa. In July, Phyllis Halliday and G.S.O. staff member, Valerie O'Neill, attended, as observers, the 8th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Bangkok, Thailand. In October, staff member Warren Stafford, International desk, and Valerie O'Neill, newly appointed Publications director attended, as observers, the 14th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany. Also, in October, Jo-Anne Lowenberger and Don Massey, attended, as delegates, the 16th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Arequipa, Peru. Finally, in November, Warren Stafford attended the 2nd West Central Africa Service Meeting (RACO) in Cameroon, Africa.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, and regional assemblies. In addition to the events listed above trustees and staff members visited India and Colombia. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, who carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Jo-Anne Lowenberger, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 59 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and outside professional services. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and



This teapot, a gift from Russia, resides in a glass case in G.S.O.'s Archives and bears the inscription:

To General World Services of A.A.

From Moscow Beginners, the first group of A.A. in the U.S.S.R.

With gratitude, hope, faith and love.

Moscow, December 20, 1988

e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our trust in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits from the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Working closely with our Records Department to insure that our International A.A. Directory (for countries outside of the United States and Canada), which is published annually, contains updated contact information for G.S.O.s, central offices and intergroups, groups, foreign contacts and Loners around the world.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives requests to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 59 languages, and additional translations are in progress.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Warren Stafford

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. The objectives of the 2010 International Convention, with its theme "A Vision for You," are: To provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A.; to enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world; and to let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee acts and makes recommendations in order to fulfill the broad purposes of the General Service Board, as those purposes relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well-planned International Conventions. The detailed work inherent in putting on the Convention is executed by the Convention coordinator and a professional Convention Consultant.

As a follow up to a 2009 Conference Advisory Action and an Additional Committee Consideration from the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that, over the Convention weekend, unlimited access to an encrypted,

anonymity-protected Internet broadcast of the 2010 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be made available through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Access to the broadcast would end on Monday, July 5, 2010, at midnight Eastern Time. This allows unlimited access within a time frame and no pass codes will be required.

The committee considered a request to change the random selection process of flag bearers during the Friday night flag ceremony, and agreed that the current process is in keeping with the principle of anonymity and is as fair as possible.

We also reviewed and accepted the program titles for the 2010 International Convention and agreed that a meeting for "A.A. in the Caribbean" be added, as it was in Toronto.

In-depth discussions were held regarding setting the registration fee for the 2010 Convention, which took into consideration a realistic budget, the committee's responsibilities relevant to International Conventions, and the spirit of self-support recommended for these events. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the 2010 International Convention preregistration fee be \$95.00 (USD) per attendee and that the on-site registration fee be \$110.00 (USD) per attendee.

We discussed the souvenir for the 2010 International Convention. *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* is coming out in soft-cover, and the new format will be launched by publishing and selling a special Convention edition as a souvenir. The price of the souvenir book is set by A.A. World Services, Inc. The Grapevine is creating a special issue for the Convention and both will be offered for presale in the printed Registration Brochure and on the Convention registration site.

The committee reviewed the speaker selection process for the Convention, and affirmed the principle that we strive to select speakers who did not speak at the previous Convention. We also agreed to keep the current sobriety requirement of 40 years to share at the Oldtimers Big Meeting on Saturday night in San Antonio.

The formats for the Friday night, Saturday night and Sunday morning Big Meetings, which will be held in the Alamodome, were reviewed and approved by the committee. Also reviewed and approved, was the tentative schedule of professional panels and participants. The committee agreed to extend invitations to special guests who are surviving links to A.A.'s co-founders and early history: Nikki Haggart and Sally Robinson, Sam Shoemaker's daughters, and Dennis Manders, longtime G.S.O. controller.

The committee reviewed background on the Fun Run, which had been held at previous International Conventions, and agreed that no Fun Run would be held in San Antonio, due to declining interest and heat concerns.

The committee declined an offer from a documentary filmmaker who requested permission to produce a documentary on the preparation for the 2010 International Convention and thanked him for his interest. The committee was also notified that the Stepping Stones Foundation had approached the General Service Office with a request to exhibit artifacts from their collection at the International Convention. The committee agreed not to accept this offer.

In response to a 2009 Additional Committee Consideration, the committee carefully considered the parameters for selection of the site for International Conventions. They reviewed the 2020 Site-Selection guidelines and form letters, noting that each time, before the process begins, these are reviewed by the trustees' and Conference Committees on International Conventions/Regional Forums. Committee members suggested that several improvements be incorporated into the site-selection process and be reported to the 2010 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. Suggestions include having a consistent timeline

for announcing the city that has been selected; increasing communication about how the Site Visit Team narrows their selection; how the city is recommended to the trustees' Committee and the General Service Board; and that more information be provided about the reasons the specific site was selected.

Regional Forums — Since the 2009 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Northeast, West Central, Southwest and East Central regions. One "Additional" Regional Forum was held in the Eastern Canada region. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the General Service Board, General Service Office and A.A. Grapevine. Many in attendance were experiencing their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to exchange information between local trusted servants, A.A.s interested in service, trustees, directors and staff of G.S.O. and Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service.

Following each Forum, the committee reviewed a summary of the Forum evaluation questionnaires and discussed the usefulness and effectiveness of the current Forums evaluation model and made no changes. The committee will continue to review evaluation summaries at quarterly meetings and noted that the information in the summaries is more useful to the staff member in planning Forums.

The committee conducted its second annual review/inventory of the content and implementation of Local Forums and Additional Regional Forums, and made no changes.

The committee discussed online hotel registration for Forums and recommended to the General Service Board that online links on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site with "page break disclaimers" be made available for hotel registration for Regional Forums, where provided. The committee also discussed the delegate's presentations at Regional Forums that the committee received and noted that summaries of these presentations are included in the newsletter distributed at Regional Forums.

We discussed a Local Forum request and recommended to the General Service Board that the request for a Local Forum, to be hosted by the Spanish-speaking districts in Area 08, San Diego/Imperial, California, August 22, 2010, be approved. This marks the third Local Forum since they were introduced. Since the 2009 Conference the second Local Forum was held in Mamaroneck, New York and organized by the Spanish-speaking districts in Area 49, Southeast New York.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2010 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums the following discussion topic: Discuss ways to encourage interest in Forums and attract first-time attendees.

We reviewed and accepted the 2010 schedule of board and staff participation at Forums, noting that the Forums staff member works out the schedule and presents it to G.S.O. management and this committee for review. The following Forums are scheduled for 2010:

2010

May 14-16	Western Canada	Saskatoon, Saskatchewan
August 27-29	Pacific	Torrance, California
September 17-19	Eastern Canada	Trois-Rivieres, Quebec
November 12-14	West Central "Additional"	Rapid City, South Dakota
December 10-12	Southeast	Myrtle Beach, South Carolina

Bill Clark, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Conventions — The International Convention assignment entails coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up the A.A. International Conventions, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning, and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a wonderful opportunity for A.A. members to celebrate gratitude and sobriety.

Plans proceed apace for the 2010 International Convention, which will be held in the wonderful city of San Antonio, July 1 – 4, 2010. The Convention theme, chosen from suggestions sent in by the Fellowship, is "A Vision for You." Throughout the Convention week, more than 4,000 local A.A.s, coordinated by the San Antonio Volunteer Host Committee, will welcome visitors from all over the globe. The 2010 International Convention will kick-off Thursday evening with a "Party in the Park" and dances in the Henry B. Gonzalez Convention Center and out the back door of the Convention Center in HemisFair Park, as well as at local hotels.

During the day on Friday and Saturday the Convention Center will be packed with Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings and Marathons. Approximately 650 speakers will participate in over 200 meetings. Friday night, Saturday night and Sunday morning all attendees will come together for the Big Meetings in the Alamodome, conveniently located a couple of blocks from the Convention Center. The traditional flag ceremony of nations in attendance will take place at the Friday night meeting in the Alamodome stadium. For the first time, this Flag Ceremony will have unlimited broadcast over the Internet starting Saturday morning, and will remain available until Monday at midnight. The broadcast will be anonymity protected. On Saturday night, old-timers chosen from the hat will share about their years of experience, strength and hope in Alcoholics Anonymous.

For family members and loved ones who belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will accompany us to San Antonio, daytime Al-Anon/Alateen meetings and other events will take place at the Marriott Rivercenter Hotel.

Information about the Convention has been made available through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, in *Box 4-5-9*, and in the A.A. Grapevine. The Web site will be updated as we move ahead. Excitement is plentiful as this 75th Anniversary celebration draws near.

Rick Walker

Regional/Local Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Additional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. groups, members and trusted servants in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staff. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and regularly scheduled at the invitation of a particular region every two years. With the implementation of Additional Regional Forums, there is currently the opportunity for five Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and coordinates Forum details: hotel arrangements, program, displays, on-site registration, etc. The coordinator works closely with the host contact who recruits volunteers to assist staff with hospitality, set-up and registration during the Forum weekend. The location for a Regional Forum is decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O., who also suggest presentations

and workshops. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "early bird" newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Forum Final Report to all who attend. Advance planning and on-site work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

In October 2006, the concept of Local Forums (LF) was approved by the General Service Board on a five-year trial basis. The purpose of Local Forums is to bring Forum information to A.A. members in remote, sparsely populated areas, urban neighborhoods or underserved A.A. communities. Any A.A. community or service entity may request a one- or two-day Local Forum. Unlike Regional Forums, the responsibility for Forum expenses, such as meeting room rental and miscellaneous expenses, are assumed by the Local Forum Committee. At their expense, the General Service Board will send two participants, one from the board and one from the General Service Office or Grapevine office, and will provide literature for display.

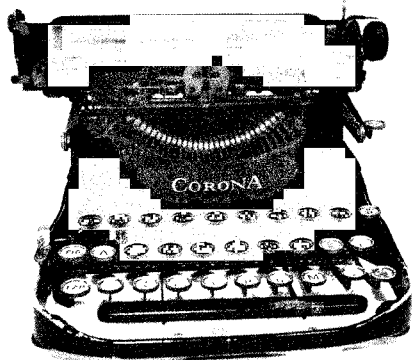
The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment also serves as co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees, as well as managing Service Material.

Eva Sanchez

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2009 General Service Conference.

- *"The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs"* — At their August meeting, the trustees' committee reviewed the 2009 Conference's recommendation to revise the draft of the pamphlet,

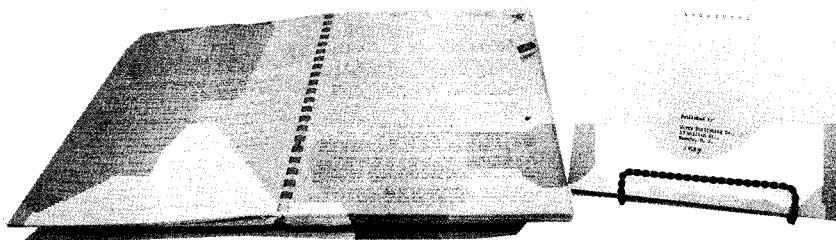


Typewriter on which Ruth Hock (nonalcoholic), Bill's first secretary, typed the manuscript for the first edition of the Big Book, Alcoholics Anonymous. Ruth received the five millionth copy of the Big Book at the 50th Anniversary Convention in Montreal, 1985.

"The A.A. Member — Medications & Other Drugs." The Publications Department was asked to revise the draft, with attention to the suggestions provided during the General Service Conference discussions, and with additional review by A.A. members who are also physicians, and to bring a draft of the revision to the Fall meeting of the committee for review. In October the committee reviewed the report and suggestions from the Publications Department on the pamphlet, and asked the Publications Department to develop a new introduction to the pamphlet and bring a final draft for review to the next quarterly.

In January, the committee reviewed the final draft of "The A.A. Member — Medications & Other Drugs" and recommended to the General Service Board that the revised draft be forwarded to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature for their consideration.

- *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"* — In August, the trustees' committee discussed the 2009 Conference Advisory



Original manuscript of first edition of the Big Book (left) and a facsimile copy, which is available from G.S.O.'s Archives for a contribution.

Action that the committee undertake a thorough review of the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship." A subcommittee was appointed and was asked to bring a progress report to the next quarterly meeting. The staff member on the Literature desk and the Publications Director served as resources to the subcommittee. At their October meeting, the committee reviewed the report and suggestions from the subcommittee on "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and agreed to forward new changes and/or suggestions to the subcommittee, which would provide a final draft for review at the next quarterly meeting. In January, the committee reviewed the final draft of "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" submitted by the subcommittee and recommended to the General Service Board that the revised draft of the pamphlet be forwarded to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature for their consideration.

- *Special Needs recovery* — At their August meeting the trustees' Literature Committee discussed the 2009 Conference Advisory Action requesting the development of a Special Needs pamphlet. The committee noted the decision of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities (CPC/TF) to expand the Scope of their committee to include Special Needs, which included responsibility for the development of a Special Needs pamphlet.

Projects Ongoing:

- At the next printing, and in keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action, a sentence encouraging newcomers to obtain and study the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, will be added to the pamphlet "A Newcomer Asks" (next reprint is scheduled for March 2010).
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the title of the pamphlet "44 Questions" be changed to "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.," the reprint of the large print format (P-57) of the pamphlet currently appears with the new title. The regular print format (P-2) will be available with the new title upon depletion of current inventory (approximately March 2010).

Projects forwarded to the 2010 Conference Literature Committee:

- Revised draft pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs."
- Revised draft pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."

Requests discussed and forwarded to the 2010 Conference Literature Committee:

- Request to change a sentence in the pamphlet, "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A."
- Suggestion that the Conference Committee on Literature consider a revision of the pamphlet, "A.A. and the Armed Services"

that would include new stories reflecting more recent experience.

- Request to review the booklet, *Living Sober*.
- Request to define editorial responsibilities of G.S.O.'s Publications department.
- Request to revise and update the video "Your General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure."
- Request to develop a book about the early pioneer women in A.A.

Vic Phillips, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications department.

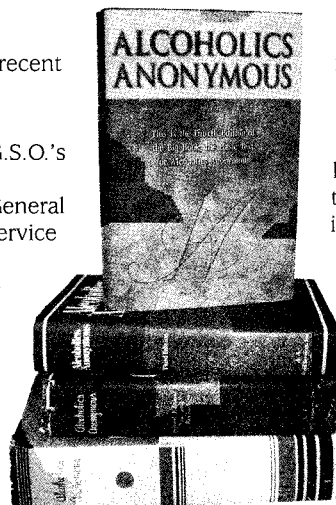
The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 73 area, 174 district and 73 intergroup/central office/other literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O. The Literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect of the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following quarterly distribution: 70,000 copies in English, 3,000 copies in French and 7,000 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. G.S.O. always welcomes committee sharing on service from the Fellowship, which may be included in articles so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both the Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

Julio Espaillat

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: The responsibilities of the trustees' Committee on Nominating grew over time to encompass criteria for all vacancies, whether in the ranks of trustees or among key service directors and staff members. At each meeting for over 60 years, the committee has worked to fulfill the task outlined for it. In *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, developed in 1962, that task included: "The recommendations of this committee to a large extent will determine the continuous success of our services. Its members will have the primary voice in choosing our future Trustees and non-Trustee workers. Careful deliberation, painstaking investigation and interviewing, refusal to accept casual recommendations, preparation well in advance of lists of suitable candidates — these will need to be the principal attitudes and activities of this committee. All temptation to haste or snap judgment will need to be



The first edition of Alcoholics Anonymous was published in 1939, the second edition in 1955, third in 1976, and fourth in 2001. To date A.A.'s Big Book has sold over 30 million copies.

faithfully and constantly resisted." (Page 49)

Activities of this committee in the past year:

Follow Up to 2009 General Service Conference: As follow up to the April 27, 2009 General Service Board motion, noted in the 2009 Conference Committee report, in July 2009 the committee consulted the A.A. World Services (A.A.W.S.) Board who advised them that they intended to nominate a candidate for a general service trustee to fill the vacancy on the A.A.W.S. Board at its October 2009 meeting. In October the trustees' Nominating Committee recommended a general service trustee, and in January 2010, the committee received and recommended the Board Slates (which includes the general service trustee nominee) to be elected following presentation at the 2010 General Service Conference.

In response to the Additional Committee consideration from the 2009 Conference Committee on Report and Charter requesting clarification of language in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding nominating a regional trustee candidate in the same year when nominating a trustee-at-large candidate, the committee forwarded this request to the Conference Committee on Trustees as directed.

Class A Trustee Election: The committee reviewed the resumes, curriculum vitae, and other background material of 31 applicants who had made themselves available to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees and whose resumes we had on file. The committee then chose six applicants to interview for two Class A positions in January 2010.

Following the interviews, the committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that John Fromson, M.D. and Michele Grinberg, J.D. be invited to serve as Class A trustees to succeed William D. Clark, M.D. and to fill a currently vacant position following the 2010 General Service Conference.

Regional Trustees: The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2010, all candidates submitted for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustees.

Board Slates: The committee reviewed and recommended proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2010, following presentation at the 2010 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures: The General Service Board approved the following recommendations to revise the language in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures: to clarify the term of service on the A.A. World Services Board and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, to note the usefulness of the documentation of past general manager searches; to clarify the time commitment of trustees-at-large regarding service to the World Service Meeting and to clarify the submission process of regional trustee candidates in the U.S. and Canada.

Rogelio Flores, chairperson

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment is responsible to the trustees' Committee on Nominating and to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees as well as to trustees' subcommittees. Since the last Conference, the staff member prepared background, minutes and reports for three quarterly trustees' committee meetings. The staff member worked with the trustees' committee on vacancy announcements, sent time com-

mitment and interest status, and follow up letters to Class A (nonalcoholic) candidates, and organized the interview scheduling processes for a search for two Class A trustees – one to succeed William D. Clark, M.D. and one to fill a current Class A vacancy. The staff member also coordinated the transcription and review of resumes for 23 regional trustee candidates who made their names available to participate in this year's Conference elections procedure.

This staff member also serves as liaison for G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, responding to all inquiries, concerns and suggestions from A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. The staff member is also the contact for maintaining the Web site in a professional manner including keeping all information on the Web site current. In addition, the correspondence for the Southwest region of the United States is also the responsibility of this assignment.

Mary Dargan

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on aa.org; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

Television P.S.A.s — Bid submissions for the 2010 Television Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s) were reviewed and the committee decided to develop, "My World," the proposed P.S.A. being considered at the 2010 Conference. The committee also concluded that if "My World" is approved, it would be important to fund a centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation phases of the project, in addition to the work done by the local committees. All current A.A. TV P.S.A.s were reviewed and found to be relevant and useful; given that, the committee did not find the need for a new A.A. TV P.S.A. in 2011.

Radio P.S.A.s — The Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD, with script as part of the packaging, was made available by the Publication department in November.

Communications with the Media — The committee reviewed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, which was sent by e-mail and snail mail in late March.

Utilizing New Media Platforms — The committee agreed not to remove the A.A. P.S.A.s from YouTube at this time and acknowledged that it is important to develop a comprehensive Public Information policy related to electronic media.

Anonymity on social networking Web sites: Extensive discussion was held on the nature and extent of A.A. anonymity breaks at the public level on social networking Web sites and at events ranging from A.A. meetings to conferences and conventions. The committee believes it is important that the Fellowship look at the issue of anonymity in the age of electronic communications.

Membership Survey — The committee discussed methods of surveying the A.A. Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada, including

electronic survey models. Changing the current (random sampling) methodology for conducting the survey to one using a web-based (self-selected) tool would alter the statistical validity of the results and their credibility to the professional community. It was decided that the 2010 A.A. Membership Survey will be conducted using the current (random sampling) methodology.

Young People's Videos — 2009 Conference-approved film submissions for the Young People's A.A. Video Project were made available for distribution in DVD format in November 2009, and the committee requested that the video also be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. The committee spent considerable time defining and clarifying the scope, direction and implementation plan for continuation of the A.A. Videos for Young People Project. One draft video has been forwarded to the 2010 Conference Public Information Committee.

Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to aa.org, updates on Web site activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the Web site, and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2010 Conference Public Information Committee.

Film projects — The committee agreed to take no action on the video "Am I an Alcoholic — 20 Questions," finding the entire video to be overly diagnostic and not in keeping with how A.A. shares experience with those seeking help with a drinking problem.

The committee remains committed to doing all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Terry Bedient, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 950 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television and radio Public Service announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive

information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.

- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity



The March 1, 1941 Saturday Evening Post contained the Jack Alexander article, "Alcoholics Anonymous," which brought a surge of interest about A.A., both nationally and internationally. In 1941 there were 2,000 A.A. members; today the number exceeds 2 million.

to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.

- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The results of triennial surveys are published in pamphlet form and as a table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.
- Coordinate Public Information and media relations efforts for A.A.'s International Convention, which will be held in July 2010 in San Antonio, Texas.

Mary Clare Lynch

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2009, the staff received 51,655 such requests by mail, e-mail and fax, plus many phone calls daily; that is more than a 25 percent increase over correspondence received in 2008 when 38,435 requests by mail, e-mail and fax arrived at G.S.O. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2009 G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,513 individual visitors in addition to English- and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of both G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

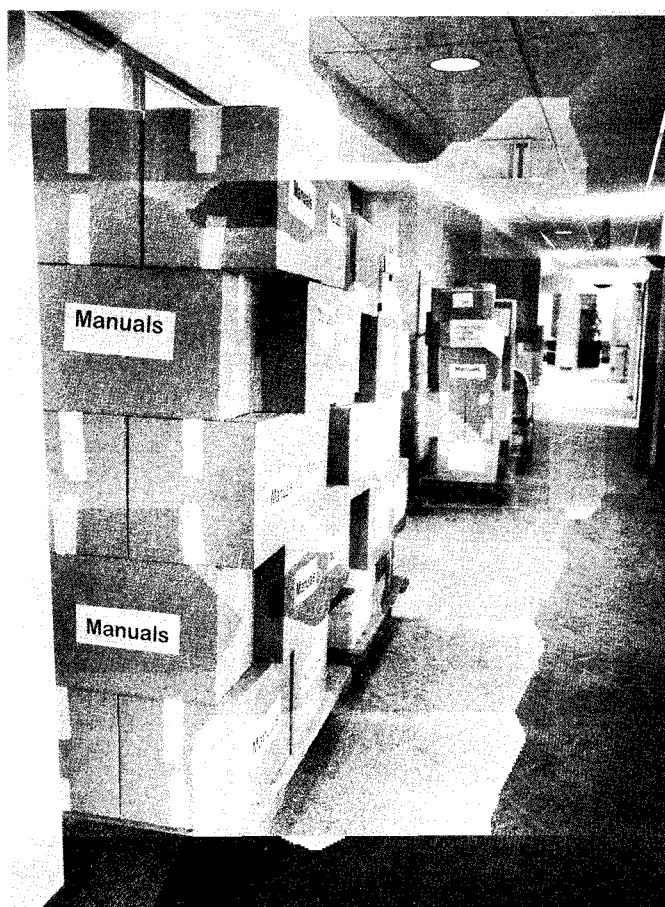
Doug Richardson

Area Service Highlights— Panel 60 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alaska: Area 02 encompasses the entire state of Alaska, consisting of 586,000 square miles, an area approximately 20% the size of the contiguous lower 48 states. Substantial portions of the state are not on a road system and travel to those areas is restricted to air and water transportation. This causes many challenges in carrying the message as well as in holding service assemblies throughout the state. Area 02 currently has 159 active groups registered with G.S.O. and an unknown number of unregistered groups that meet on a regular basis. The groups are divided into 12 districts, one of which is currently dark and two others with very limited activity at this time. Some of our districts are much larger geographically than many states making meeting and communications difficult tasks. In spite of the challenges, we have two assemblies each year plus an election assembly in odd numbered years in various locations around the state. In recent years we have held an Area Committee teleconference each month to deal with routine business matters and develop further plans to carry the message to rural communities. Progress has been slow, but efforts continue with encouraging results at times. Through our Communications Committee, we are exploring the possibility of holding area assemblies via teleconference so that more participation can be accomplished without incurring the high cost of travel. We were honored to have the opportunity to host PRAASA in 2008 and look forward to hosting the International Women's Conference in 2011. Area 02 will also be the site of a Regional Forum in Fairbanks in 2012. We continue to carry the message of recovery and fellowship while living life happy, joyous and free.—*Loren Uhlenkott*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 is the largest area in North America 1,596,867 square miles. It is comprised of the Province of Alberta, the North West Territories, a large portion of Nunavut Territory, the Peace River Block, and the East Kootney Region of British Columbia, as well as one group in the town of Maidstone, Saskatchewan. It has been said that if Santa Claus had a drinking problem it would be in Area 78. We have the blessing of incredible cultural, linguistic, and geographic diversity, which has been and we believe will continue to be the catalyst for growth in the Fellowship. From the traveling area committee meetings to the travel assistance program, the demonstration of Unity in the area is inspiring. Area assemblies and area committee meetings are well attended. The broad range of A.A. experience is revealed at these gatherings as members car pool together for hours to attend. The Travel Assistance Program has been utilized enough that we have had two of our committee chairs in the last four years come from the Northwest Territories. Just over 500 groups in 48 districts have generously contributed to the areas overall health. One of our past delegates, in conjunction with a C.P.C. committee in one of our more densely populated centers, was approached by a medical professor about the phenomenon of alcoholism/Alcoholics Anonymous. This has resulted in medical students observing an open A.A. meeting, then afterwards a two on two (two students, two A.A.) dialogue. The professor has made this part of the class curriculum. We continue to evolve, sometimes quickly, sometimes slowly, it is always evolving as we are a work in progress that I am honored to be a part of.—*Darryl Dunphy*



Hallway at G.S.O. with cartons, containing Conference Manuals, office supplies, two copies of every piece of literature and service material (English, French, Spanish), ready to be transported to the Hilton Rye Town.

Arizona: Hi everybody. My name is Suzette Cottrell. I am the Arizona, Area 03, Panel 60, delegate. Our area spans over 114,000 miles, to include 15 county districts, 54 subdistricts, of which three are Spanish. This represents 900 groups, or over 20,000 alcoholics. With a large geographic and linguistic area, we realize that we have and will face many challenges. Area 03 has focused some of its attention on maintaining regular communication, or bridging the communication gap. Our Fellowship has held its first Biennial Coordinators Conference. Coordinators, or committee chairs, at a group, intergroup, subdistrict, district, or area level, are invited to attend and participate. The purpose is to foster an environment of sharing ideas and information. The Remote Communities Committee is challenged with carrying the message to those groups that face linguistic or geographic barriers. This committee has nurtured an Adopt-A-Meeting idea, which encourages groups or districts to adopt a remote group or meeting. Groups or districts travel to other groups in rural communities to share their experience, strength and hope. Area 03 also has a growing Spanish community; and with growth comes change. We are exploring the needs of this community. We have had verbal translation, and minimal, written translation for years. We have begun, by translating our

area handbook, area newsletters, coordinators report, officer reports, and the delegate's Conference Report. This effort has been, informally, a duty of the Spanish coordinator. There seems to be an increasing need, for a committee, to provide verbal and written translations to our area. Lastly, at our four area assemblies, we offer roundtables or orientations to Coordinators, G.S.R.s, Intergroup liaisons, D.C.M.s and D.C.M.C.s. This is to share information with those that are serving in these positions. I am truly honored each time I get the opportunity to be of service to Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Suzette Cottrell*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 09 is comprised of 1,809 recorded groups, with an estimated 58,000 members, and encompasses all or part of four counties, stretching from the Pacific Ocean to the Arizona/Nevada border and roughly between San Diego/Imperial Counties and Los Angeles County. We are divided into 18 geographical districts and 6 Spanish-language districts. Most districts have district committee chairs and D.C.M.s serve more manageable sub-districts. We have three assemblies a year and six Area Service Committee Meetings, two prior to each assembly, all of which are simultaneously translated into Spanish. G.S.R. and D.C.M. "schools" are offered at each area meeting. We participate in a four-area D.C.M. workshop with Areas 05, 08, and 93. In 2009 we changed our corporate structure from a Nonmember to a Member Not-for-profit Corporation to better align our structure with our actual practice. We currently have 15 standing committees, most of which have English and Spanish speaking co-chairs. We just ended our first panel of our new Communications Committee, which includes the newsletter, the website, the written translations, and the overview of communications equipment. All our communications are translated into Spanish, including all material on our Web site, newsletter and flyers. Our Archives are housed in a new 1,380 square foot facility, which also serves as a meeting place for smaller committee gatherings and archival presentations. For the first time Area 09 will host the Pacific Region Forum, which will occur in August in Torrance.—*Linda Clough*

California (Northern Interior): My name is Melody Tolmie, and I serve as the delegate from the California Northern Interior, Area 07, Panel 60. The California Northern Interior Area extends from the Oregon border south through the central valley of California between the coastal mountains and the Sierra Nevada, to about 125 miles north of the LA basin, covering almost 50,000 square miles. Area 07 has 29 districts, 25 English-speaking, and four Spanish-speaking. There are almost 25,000 members, with 912 listed groups, 704 of which are listed as "active." 46 groups meet in correctional facilities. The area holds four assemblies per year, which rotate locations throughout the area. Despite a seriously depressed economy in California, and the central valley in particular, the groups have been most generous, and the area is financially very stable. We have established a vibrant and active Bridging the Gap network and chair position at the area level, and Area 07 will host the National Bridging the Gap Workshop in September 2011. Two new Spanish-speaking districts have been established, for the total of four, which meet every eight weeks in the Asamblea Hispana Interdistrital de Area 07. After long deliberation and consideration, the cnia.org website has premiered and is a working part of our communication endeavors. Additional efforts to improve communication include greater attention to the area newsletter, and the purchase of professional translation equipment. Our Young People's Groups are growing stronger in number and activities. This year, Area 07 will be the site of the Western Area Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous. Area 07 remains committed to fostering

communication between all the A.A. service entities in order to carry out A.A.'s primary purpose.—*Melody Tolmie*

California (San Diego/Imperial): Come to the San Diego/Imperial Area, and you will find A.A. groups in large urban centers and small mountain enclaves; in remote desert towns and agricultural fields; around bonfires at the beach and under gazebos in county parks, and at all hours from 5:30 am to midnight; women's groups, men's groups, young people's groups, gay & lesbian groups, doctors groups; in English, Spanish, and ASL; and always in the language of the heart. Our 899 listed groups and approximately 26,000 A.A. members are served by 20 English-language districts, two Spanish-language districts, five central offices (two English-language and three Spanish-language), two Hospitals & Institutions committees, and three YPAAs. A recent accomplishment is the growth of meetings with ASL interpreters. We now have at least one per day, so it is possible for deaf newcomers to do 90 meetings in 90 days. Our area Accessibilities Committee played a key role in fostering this growth. An ongoing challenge is helping all members of the area to see general service as spiritual, relevant, and fun. And we're making progress on implementing ideas that grew out of our 2008 area inventory—the first inventory held at an area assembly (our previous inventories were done at the area committee level). In 2010 our A.A. members will enjoy ACYPAA (the All California Young People in A.A. Round-Up), a Traditions Breakfast, hosted by the North San Diego County Intergroup; a district-sponsored workshop on A.A. and the Internet; a local Forum sponsored by our Spanish-language districts; and congress and round-ups too numerous to mention. We are, I believe, a complete microcosm and true representation of A.A. as a whole, which makes serving as Area 08's delegate a blessing and a joy.—*Joel Castellaw*

Delaware: Greetings from Delaware—the First State. Area 12 has 231 registered groups serving over 3,500 members; 74% of our groups have G.S.R.s. These groups are divided among 13 districts. Six of our districts are represented by D.C.M.s and meet monthly. For at least the last 10 years, Area 12 has posted the highest figure for per capita contributions to the General Service Office of any area in the United States, yet only 54% of our groups are contributing. Our assembly meets four times a year in Dover which is centrally located within the state. The April assembly is our mini-Conference, at which any member of the Fellowship can voice an opinion on the current year's Conference agenda items. In non-election years we conduct our area's inventory. Our Area Committee meets six times each year. Our area Web site has proven to be a valuable tool for providing information about A.A. worldwide and within our area. The highest amount of traffic accesses our meeting schedules for the entire state and is particularly useful to vacationers at our resorts in southern Delaware. Our three intergroups meet monthly and are active in providing services to the professional community, correctional facilities, and treatment centers. We still have much work to do in attracting our members to embrace the Third Legacy. We take every opportunity to attract, educate and motivate those still reluctant to become involved in service, but we continue to have limited success. This year from May 21st to the 23rd, we will be hosting our 50th Delaware State Convention in Rehoboth Beach. Information can be found on our Web site at delawareaa.org. We hope that you will join us and spend time enjoying the fellowship, serenity, and the Atlantic beaches that Delaware offers.—*Frank Ziembra*

Georgia: Area 16, the state of Georgia, has over 9 million residents. It is the largest state in the Southeast. Alcoholics Anonymous is strong and active in Area 16. We have 656 groups

and approximately 16,000 members. There are 31 registered groups that meet in Correctional Facilities. The area has 51 districts/zones, including one linguistic district, that overlays the area for our Spanish-speaking groups. The service assembly meets three times a year. In addition, there are a D.C.M. Planning Meeting, a Pre-Conference Planning Meeting and eight Cluster Forums on the Conference theme. Area 16 has a PrePaid Convention. It is supported by the groups' contributions throughout the year. This allows for free registration for all of Area 16's A.A. members. No business is conducted at our state Convention. It rotates around the state according to a bid process that is outlined in our Georgia State Service Manual. Georgia has its own service manual which outlines how area business is accomplished. The committee structure in Area 16 includes a Budget/Finance Committee that meets annually to prepare an area budget. It is presented to the D.C.M.s for approval. Other committees are: Archives, Communication, Convention, Corrections, Grapevine, PI/CPC and Treatment. Area 16 has an office that is centrally located in Macon, Georgia. It has one paid employee that answers the phone, fulfills literature orders, does the bookkeeping and takes care of the Area Archives. We have a climate controlled archives repository that is a collection of the history of Area 16 and is supported by donations from our group members. I am very grateful to be serving Area 16 and to be here with you. Thank you.—*Patty Lavelly*

Idaho: Area 18 has 4,544 listed members, in 12 districts, with 441 listed groups. Our area covers 138,000 square miles. We have groups from Eastern Oregon, Western Wyoming, and Northern Nevada. We cover all of Idaho, excluding the panhandle. We have three area committee meetings, which are held in January, March and August; and full-bodied area assemblies in May and October. Due to the geography of our area, the different districts within the area host our assemblies so they are always being held in different parts of Idaho. We generally have about 50% participation with the G.S.R.s in our area. It is so exciting to be a part of this process. I have buckled up, here we go.—*Angela Heuer*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 has over 22,000 members and 1,000 active groups in 24 districts. Each year, we hold four assemblies, four area committee meetings, a Spring service conference and a Fall Big Book conference, all hosted by our districts. Over the past two years, our assembly acted to become a more inviting and effective forum for communication and participation. First, we fostered integration of our service committees by inviting area and district chairs, their alternates, interested G.S.R.s and other committee members to work together at assembly breakout sessions. Second, we adopted the Fellowship New Vision database to facilitate area communication. Third, we increased use of area sharing sessions to provide relief from the "yea or nay" mindset that frustrates many newcomers to general service. These sessions allow for the open exchange of ideas and sharing of experience so vital to the health of our overall service structure. We also changed our approach to Area 20 finances. Our new approach, referred to as Primary Purpose Finance, provides clarity and transparency not possible with our prior service position-based budget. All service activities approved by our assembly are included in a Primary Purpose Register. As additional activities are recommended by our Service Committees and approved by the assembly, they are added to this register and reported on at subsequent assemblies by our area treasurer and Service Committee chairs. Primary Purpose Finance focuses discussion on services needed, rather than the money involved. This new

approach allows the Fellowship throughout Area 20 to understand better how their money in the basket is being used to support specific services to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.—*Ray Mengler*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 serves more than 650 groups, 26 districts and one Spanish linguistic district. Groups are also served by 14 area standing committees and five active intergroups. The area holds five assemblies per year, one of which is a pre-Conference assembly; a November budget meeting; and one weekend focusing on service workshops. We alternate years with Area 22 in hosting the state convention; this year Area 23 hosts the 57th Indiana State Convention, "Keeping it Real." The area is feeling the financial pinch as reflected by the overall economy. Seventh Tradition donations are down and as a result, we reduced our annual operating budget by \$1,000. We are doing more with less. Through diligent Twelfth Step work by the area committee and individual groups, 11 federal, state and county correctional facilities are being served and two women's prisons are holding weekend conferences. Our Web site is up and running, although we're not yet up to speed with group e-mail capabilities. We activated an area-wide dedicated phone line for bridging the gap with treatment facilities to help ensure calls don't fall through the cracks. Recently we've seen a high turnover of area officers and standing committee chairs, which is of great concern. By clearly and accurately communicating the responsibilities that come with leadership positions and with voting for principles rather than personalities, we hope to have better prepared service workers. A traveling G.S.R. school to various locales within the area has resulted in an increase of general service representatives. Beginning this year the alternate delegate and I are taking a similar approach with D.C.M.s, holding small roundtable discussions with them at various locations around the area. I am grateful for the opportunity to serve Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Virginia Rogers*

Kansas: The geographical center of the United States is in Kansas, and we are right in the middle of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are not unique but remarkably varied in subtle ways, like our landscape. We are 10,000 members in 400 groups in 28 districts, including two linguistic districts. Our state is largely rural—our smallest district is four groups—but we are also urban. My own district has 40 groups in one county. Most of our D.C.M.s show up for assemblies, held in January and July, and area committee meetings, held in April and October. Our service committees do enthusiastic work and corrections, especially, is active across the state. Our past delegates meet with us and their experience in workshops and business meetings helps us all. Our Spanish districts have set up intergroups in Kansas City and Wichita and are bidding to host the Spanish International Convention. The Southwest Regional Forum will be in Wichita in 2011. Our Web site is now three years old and is well used and developing well. We do face some challenges. We are not growing much. We have consolidated districts to better serve our members. We need to make the Conference process relevant to more of our groups—only one in four were represented at our last assembly. We need to better integrate the Spanish-speaking groups into the area via translation and are looking to the other areas in the Southwest Region to help us. We are active folk. We round up, round robin, assemble, convene, converse, eat and pray together and drive a long way to do it. Our commitment to carrying the A.A. message, no matter the location or language, is strong and, God willing, will remain so. I am both proud and humbled to represent Area 25 at the General Service Conference.—*Mike Rogers*

Kentucky: Area 26 is in the Southeast Region and encompasses all of Kentucky, Southern Indiana and Metropolis, Illinois. Bordered by the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers, Kentucky covers over 40,000 square miles and has a beautiful and diverse geographical landscape. From the mountains in the east, the rolling hills and horse farms in the center to the wetlands in the west, Alcoholics Anonymous is alive and well in the "Bluegrass State." We're known for horses, basketball, baseball bats, Bluegrass music and—yes—BOURBON. And we thank all of you for your past contribution to the success of that industry, which continues to thrive, even though we quit drinking! But of course those are outside issues. Area 26 has about 1,200 registered groups, about half of those are considered active. Last year we revised our Area Structure trying to clear up inconsistencies and make it more congruent with *The A.A. Service Manual*. This was a time-consuming, but a worth-while process. As chair of the ad hoc committee, I appreciated finding so many other Area Structures on the Internet to use as a guide. We meet four times each year, rotating around the area providing opportunities for service in all our districts. Our Assembly in October is mainly for the purpose of elections and our G.S.R.s do have a voice and vote at that meeting. The Area 26 Archives Repository is located in Lexington, Kentucky, and is open at least one Sunday a month, as well as by appointment the rest of the time. We're also very proud of our ever-improving Web site—area26.net—which lists area meetings, news and events, as well as providing a place for those seeking help. We're all very excited about the most recent addition of our first linguistic *Spanish-speaking* district, which helps fill an on-going need in the area. We welcome District 36 and look forward to their participation in the General Service Structure. With the help of "*something bigger than ourselves*," keeping our Primary purpose in mind, Area 26 continues to carry the message to the suffering alcoholic through the Three Legacies of Alcoholics Anonymous—Recovery, Unity and Service. Thank you for allowing me to serve!—*Joy Flynn*

Maine: Area 28, commonly thought of as the state of Maine, also includes part of New Brunswick, Canada. Currently there are over 550 registered groups and many more meetings that comprise 26 districts, all of which are active except two. Five committee meetings a year keep us in close contact even though we are spread out by distance. Twice a year we meet for assemblies with one being dedicated primarily to the Conference agenda. Each year we meet at the Sugarloaf ski area for a weekend roundup, which usually brings over a thousand participants. The area is served by a strong panel of officers and each rotation finds more people standing for positions than are available. This abundance of people makes it easy to fill all standing committee jobs and ensures that the future is strong with committed service volunteers. We have been especially proud to have a Class A trustee from Maine for the past four years in Dr. Clark. We are blessed in strong recovery and a deep commitment to service, which is passed on from one person to another. Area 28 should remain strong for today and into the future.—*Spencer Richie*

Manitoba: Area 80, Manitoba covers a geographic area of about 250,000 square miles. There are 14 districts, approximately 150 groups, and about 3,900 members. Groups are constantly coming and going, as are individual members, but our numbers have remained relatively constant over the past several years. The bulk of the population of Manitoba lives in the Southern quarter of the province, with 60% living in Winnipeg. About 1/3 of our districts, 1/3 of our groups, but 60% of our members are in or around Winnipeg. So one of the challenges we face is serving the alcoholics who are in the smaller, more scattered groups in the

less populated areas of the province. Each year we include in our area budget, a provincial trip, which provides for representatives of Manitoba general service to visit remote or dark districts in order to encourage interest and participation from those districts. We also try to hold at least two of the four annual assemblies in rural Manitoba, with the remaining two held in Winnipeg. As is the case with other areas, it is sometimes a struggle in our area to find people willing to participate in general service. With our current rotation we do have all area service positions filled. We are always hopeful that G.S.R. participation at our assemblies will increase. Although the majority of groups do have a G.S.R., only about 1/3 of the groups are regularly represented at the assemblies. However, at district meetings, participation is significantly higher, especially in rural Manitoba, where G.S.R.s sometimes travel several hours to attend their monthly meetings. So, although we may not always see them at the assemblies, we know they are participating in the A.A. general service structure. We remain active with P.I., C.P.C., Special Needs, Corrections and Treatment initiatives, but could always use more help to carry the message.—*Cate Wittig*

Maryland: My name is Nancy Bagley; I am an alcoholic and the Panel 60 delegate from Area 29, Maryland. Although geographically small at just under 10,000 square miles, Area 29 covers 20 of the 22 counties in Maryland and serves over 1,000 registered groups in 47 districts. We are continually challenged to keep the Legacy of Service active in our districts and have relit four previously dark districts in the past year, supported by efforts of the Area Committee. We are blessed to have seven past delegates who remain active in an advisory capacity. Our 19 standing and ad hoc committees are active throughout the year. The Archives, Literature and Grapevine committees are available to attend service events as requested; the Finance Committee offers a workshop titled "Where Your Money Goes" to encourage contributions; the Intergroup Liaison Committee teams with several of our 10 Intergroups each year to offer presentations on service opportunities available within each entity; the Special Needs/Accessibilities Committee actively works with groups and districts to ensure that the message of recovery is carried to those with special challenges. Service events hosted by the area this year will include the 40th Annual Maryland State Convention and the 26th Annual Fall Conference. In April, our Regional Panels give presentations on assigned agenda items at our Annual Mini Conference. By meeting often in 2009 the six Regional Panels submitted five Agenda Items to the area assembly. Three of those were approved and forwarded to the General Service Board to be considered for inclusion on this year's General Service Conference Agenda. Area 29 is excited to have been selected to host a hospitality suite at the 2010 International Convention. I am so grateful for the work Area 29 does and honored to represent its groups at the 60th General Service Conference.—*Nancy Bagley*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31, Western Massachusetts, extends from Greater Springfield to the New York, Connecticut, and Vermont borders. It has six districts, 323 active groups, and approximately 5,500 members. We have six standing committees; Archives, Grapevine, Accessibility, P.I., C.P.C., and the Round-Up Committee. The one-day "Round Up" in May allows the delegate to give the area a report on the highlights of the General Service Conference. There are four Invited committees; Western Mass. Young Peoples Conference Committee, Institutions Committee, Western Mass. Intergroup, and Berkshire Intergroup. Each district and committee is visited monthly by either the area chair, the alternate delegate, or the delegate. We believe this puts us closer to the heartbeat and col-

lective conscience of Area 31 in real-time. Two two-day area assemblies occur in the Spring and Fall; The Spring Assembly is a mini-Conference, held 4-6 weeks prior to the General Service Conference; the format resembles the General Service Conference committee process, with a past delegate chairing each committee, if possible. After reviewing and discussing specific agenda items, committee reports are given, providing the delegate a sense of the area's conscience regarding those agenda items. The Fall Assembly consists of workshops, panels, fellowship, and an "open-mike/Ask-it-Basket," with our past delegates sharing their collective experience. An area business meeting occurs on Sunday of each assembly. The Area committee provides service commitments to groups at their request. Members of the Area committee share their experience, strength and hope, as well as how their service experience has strengthened their recovery and sobriety. Area 31 is currently developing a Web site. In the interim, area information can be found on the Web site of the greatest Intergroup Office in the world! Intergroup also hosts an active "bookie" committee where groups can schedule incoming and outgoing meetings. Area 31 co-hosts, with our neighbors Area 30-Eastern Mass, an annual State Convention in November. Last year, we had approximately 1,000 registered participants. The State of Massachusetts, Areas 30 and 31 combined, will be hosting the upcoming Northeast Regional Forum in 2011, as well as a Hospitality Suite at the International Convention in San Antonio. In conclusion, I want to thank Area 31 for the opportunity to serve them as their delegate at this General Service Conference. It is truly an honor!—*Chip Kronoff*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 (The western half of Michigan's Lower Peninsula and the eastern half of the Upper Peninsula from the Straits of Mackinaw to the beautiful Locks of the Soo). Area 34 consists of more than 550 groups in fifteen mostly rural districts and one linguistic district. We currently have eleven committees who actively work to make sure the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous is there whenever anyone, anywhere reaches out. We are especially active in corrections work and are talking about how to proceed with Bridging the Gap, as well as continuing efforts with special needs, including the needs of the elderly and the vulnerable member. Our area covers more than 400 miles end-to-end and we hold area assemblies on a monthly basis, rotating location throughout the districts. Generally, in any given month, more than eleven districts are in attendance. This gives more members the opportunity to participate in work in our area and be part of the service structure. All who attend the assembly are allowed to participate, unless it is an election assembly, and this has worked well for us in trying to build unity and encourage participation. We have incorporated a Finance Committee to help us explore ways to better use our resources to help carry the message and are finding this to be very helpful. We recently had the opportunity to host the East Central Regional Forum and enjoyed participating with that. We also participate with the other two areas in our state (Areas 32 and 33) in statewide meetings on a quarterly basis, with one being conducted at our State Convention. As a unified statewide group we have a Corrections Committee that works together to help ensure that prison meetings are covered, correspondence is handled timely, and that members being released are able to get to a meeting. We work together to hold a Mock Conference in March of each year to keep the voice in our groups and to send our delegates to the General Service Conference informed; we also rotate the State Convention among the three areas each year. Area 34 is currently gearing up to host this year's Convention.—*Mel Lawson*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 covers the northern half of Minnesota. We have 531 registered groups and 18 districts in an area that spreads over 69,000 square miles. We begin every year with a January area service workshop using the theme and presentation topics from the Conference. We have five area elected officers: delegate, alternate delegate, secretary, treasurer and area chairperson. Our area chairperson appoints our nine action committee chairs with recommendations from the present action committee chairs and area officers. We hold two assemblies annually, a spring and a fall assembly. Our area is split into four geographic zones where our workshops and assemblies are rotated from zone to zone to give every member the opportunity to experience events without having to travel vast distances. We also have four area committee meetings annually, held at the same central location to keep communication lines open. We hold four zonal forums, covering each zone in a two-year period, where our five area officers put on presentations and answer questions and address concerns from our Fellowship. Also, each committee chair is required to hold four workshops in the four zones over a two-year period. We believe that these forums and workshops keep our Fellowship informed, encourage participation, and strengthen unity so that together we may better achieve our singleness of purpose. All information on Conference agenda items and background material, once received, are forwarded expeditiously to the area to allow time for discussion at group, district, and area levels. At our spring assembly, we allow time to go over every agenda item so our delegate will be informed about our area's considerations. We continue to communicate, at all levels of service, the importance of financial support to all entities, responsibility of serving our Fellowship and Alcoholics Anonymous and maintaining our singleness of purpose. My participation in A.A.'s service structure has provided many opportunities for growth and learning, and I look forward to serving with all of you trusted servants at this Conference. May we do the best we can for our Fellowship and for Alcoholics Anonymous. God Bless.—*Jon Curphy*

Mississippi: Area 37 is comprised of 24 districts and 316 groups. We have an area assembly that meets in a central location four times per year and there is not a rotating location. We currently have a one-day assembly. We also have an area or state convention that rotates around the state once per year. Dick and Ruth B. brought A.A. to the state of Mississippi in 1946. I have heard reports that A.A. is not growing. Well that is not true in Area 37. New groups appear and we have strong growth in established groups causing a great increase in meeting frequency. We also have had our Spanish-speaking groups take hold and grow. The young people of Area 37 are growing by leaps and bounds and becoming very involved in service, promising a bright future for Area 37. We conduct an area inventory every two years and have 11 standing committees. We have a state Web site and a quarterly newsletter, which is making the transition from paper to electronic. We also have instituted a pre-Conference assembly in the past two years so our delegates will have better feel for the conscience of our area before they go to Conference.—*Tom Kepner*

Nebraska: Area 41 has 636 registered groups and 32 districts and we have one Spanish linguistic district. Our area is a mixture of rural and urban communities. Our area committee meets quarterly for two days with an Area Reunion in June to hear the Delegate's Report, and meet new and old friends. Area 41 started the process to adopt a committee system based on the General Service Conference Committee structure in January of 2005. This past November the standing committees elected this

term's chairpersons from within their respective committees. We still continue to fine-tune the process and we are updating our area service handbook to include all the changes. Area 41 has a Web site (www.aaofneb.org) with a meeting finder to search by district or town, an event calendar with flyers and area functions, password protected member services, and links to the G.S.O. and Grapevine Web sites. We hold an area inventory in the even numbered years with participation by all attendees to our September meeting. Our area publishes an Area 41 "Where & When." Members of the Area 41 standing committees travel the area to other A.A. events to provide literature, Grapevine materials, and the Archives display. We hold four "4-Corners Workshops" throughout the state during the year to allow those who are not able to attend the area meetings a chance to meet the standing committee chairpersons and officers. This past March meeting our area had a discussion of the General Service Conference Agenda Items, to help the area and the delegate to be better informed.—*Leon Arps*

New Brunswick/PEI: Hi, my name is Jean-Claude Cormier, Panel 60, Area 81 NB & PEI et je suis un alcoolique. Bonjour a tous et à toutes. Area 81 has 12 districts with 183 groups, which comprises New Brunswick and Prince Edward Island plus one group in Nova Scotia, all this in Eastern Canada. Area 81 includes two federal prisons (maximum security) and one minimum security, plus a number of provincial jails. Area 81 also has a number of detox centres, (I believe eight), where the A.A. message is being carried by A.A. members on a regular basis. Even if we are a small and poor area, all the needed structures are in place to effectively deliver the A.A. message to the still suffering alcoholics by means of area chairs and committee members. Most of our districts have an answering service for A.A. related calls, be it a cell phone or a more conventional answering service. Many groups have road signs giving a phone number for people in need of help and it has proven to be a great help. Area 81 holds four meetings per year with two of these meetings combined with a three day round up. Most of our districts hold monthly meetings or bimonthly meeting ensuring the A.A. message is still being carried to those in need. La région 81 est une région bilingue, donc nos documents sont traduits dans les deux langues ; français et anglais. Les minutes des réunions de la région sont également traduites dans les deux langues et ce bénévolement. Lors de nos assemblées de région, les participants peuvent s'exprimer dans la langue de leur choix et l'essentiel est traduit de sorte que chacun.e puissent comprendre. Mon souhait pour la région 81 est de voir à ce que plus de groupes contribuent à la fois au district, à la région et à bureau des services généraux. (GSO) Bonne réunion à tous et à toutes, I wish each and every one of you a great meeting and thanks for allowing me to serve my fellow alcoholics.—*Jean-Claude Cormier*

New Hampshire: Area 43 encompasses the entire state of New Hampshire. From our first official A.A. group in 1947, we have grown to 15 districts, serving 587 groups. Area 43 has nine active standing committees: Archives, Corrections, Finance, Functions, Literature/Grapevine, Hotline, P.I./C.P.C., Service Office, and Treatment. Our Area 43 Service Office serves the entire state and has two part-time paid staff members. The area office acts as a focal point for all area activities, sells Conference-approved literature, and hosts our various committee meetings. We also are very proud of our Area 43 Web site, which maintains a data base of meetings and area information, which helps unify and inform our members. We have an excellent monthly newsletter produced through our Area Service Office called the "Pipeline." Area 43 has four quarterly area assemblies per year,

hosted by rotating districts. Two assemblies are Pre- and Post-Conference, presided over by our delegate; we typically see the greatest attendance at our Pre-Conference Assembly. The third assembly is for elections in odd numbered years and an area inventory in even numbered years. Because of the reasonable travel distances within our state, our assemblies are normally one day events. Highlights of the Area: Recently, after a period of disagreement, misinformation, acrimony and continuing controversy, Area 43 hosted a Unity Weekend. The area assembled a workshop panel of past and present trustees, as well as a G.S.O. staff person. The purpose was to bring our Traditions and Concepts to bear on the problems through a series of open workshops. The result was a gratifying success. Members in our Area explored the Traditions and Concepts, resulting in increased education, tolerance, and unity. The panel helped Area 43 members understand that we can disagree agreeably, put personalities aside, and ultimately do what is best for A.A. The day's sessions were followed with a Unity Dinner. Coincidentally, following the Unity Weekend experience, our State AA Convention, held a year ago in April, had the theme of "Love and Tolerance—The Path to Unity." Our Fellowship in Area 43 has become more active and involved in Service at all levels because of the growing events of the last two years. I am happy to say Area 43 is working hard to carry the message to alcoholics, as well as to educate and develop our members as current and future trusted servants.—*Richard Purtell*

New Jersey (Southern): Hello, my name is Elaine, and I am an alcoholic. I have the privilege of serving as Panel 60 delegate to the General Service Conference for Area 45, Southern New Jersey. Area 45 covers that part of the state that includes the capital city of Trenton at our northern end, to the historic seashore town of Cape May at its southern-most tip. We have 476 groups supporting 587 meetings, and serving 7,100 members in 24 districts. We meet quarterly in a combined assembly/committee meeting, which rotates its location throughout the area. Having just added a Committee for outreach to the Hispanic Community, as well as a Hospitality Committee for the 2010 International Convention, co-hosted with Area 44. Area 45 now has 19 active committees. In the early spring, we hold our annual Convention, as well as a mini-Conference to prepare our delegate for the General Service Conference. We take a fearless inventory of ourselves every other year and join with our three Intergroups for an Annual Day of Sharing in the fall. Our Jal-Con Committee coordinates our participation in the state Al-Anon Convention, thus honoring the spirit of cooperation with that entity. Our Young People's Committee strives to keep us all "young at heart" with various social activities. Our CTF Committee hosts an Inter-Area Conference each year and works to bring the message of hope to those who are incarcerated. Our Bridging the Gap Committee helps those newly released make the transition to A.A. meetings outside their institution. Our C.P.C. Committee often joins with Area 44's C.P.C. to bring the recovery message to statewide conferences for professionals. P.I. works diligently to provide information on what A.A. is and what it is not to the general public. Our Grapevine Committee strives to increase awareness of our "meeting in print." We recently celebrated our first Grape-Fest and it was well-received. Our Web site and our Fourth Dimension Newsletter keep us informed of local events. Area 45 will be host for the 2011 NERD. For that event, and anytime, we welcome you to visit us in Area 45, Southern New Jersey, where, through Recovery, Unity and Service, "we have found ourselves in a new dimension"—the current theme of Area 45.—*Elaine McAndrews*

New Mexico: Area 46 is comprised of the state of New Mexico, the 5th largest state in the nation. There are 19 districts, two of which are Spanish. District 19 was added in 2009 and is the second Spanish district. Over the last few years we have seen an increase in the participation of the Spanish groups in our area assemblies and in 2009 these groups hosted the International Hispanic Convention in Albuquerque over Labor Day weekend. There were over 3,000 people in attendance, both Spanish and English-speaking, with translation provided by the Area Bilingual Committee, so everyone could enjoy all the events. Area 46 has three assemblies each year, March, September and December, and districts bid one year in advance to host an assembly. An area convention is held in June and again districts bid for the opportunity to host the event. 2009 brought about a couple of changes in the committee structure of our area with the dissolving of the position of Convention Liaison and the restructuring of the Finance Committee, resulting in the appointment of a chair for this committee, a position that had previously been filled by the area treasurer. The Convention Committee is now chaired by the person chairing the current year's convention and the job of acting as a liaison has fallen on the shoulders of the area chair. Area 46 is already working diligently on plans for hosting the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in 2012. This event will be held in Albuquerque on the third weekend of October and we invite one and all to come witness A.A. service in action and to visit New Mexico, the Land of Enchantment.—*Marsha Slane*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Hello ¡Hola! Bon Jour. My name is Deb Domack and I am an alcoholic. I am honored and privileged to serve as the Panel 60, Area 48 delegate from Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire. HMB as we call it—gets its name from its region's waterways and geographical location. We surround the Hudson River Valley north and south, the Mohawk River Valley east and west and we border the Berkshires of Massachusetts to the East. HMB's geographic area is the largest of the four A.A. service areas contained in New York State. In A.A. history, HMB is one of the original Areas designated by our first Conference Charter. Of note: HMB had Delegate representation on Panel 1, and since then, on all even numbered panels. The first local A.A. gathering—as well as the first HMB Convention—was held at the Crooked Lake Hotel in Rensselaer County. Currently HMB has 18 districts with over 750 registered groups. Our oldest active group is the Glens Falls Original Group, founded in June 1939. The Kingston Original Group, where I was introduced to general service, is the second oldest, founded in September 1941. Our land mass was originally settled by Native American tribes, including the Mohawks and Senecas, and is now a melting pot of cultures and races. In fact, today our A.A. membership continues to mirror that diversity. Our area conducts seven annual meetings that rotate around the area. Our meetings include an Inventory Day, a Day of Sharing and Fellowship Days. In the fall, we hold our annual Area convention. In addition, Area 48 participates with the three other New York state areas to conduct the Annual State Convention, as well as an Informational Service Workshop. HMB hosted the Northeast Regional Delegates Reunion in March of this year and will be hosting the Northeast Regional A.A. Service Assembly in 2012. As delegate I am grateful for the support given to me by our many active past delegates, our current elected and appointed servants, our D.C.M.s and others active in service. Our trusted servants are always busy—helping both our A.A. members and our non-A.A. friends. We are blessed to have an enthusiastic and hard working bunch—all who have discovered that "Service is the Secret!" I am humbled by the opportunity to serve Area 48—Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire. I pray that my Higher Power continues to bless Alcoholics Anonymous, and each of you.—*Deb Domack*

New York (Western): Area 50 is comprised of 22 districts and four Intergroups/Central Committees, serving about 500 meetings/groups. We are a dark area as only three districts are represented at assembly, with more interest being shown to open more. To this end the active districts will be hosting Days of Sharing to encourage participation. Our Intergroup structure consists of Buffalo Central Committee, which runs the Central Office, has all standing committees and the Web site buffalooany.org. They publish a monthly newsletter and schedules for about 400 meetings and hold an annual Fall Convention. Niagara Intergroup prints schedules, has Treatment and Corrections Committees, has an e-mail niagaraintergroup@gmail.com and hosts a Spring Convention. Jamestown, NY PENN and Genesee/Wyoming print schedules and hold Days of Sharing. All Intergroups are invited to send liaisons to assembly. Area 50 committee chairs coordinate activities with the Intergroups and report to assembly. The area P.I. Committee chair also hosts an information booth at the Erie County Fair, which will happen again after a two year hiatus. Our assembly meets seven times a year with a special meeting in September of odd years to facilitate elections.—*John Czermernys*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeast): Area 55 currently covers 17 districts in Northwest Ohio and Southeast Michigan. Toledo is the hub of activity in Area 55, which is located near the southwestern shore of Lake Erie. Our boundaries are Monroe County, Michigan to the north, Lima, Ohio to the south, Sandusky, Ohio to the east, and the Ohio/Indiana state border to the west. Our area includes over 4,500 members in 17 districts, 380 groups and over 500 meetings a week. General Service Area 55 contains two Intergroup Associations, one in Toledo and one in Monroe, Michigan. The Toledo Intergroup finances the Central Office that our General Service cooperates with. Area 55 has eight living past delegates, who are frequently asked for their experience, strength and hope. We have six standing committees: Archives, Special Needs, Group Services, C.P.C./P.I., Multi-District Corrections, and Grapevine. We currently hold monthly assembly meetings in the downtown Toledo area. In past years we have taken the summer months off, however we found that our responsibilities were year round and that alcoholism is a 24/7 disease. The Area 55 Archives is in its third year of a preservation project to record the history of our “long timers” and is also currently working on an Archives Display to be located in our Central Office. A goal over the next two years is for the area to increase participation of all of our districts, and possibly a redistricting of our area. We recently discussed with Area 32 (Central Michigan) the possibility of transferring two counties in Michigan to their area since they have been servicing the groups there for over 10 years. As always, our goals are to foster unity between the Intergroup Association and the local general service, and to grow and remain responsive to change so we may be of maximum service to those we serve and those yet to come to our Fellowship.—*Louie Bellner*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 is dedicated to provide service to A.A. members and groups in Southwestern Ohio. We serve approximately 20,000 members in over 500 registered groups. The area meets monthly, rotating between voting assemblies and working committee meetings. Our first committee meeting of the year is a Unity Day workshop where we collaborate with our 30 districts and two Intergroup Offices, as well as enjoy a wonderful potluck lunch. Area 56 hosts a mini-conference in March focusing on the General Service Conference agenda items, with in-depth committee discussion and reporting. Because this is used as a means of both disseminating and gathering information, there is no

charge to attend our mini-conference. It is paid for through group contributions to the area throughout the year. Area 56 also collaborates with three other areas in our state, attending their mini-conferences, participating in quarterly Ohio State Convention planning meetings and hosting the Ohio State Convention on a rotating basis. A.A. is alive and well in Southwest Ohio thanks to the humble service of so many dedicated members in our area. I am grateful to represent Southwest Ohio at the General Service Conference.—*Alicia Rosselot*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has about 570 groups in 24 districts and a membership of approximately 11,000 alcoholics. Our area is serviced yearly with two assemblies which are centrally located in our area, and three or four business meetings, which we move throughout our districts. We interact well with our neighbours and adjacent areas. The 14 Canadian areas and Alaska have formed an Inter-Area Remote Communities Work Group to deal with the Remote Communities to the far North. Area 86 plays a supportive role in that respect. We have a Unity Day, which is a biannual event that we share with Area 83 Eastern Ontario International. Our chairman of the board and our general manager have been invited guests in the past. The four areas in Ontario already meet once a year so we can give the incoming Delegate(s) an idea of what this Conference is all about. We, along with the other nine areas in the Eastern Canada Region, are in the process of creating a Regional Service Assembly. On the home front we cover approximately 100,000 square kilometers (60,000 square miles). We like to think we are a vibrant area covering all genres of the working force, everyone from a low bottom drunk to a CEO of a notable organization. Of course the automotive industry plays a large part in our economics. We are just now starting to feel the crunch of the recent recession that our neighbours to the south have felt these past few years. Keeping our primary purpose in mind of carrying the message to the alcoholic that still suffers is always first and foremost. Area 86 is doing just that by seeing that all the available tools of recovery get to our groups and to the people in the trenches that need them the most while doing their and our most important job—that Twelfth Step call.—*Dean Thrasher*

Oregon: Since our last Conference highlights, the area body has approved a new Translation and Interpretation standing committee and a third Spanish-speaking district, which encompasses members in and around Salem, our State's capitol. The new Spanish district cooperates with a third Spanish Intergroup office, also in Salem. In total, we now have 37 districts representing just over 1,000 groups and just under 20,000 members. Our Area Committee consists of the 37 D.C.M.s, eight elected officers, ten standing committees and a nonvoting Web site committee. Geographically, Area 58 includes the entire State of Oregon, with the exception of one small section at the eastern border whose groups choose to participate in Idaho Area 18. We also include a few groups from Southwest Washington and Northern California. One district, in a very remote and sparsely populated part of the state, has not actively participated in area assemblies for many years, although meetings are being held on a regular basis. Our newly elected area officers are dedicated to trying once again to reach out to this district and encourage participation. Two years ago the area experimented with a new format for preparing the delegate for the Conference. Each district was randomly assigned to a “Conference Committee.” At our February Quarterly Service Assembly, districts discussed and became familiar with the agenda items for their Conference Committee. They were asked to take the agenda items back to their districts and continue those discussions with the home

groups. By mid-April they supplied a summary to the alternate delegate, who compiled the information for the delegate prior to the Conference. The results have been positive in that more group members and districts are becoming involved with the Conference process, including the Mill Creek Group, which is located inside the Oregon State Penitentiary and celebrated 65 years of continuous meetings last May.—*Anne Meader*

Puerto Rico: In 1947 the message of A.A. arrived at Puerto Rico. The first group opened its doors in 1950. The Fellowship expanded slowly, but surely, one day at a time. Today, there are 120 groups covering the whole island, and nine districts contributing to the growth and well-being of the groups. One Central Office is working for the whole community of 1,500 members. Area 77 is alive and stretching to every corner of the country. The area has monthly meetings in different groups throughout the region. Five area assemblies are held every two years. Annually, there is a convention and other activities, like a seminar, end of the year celebration, and a family gathering festivity. A monthly bulletin, "The Awakening," informs the whole Fellowship about anniversaries, events and group news. Also, it includes the voice of the people in A.A. Every two years we celebrate the birthday of A.A. with a big meeting, and this year is one of them. Our Web site, aa-pr.org, has been a great addition to the tools we put into action to fulfill the Fifth Tradition. It is getting thousands of hits every month from around the world and from our own backyard. Bridging The Gap and Correctional Facilities committees are among the fastest growing squads in the past years. This year we held, for the first time, a past delegates and newly elected delegate get together, and it was a success. The continuous practice of recovery, unity and service takes the message of A.A. to sunless places and lights them up. The A.A. Message: powerful, unifying, timeless.—*Inocencio Fernandez*

Quebec (Northwest): Hi, my name is Richard Boisvert; I am an alcoholic, delegate Panel 60, Area 90, Northwest Quebec. It is a privilege to be here and talk about our beautiful area. Area 90 extends from Ottawa, Ontario (French groups) from the West, to Joliette, Quebec to the East, and from Metropolitan Boulevard to the South, to Alert to the North, which is north of the 80th Parallel in the Eastern Arctic. We have approximately 380 groups, which are mostly French and located in 25 districts. We have six standing committees: Correction Centers, Treatment Facilities, Public Information, La Vigne A.A. (French version of Grapevine), Area 90 News Bulletin and Publications. We have four work groups—Archives, Web site, Sharing Sessions on A.A. Services and Remote Communities, which was approved unanimously by the Area Committee back in 1994. Our Remote Communities work group encompasses those groups or members that are located in communities, which are defined as being remote due to language, culture and geography. These were also approved by the area committee as District 27, Nunavik-Nunavut in 2001. Fourteen communities are from the Nunavik Region (Northwest Quebec) and ten communities are from the Nunavut Region, located north of the 60th Parallel. Languages spoken are English and Inuktitut. Two communities that are geographically located in Area 89, Northeast Quebec, and one community located in Area 80, Manitoba, are serviced by Area 90 as per an agreement in the past with those area service delegates. In a year we have six area committee meetings consisting of all the D.C.M.s committees chairs and our working groups. We also have a welcoming assembly for new servants and two general assemblies where all the G.S.R. are invited to participate and express their concerns. Our main goal is to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholics and our contributions to Tradition Seven show it.—*Richard Boisvert*

Quebec (Southwest): Providing a stimulating diversity, Area 87 is a magnificent part of Québec, one of four A.A. Areas in the province. Southwestern Quebec is the most densely populated area considering it covers only 80 Radius kilometres (49.7 Radius miles). It is also a bilingual area (French and English) with a membership of about 15,000, the vast majority being French-speaking. Area 87 includes 29 districts: 21 French-speaking, seven English-speaking and one Hispanic district. Some 550 groups hold more than 600 weekly meetings, with about 50 of them being held in treatment or correctional facilities. We organize seven area meetings and three area assemblies every year. Simultaneous translation from French to English is always provided during these gatherings. Fourteen committees are engaged in the carrying of the message. Some committees are French-speaking, others are English-speaking and a few are bilingual. Our most recently-created committee is the Web site committee. It is bilingual, with Spanish-speaking members' participation. This medium is likely already playing an important role in carrying the A.A. message and will increasingly in the future. The Web is at the heart of a lot of discussion and reflection throughout the Conference and I invite you to share our unique experience by visiting our area Web site at www.aa-quebec.org/region87. Along with the three other delegates from Québec, we sit on the board of La Vigne AA, a bi-monthly French language A.A. magazine, which has been published since 1965. Through the display of Attraction, Love and Tolerance within our area, we will certainly put into practice the principles of A.A. and pursue the path of unity. I'd like to thank the A.A. members of Area 87 for allowing me an opportunity to live this unique, unreal experience, which I will carry for my lifetime.—*Jules Roussy*

Rhode Island: Area 61 consists of eight districts, seven geographical and one linguistic. We have approximately 250 groups, 550 meetings and 5,300 members. All districts are active, although some have limited participation. The area is actively staffing all of the committees with volunteers. All of the committees are working hard and last year Area 61 had a growth in Grapevine sales due to the efforts of our Grapevine committee. Our Treatment and Correctional committees are supporting more than 300 meetings monthly. Our area committee meets monthly in order to keep the districts and subcommittees informed. Area 61 holds four yearly assemblies, using April as our pre-Conference assembly. We decided at our October assembly to incorporate and file for federal tax exempt status in order to comply with new federal regulations. In the months when we don't have an assembly, each district takes a turn sponsoring a monthly "Joy of Service" meeting, hosted by different groups, to help spread the word about service. Our annual convention, held in March, continues to be a huge success and sells out months before the event. This year was our 34th annual convention. Each September we hold an annual Roundup. Our Roundup is a service oriented day of workshops, sharing and fellowship. In 2009, contributions were up slightly and for the first time in a long time, the area was able to subsidize the entire budget. We are hopeful that this is a direct result of spreading the word that a dollar in the basket is no longer sufficient to be self-supporting. We have a Central Service office and a Southern Rhode Island Intergroup. Together, with the Area committee, we have formed a joint committee called the Unity Committee. We meet once a month to keep each entity informed about what the others are doing. There is also a large contingent of Rhode Islanders heading to San Antonio for the 13th International Convention. All in all Area 61 is alive and well and it is my honor and privilege to serve them as delegate.—*Gregory Cooper*

South Carolina: Area 62, the state of South Carolina, is divided into 24 districts with 335 registered groups serving over 8,500 members. In 2009, the assembly approved the formation of our first linguistic district, serving 10 Spanish-speaking groups. Our group contribution rate remains above average, with over 57% of our groups contributing. Our two-day area assemblies are held three times a year in a central location. We have challenged our committee chairpersons to focus on activities that directly affect an alcoholic's ability to find sobriety, rather than simply meeting to review the last meeting or to plan the next meeting. In response, the C.P.C. Committee has conducted workshops statewide to assist our groups in working with local professionals, and made presentations to conferences of professionals in our coastal region. Our Corrections Committee has made real progress toward a uniform admission policy for A.A. visitors. Communication with the Department of Corrections has improved through one-on-one meetings and presentations to prison officials. Our Treatment Committee's "Bridge the Gap" program recently made contact with over 100 facilities in our state and organized A.A. contacts in every district. The Area Web site continues to assist over 5,000 unique visitors per month and is being revised to improve accessibility. The focus of our area newsletter, "Keep in Touch," has been shifted to emphasize and encourage our service efforts. Finally, we look forward to another opportunity to serve by hosting the Southeast Regional Forum later this year.—*David M. Thatch*

South Dakota: Area 63 is excited to be hosting the Special Regional Forum ("Singleness of Purpose: Carrying A.A.'s Message to the Native American") this November 12, 13 & 14 at the Ramkota in Rapid City, South Dakota. Area 63 has 15 districts with 13 currently active at the area level. There are approximately 140 registered groups, with approximately 96 of these groups active at the district level. Our groups are predominately white, English-speaking, with a substantial Native American population. We have two conferences and two service workshops each year. The conferences are hosted by district committees and are currently split between East and West River communities. The service workshops are centrally located. Area 63 uses a committee service structure composed of nine committees. Our G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, Area Committee chairs and area officers make up our voting members. All members are strongly encouraged to participate in our service structures. Area 63 continues to be challenged in reaching the remote communities and maintaining an active district service structure in rural areas. Area 63 is not unlike any other area whereas people active in district and area service work can be discouraged at times. The area is very cognizant of the importance of administrative work to the continuation of A.A. and at the same time we are constantly working in the trenches carrying out our primary purpose—To carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.—*Dean Bahr*

Tennessee: Area 64 consists of the entire state of Tennessee and portions of Virginia and Alabama. Tennessee is the birthplace of the blues and rock and roll, the home of country music, and is known as the Volunteer State, has a population of 5,900,962. Area 64 has 41 Districts of which 39 are geographical and two are linguistic, 538 A.A. groups, of which 523 are English-speaking and 15 are Spanish-speaking; 535 are in the state of Tennessee, two in Virginia and one in Alabama. We have four Quarterly area assemblies and usually a State convention each year. They move around the area, any district or districts that have an interest in hosting an assembly or convention makes a bid to the assembly body. The assembly body considers each bid and votes on which district will host them. We have six standing committees at the

area level, where we disseminate information and some literature to the local committees to help them better carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous. Between assemblies our standing committees put on workshops across the area, sometimes hosted by or in conjunction with districts and sometimes on their own, like our Corrections Committee and Treatment Committees Annual Workshops. All Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service, are alive and well in Area 64.—*Don Autry*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66, Northwest Texas, is one of the four areas in the state. We cover roughly 96,000 square miles. Our largest district geographically is almost the size of the state of Maine! It has only seven groups and approximately 100 members. There are a total of eleven districts, three of which are Spanish speaking. We rotate our assemblies on a two year schedule among the five largest cities in the area. We usually have around 60 people at the assemblies; roughly twenty percent are Spanish speaking. Our bilingual committee translates the assemblies and helps with the Web site documents. We have twelve standing committees. Our Corrections committee just finished a project of adding both English and Spanish Big Books, Twelve and Twelve, and "It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell" to some of the prisons in need. We have a short, snappy, monthly newsletter. Our Archive committee attends most conferences in the area. They also participate each year at the state convention. The Spanish district continues to carry the message to the sometimes dangerous treatment centers in old Mexico. An ongoing project has been the updating of our Web site. The vast size and small population can be challenging. By constant contact, using e-mail, phone and our web site, members keep in touch on a regular basis, and keep moving forward in carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Tim Bryson*

Texas (Southwest): Area 68 covers approximately 77,650 square miles in the southwest section of Texas. Area 68 is the second largest of the four Texas areas. We have 506 active English groups and 81 active Spanish groups. Out of the 33 districts in our area, seven serve our Spanish groups. We meet quarterly on a rotating basis for two workshops and two voting assemblies. Once a year our area holds a C.F.C. Conference as well as a P.I./C.P.C. Conference. All our events, our newsletter, minutes, flyers, etc. are translated into Spanish. We have seven very active standing committees: Archives, Bilingual, C.F.C., Grapevine/LaVina, Newsletter, P.I./C.P.C. and Treatment. Area 68 conducts an inventory held at our July Workshop every odd numbered year. We are especially pleased with the progress that has been made on our Web site; and are grateful for the technical talent in our Fellowship. Now for an exciting Area 68 highlight....a great event will come to pass for us this July as we will be the host area for the 13th International A.A. Convention, which will be held in San Antonio, my hometown. You can be sure that the enthusiasm is overwhelming in San Antonio, as well as in the great State of Texas. Our Area 68 officers and I are planning a luncheon at the celebration of A.A.'s 75th Anniversary for all current and past delegates and trustees. We hope to see you there. There is no doubt that the International A.A. Convention will be an instrument of principled unity in Area 68. Viva San Antonio!!!—*Char*

Vermont: Area 70 is the entire state of Vermont, pristine, rugged and rural—only recently have people finally outnumbered cows. We have 11 districts (9 energetic and connected, one "sleepy" but active on the local level, and one disconnected). As we have no intergroup or area central office, our districts provide essential services, such as hotlines, local meeting lists, and other Twelfth Step committee work. Before our four full area assemblies there



The five members of G.S.O.'s Mailing and Shipping Department (all nonalcoholics) represent 170 years of service. Standing, Aubrey Pereira, supervisor, 28 years; Frank Smith, asst. supervisor, 30 years; Bill Heinitz, 31 years. Front row, Joe Moglia, the only G.S.O. employee who was here when Bill W. was, 44 years; and Ronnie Shelton, 37 years.

is a Service Structure Presentation, Committee Roundtables, and a meeting where D.C.M.s and the delegate share problems, successes, and information. A Spring Pre-conference reviews the General Service Conference agenda items and forms a group conscience to guide our delegate. Our 47th Area Convention was held in early April at the resort that Bill W. frequented. Our challenges include realizing the full potential of technological tools, such as our Web site, aavt.org, and the Fellowship New Vision. Our current budget is "spiritual" as our desire to do our Twelfth Step work outweighs our contributions. Like our General Service Office, we are struggling to determine what services are most vital. Equally challenging, like many other areas, is filling all our service positions. Our area chair writes a short monthly newsletter, the "State of the State," detailing important area, regional, and G.S.O. information that our D.C.M.s carry back to their districts. Area 70, Vermont, is the Green Mountain State, and the birthplace of our co-founders. Dr. Bob was born in St. Johnsbury in the north, so let us greet you seven days a week at meetings at his birthplace. Yes, there is an "As Bill Sees It" meeting there, too. Or sit by the fireplace in meetings in East Dorset in the south, where Bill W. was born. Area 70 is rich in history and tradition, but there are no pedestals in Vermont: A.A. oldtimers still recall what a crummy fly fisherman Bill was.—*Chazz Collette*

Washington State East: Greetings from Washington State East, Area 92. We are a large area with 25 districts, which are located from Libby, Montana to Cle Elum, Washington, from Nakusp, British Columbia, to Riggins, Idaho, with a piece of Oregon thrown in to anchor the south. In Area 92, we speak English, French and Spanish. Four of our districts, are nongeographical linguistic districts, so our assemblies and quarterlies are conducted in Spanish and English. We are currently translating all of our area documents into Spanish. Our geography and diversity

pushes us to continue to reach out to suffering alcoholics across cultural and language boundaries. Area 92 and Oregon Area 58 still host the Pacific Northwest Conference, the oldest service conference in North America. The 61st Conference was held in Rossland, BC, in June of last year. As an area, we are young but strong in A.A.'s Traditions. Our service committees are active in providing information and meetings to those in institutions and treatment facilities. I am excited and honored to serve Area 92 and to join you in this adventure that is the Alcoholics Anonymous' General Service Conference.—*Jamie Shropshire*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula of Michigan: Area 74 currently has 654 registered groups and 24 districts. One district operates using the L.C.M. method to assist the D.C.M. This district has about 120 registered groups, which makes up about 20% of our areas' group totals. Area 74 is unique to other delegate areas in that its boundaries encompass two states—the Northern half of Wisconsin and the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. Our area has all of the standing committees in place with a chairperson for each committee. This includes an Area Web site with nine District Web sites. We also have an Area newsletter that has been in existence for at least 40 years. Our Webmaster operates within the Public Information committee and our Bridging the Gap coordinator works within the Treatment committee. Area 74 also has three Central Offices within its wide boundaries. We struggle with unity with some districts, due to our large Area (350 miles north to south and 200 miles east to west). In recent years we have implemented three D.C.M.s to serve on each of our eight standing committees. This in turn has promoted unity within our Area and has helped with carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. It has also strengthened our standing committees and hopefully promotes unity within our District. Area 74 operates a little differently than most other delegate areas. We hold two Conferences a year (spring and fall), and two assemblies a year. This year on our Spring Assembly agenda we are looking to add two more assemblies. We are also going to be doing an area inventory at our Spring Conference. I am hopeful that this will unify our districts with our area.—*Steve Hildeman*

Wyoming: Area 76 covers 97,100 square miles within the state of Wyoming. We currently have 12 districts and 109 registered groups, which include three Spanish-speaking groups. We hold two area assemblies and two area conventions per year. These events are hosted by various districts throughout the state, in an effort to provide each of our members with an opportunity to attend and participate in at least one of these events. Like many others, our area struggles with a lack of participation by some of our groups and their members. We are working to improve our communications with them and encourage their participation in all aspects of our area structure; as well as Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. In conjunction with this, we are trying to involve more members in our area committees and improve upon our assembly procedures. We are currently investigating the possibility of obtaining a state-wide, toll free phone line that would assist us in directing A.A. inquiries to the appropriate district contact. Our area Web site provides visitors with committee contact information, meeting schedules and events. Wyoming's towering mountains, vast plains and wide open spaces provide spectacular scenery and many places for potential A.A. members to hide out. At last census, our population was estimated at just over 544,000 people. It has been estimated that 10 percent of the population suffers from the disease of alcoholism. If this is true, we have plenty of work to do, because we certainly don't have 54,000 people attending our meetings!—*Allen Wharton*

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form with appreciation and made the following suggestions:

- Continue the daily color coding of the Evaluation Form.
- Add the date to each page.
- Bold Presentation Topics and Report Headings.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and accepted the revisions, including a minor change to the Photocopying Policy and new language to the section "What to Collect?," intended to provide more detailed information on the development of collection procedures for local use.

- The committee requested that the section "Role of the Archives Committee" in the Archives Workbook be revised to include:

- Suggested archives committees activities, to encourage interest in, and understanding of, the role and benefit of archives committees at the local level, for example: archives workshops, traveling exhibits, presentations and seeking out historical material from longtime A.A. members.
- Information for archives committees on how to implement, establish and support local archives.

- The committee accepted the report from the trustees' Archives Committee on the Feasibility of Developing a Self-guided Tour of G.S.O.'s Archives. The report included information from the archivist on the new Digital Archives Exhibit, which will be launched on the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

- The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities gather sharing from the Fellowship on the need to develop a sample format for one-on-one C.P.C. contact with professionals for inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook.
- The first bullet on page 14 in the C.P.C. Workbook, be revised to read: "Consider showing videos such as the C.P.C. video 'A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community,' 'Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous,' 'A.A. Videos for Young People,' at this point, or other videos appropriate for the audience."
- The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities explore including in the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook a service piece with Class A trustees' shared experiences em-

phasizing the value found in the continued use of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne.

- The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities explore including in the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook a sample letter which reinforces the value to professionals of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne as well as providing information on how the recipient may subscribe to the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne.

- The committee requested that the committee secretary and trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider creating a process by which professionals attending national C.P.C. exhibits can request follow up contact with local C.P.C. committees.

- The committee requested that the committee secretary and trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider adding to the *About A.A.* postal card a question to allow professionals to request follow-up contact with local C.P.C. committees.

- The committee requested that the committee secretary and trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities discuss developing a method by which appropriate C.P.C. pamphlets and other materials may be consolidated on cost effective digital media such as CD and DVD in order to be distributed to professionals.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Corrections on revising the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee expressed its sincere thanks for the work already done on this revision, and encouraged the trustees' committee to consider the following criteria when updating photos, as per the 2009 Advisory Action:

- photos reflecting the principle of attraction.
- photos that convey the varieties of age, ethnicity, gender, culture and beliefs that our Fellowship so richly enjoys.
- visual aspects other than photos (i.e., graphics, illustrations, etc.).

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Corrections on signing sponsorship agreements and legally binding documents and requested that the staff member continue to gather sharing on local solutions A.A. members may use to resolve perceived differences between facility rules/regulations and what A.A. is and is not.

- The committee reviewed changes to the Corrections Workbook and Corrections Guidelines forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Corrections and requested that applicable changes reflect updated language in Conference-approved literature.

- The committee discussed discrepancies in the contents of the French language Corrections Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections undertake an inventory of the contents of the Corrections Workbook in all three languages, and take appropriate steps to ensure consistency of content in these publications.

The committee also suggested that "missing" sections be translated as soon as possible and be made available as addendums until current inventory is depleted.

- The committee discussed at length the importance of having the Composition, Scope and Procedure for a particular Conference committee available in French or Spanish for any Conference committee member whose native language is not English.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed and discussed input from the Fellowship concerning the 2009 Conference Advisory Action that the trustees' Finance Committee gather input from the Fellowship on the following: (1) If we continue to use literature profits to fund services, should there be a limit? (2) If there is a limit how do we continue to pay for services if there is a shortfall in contributions? The committee recognized that the majority of the sharing of the Fellowship was not in favor of a limit. The committee does not recommend that a specific limit should be placed on the use of literature profits to fund services. From all input gathered, the committee found that the Fellowship agrees with the trustees' policy on self-support which was affirmed at the 2009 Conference:

Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous

The A.A. spiritual principle of self-support enables us to pursue our primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic with a shared sense of responsibility for our lifesaving work and without interference or financial dependence on outsiders. From our Fellowship's earliest days, the expenses of the General Service Office, and the world services provided by it, have exceeded the amount derived from contributions of A.A. groups and members. As a result, providing these needed services has necessarily been supported in part by income from the sale of A.A. literature. It is the policy of the General Service Board that income from literature sales should only be in amounts required to allow continued provision of vitally needed services and maintenance of a Prudent Reserve Fund. We hope that the day will come when A.A. groups and members, through their contributions, will be able to fund fully the services provided by the General Service Office. If that is achieved, revenues from literature sales will only be needed in amounts necessary to cover the actual costs associated with literature production and to maintain a Prudent Reserve Fund.

- The committee believes that more effective communication to the Fellowship as a whole is key to achieving this ideal and the committee has made recommendations to that end.
- The committee discussed additional ways to communicate with the Fellowship about Self-Support and forwards the following list of items to the 2011 Conference Finance Committee for further discussion:
 - 1) Birthday Plan.
 - 2) Seventh Tradition Pamphlet.
 - 3) Box 4-5-9 or Grapevine Articles.
 - 4) Finance Workbook/Tool Kit.
 - 5) Report Costs of Services to Members.
 - 6) Discuss Effects of Inflation.
 - 7) Add Additional Financial Information to the Web site.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the A.A. Grapevine Board's History of Advisory Actions Report pertaining to the relationship between the A.A. Grapevine Board, A.A. Grapevine office and the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine with appreciation and encourages this ongoing partnership and the continuation of the quarterly Conference Committee calls with the board and office, along with all of the board's recommendations in the Report, especially the board's recommendation for an annual report to the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested that electronic updates be made to outdated material, while still preserving a digital version of the historic document, and these updates should be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.
- The committee discussed at length and agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2011 or later:
 - Step by Step (working title): A collection of A.A. Grapevine stories on the Steps.
 - The Sponsorship Book (working title): A collection of stories on sponsorship.
 - Staying Sober Through Adversity (working title): A collection about handling the rough patches in sobriety.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee heard reports on the upcoming International Convention:
 - Over 37,000 people have registered for the Convention so far. About half of those have prepurchased the souvenir edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* and the Special Issue of the Grapevine magazine.
 - Preparations are in place for the anonymity-protected broadcast of the Friday night Flag Ceremony. Invitations have already been sent to many of the flag bearers who were selected at random from registered A.A. members from each country.
 - For the second time, registration for an International Convention was made available online. While paper communications continue in order to make sure everyone has access to International Convention information, a large percentage of our attendees registered and made housing reservations online.
 - Notices are being included in Convention materials and meeting formats to emphasize A.A.'s anonymity Traditions to attendees.
 - Efforts are being made to insure that attendees are prepared for the Convention experience, and understand the challenges of weather and of getting around very large facilities.
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' committee on the site-selection procedure for International Conventions, and expressed gratitude for the trustees' committee's willingness to continue to review and improve the process.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Forums and attract first-time attendees and suggested the following:
 - Create local flyers to carry the message about future Forums in the region.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- Utilize electronic communication from the areas to the Fellowship.
- Share about the Forum Orientation for first-time Forum attendees.
- Encourage members to bring others, such as sponsees, along to Forums.
- Coordinate fun "road trips" to Forums—"Fill the car; bring them all!"
- Share the Forum experience with others and with enthusiasm.
- Attraction, attraction, attraction!

LITERATURE

- The committee considered a request to define the editorial responsibility of G.S.O.'s Publications Department and took no action. The committee expressed appreciation for the request, noting the concern for Conference-approved literature and for the Conference process, and agreed that current practices followed by G.S.O.'s Publications Department are appropriate.
- The committee considered a request that the video, "Your General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure" be revised and updated and took no action. The committee noted that there was no widely expressed need for a new video and that the information in the video was still relevant and useful in describing the A.A. service structure.
- The committee considered a request to develop a book on the history of "early pioneer women in A.A." and took no action. The committee expressed appreciation for the request but considered that there was not a widely expressed need for a Conference-approved book on the history of early pioneer women in A.A.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

No additional committee considerations.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on the Agenda a request to hold a future General Service Conference on the theme "Anonymity in a Digital Age."
- The committee reviewed the 2009 Annual Report from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, noted that the Web site seemed to be very well managed, and appreciated that numerous steps previously required to get an item placed on the Web site have been streamlined.
- The committee suggested that particular consideration be given to developing a more effective distribution of Spanish and French language public service announcements to Spanish and French language stations, including exploring possible assignment of telecaster numbers to older public service announcements in Canada.
- The committee reviewed all of the current A.A. TV public service announcements and agreed with the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee that found them all to be relevant and useful.
- The committee assessed the need for a new A.A. TV public service announcement and agreed with the report of the

trustees' Public Information Committee that none was needed at this time. However, the committee recognized the need to have a public service announcement tracked and distributed on a yearly basis.

The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider developing a plan to redistribute and track an older A.A. T.V. public service announcement in the years when a new public service announcement is not being distributed.

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee replace the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" with the revised "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of "A.A. at a Glance."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop draft text on the topic of anonymity in a digital age for the Conference-approved pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" for review by the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop an answer to the question "What should I tell my loved ones about protecting the anonymity of the A.A. members they may meet?" for inclusion in the Conference-approved pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" as a new second question and answer in the section "Some questions and answers about anonymity/personal anonymity" on page 7. The draft text will be brought back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee suggested that delegates utilize a variety of means, such as workshops, newsletters, panels, delegate reports, area Web sites, etc., to stimulate A.A. members' discussion on how to maintain anonymity on online media, such as social networking sites.
- The committee discussed the "A.A. Guideline on the Internet" and suggested that it be more prominently placed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The committee expressed gratitude for the obvious time and commitment on the part of the trustees' Public Information Committee to the A.A. Videos for Young People Project and agreed with the trustees' suggestions that:
 - Use and distribution of videos from the A.A. Videos for Young People Project, including those already approved by the Conference, will be at the discretion of the trustees' Public Information Committee.
 - The trustees' Public Information Committee may group similar items, stream individual or multiple items on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, create DVD compilations, and produce video loops for use at C.P.C. events.
 - All video submissions that are not used in their entirety, with permission, will be kept on file at G.S.O. and may be edited for inclusion in future young people's video projects.
- The committee enthusiastically encourages continuation of the A.A. Videos for Young People Project. They suggested that the A.A. Videos for Young People Project submission form be listed periodically in the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña, and La Vigne.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that an issue of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña, or La Vigne be added to the contents of the kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed a report from the Publications Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2010-2011 Edition, and suggested two changes to the process.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed with appreciation the updates from the A.A. Grapevine Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed with appreciation the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed with appreciation the updates from the General Service Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publications Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and added additional updates.
- The committee agreed to add the sentence, "The Report and Charter Committee has reviewed and accepted these changes." to the note on the bottom of the page in *The A.A. Service Manual* that lists annual changes to the Manual (currently on page S123, 2009-2010 Edition).
- The committee considered a request to (a) publish and distribute *The A.A. Service Manual* every other year and in years not produced, distribute a supplement of changes, and (b) publish the A.A. directories (Canada, Eastern U.S. and Western U.S.) in alternate years when the *Service Manual* is not published and took no action. The committee noted the importance of publishing *The A.A. Service Manual* annually and that it be as current and accurate as possible.
- The committee considered a request that *The A.A. Service Manual* "be reprinted only as necessary and consider publishing every three to five years with changes being sent as inserts to existing manuals," and took no action.
- The committee considered a request to gather sharing from the Fellowship concerning the general nature of *The A.A. Service Manual* and took no action. The committee agreed that there was no widely expressed need for this sharing.
- The committee agreed to add the text "(see Chapter Eleven)" in the paragraph under the heading *Tools Available from G.S.O.* in Chapter One in *The A.A. Service Manual* so that the sentence reads: "They are designed to show groups the kind of help that is offered to groups everywhere by G.S.O., and thus get more people interested in service activity (see Chapter Eleven)."
- The committee considered a request to place *Additional Committee Considerations, Recommendations That Did Not Result in Advisory Actions and Floor Actions That Did Not Result in Advisory Actions* following the Advisory Actions in the Conference *Final Report*, and took no action. The committee agreed that the current placement in the *Final Report* continues to work well.

TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities regarding the proposed Special Needs recovery pamphlet and requested that:
 - In the first paragraph, second sentence under the proposed introduction "Do You Have a Drinking Problem?" other language be considered that is more special needs focused.
 - In all aspects of pamphlet development, the use of language that is inclusive of a wide variety of special needs be continued.
- The committee considered a suggestion to change the name of "Treatment Facilities" Committee to "Treatment" Committee and took no action. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities background which would include details regarding the impact of such a name change on, among other things: titles of relevant A.A. literature; contents of relevant A.A. literature; and the focus of A.A. service committee work.
- The committee considered two locally created Bridging the Gap forms (one for treatment clients and one for A.A. members willing to serve as temporary contacts) and requested that the trustees develop and include sample forms in the Treatment Facilities Workbook, taking into consideration exemplars from other local committees.
- Upon review of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook, the committee suggested that the following changes/additions be made where fiscally feasible:
 - The DVD *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be added in a hole-punched vinyl sleeve instead of in the current jewel box casing.
 - The Young People's videos be included in the Kit as a suggested tool for use with young people in treatment.
 - That suggestions for use of the two DVDs and the A.A. Grapevine be included in the Kit.
 - That changes be made in the Treatment Facilities Workbook to reflect that the A.A. message is carried to alcoholics in a wide variety of treatment settings, including outpatient settings.
- Upon review of the Special Needs Kit and Workbook, the committee suggested that:
 - The Kit be incorporated in a three-ring binder instead of the current pocket folder to achieve parity with other service Kits.
 - Shared experience with carrying the A.A. message to those with less visible challenges, such as illiteracy, autism, etc., be gathered and added to the Special Needs Workbook when feasible.

TRUSTEES

- The committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Report and Charter a request to clarify language and resolve inconsistencies in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding nominating a regional trustee and a trustee-at-large candidate in

the same year. They reviewed Conference Advisory Actions regarding this matter and suggested the following language, which reflects the policy decisions in those actions.

On page S65 of the 2009-2010 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the Regional Trustee Elections Procedures replace:

"2. Two Conference Actions should be kept in mind. In 1977, the Conference recommended that a delegate not be eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference. And in 1983, it was recommended that 'no area shall submit an individual as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large U.S./Canada in the same year.'"

With:

"2. Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

On page S67 of the 2009-2010 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the Trustees-at-Large Election Procedure replace:

"In the areas, the same procedure used in selecting a regional trustee candidate is followed. No area should submit the same name for regional and at-large trustee in the same year."

With:

"Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

Note: When these changes are made to *The A.A. Service Manual* the committee would ask that the trustees' Committee on Nominating consider using similar language in Procedure No. 11 "Procedure For Electing Regional Trustee Candidates in the U.S. and Canada" and No. 12 "Procedures For Electing A Candidate For trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada."

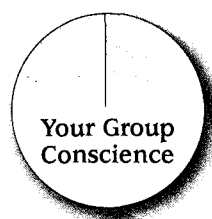
- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustee.
- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and updated the reference to "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities" found in their Scope to "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities."
- At present, in two regions (Southeast and East Central) the elections of regional and at-large trustee occur in the same year. Since no area can submit the same person as candidate for regional and at-large trustee in the same year, the committee feels that A.A. members in the two regions do not have the same opportunity for participation in our service structure as they do in the other six regions. In six of the regions the same person has the opportunity to stand for both regional and at-large trustee every four years. In the other two regions the same person has only the opportunity to stand for one of these two trustee positions every four years. Therefore, the committee requests that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore benefits and liabilities of allowing the same person to be submitted as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large at the same Conference.

- The committee discussed unplanned regional trustee vacancies that are left unfilled. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore the impact on the boards (General Service Board, A.A. World Services Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board) if a change in regional trustee rotation were to occur, and to bring a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Trustees.
- The committee discussed unplanned Class A and general service trustee vacancies that are left unfilled. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore the impact on the boards (General Service Board, A.A. World Services Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board) when such vacancies occur and bring a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

FINANCE

- The committee considered a request to replace the "pie chart" on page 12 with text in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" and recommended the following changes:
 - "AND" be replaced with "OR" between the pie charts that start on page 12 and an additional "OR" added after the second pie chart.
 - Replace the Q & A on page 13 with the text "Each group is autonomous and its informed conscience should determine the contribution amounts to the following entities: District, Area, G.S.O. and Intergroup/Central Office, if one services your locality" and insert an additional blank pie chart afterwards.



District	_____ %
Area	_____ %
G.S.O.	_____ %
Intergroup/Central Office	_____ %
Other	_____ %
Other	_____ %

See Floor Action #3

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the revised pamphlet "The A.A. Member-Medications and Other Drugs" be approved. (See Floor Action #2)

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that the following procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference be established noting that staffs, committees, corporate boards or trustees, as referenced on page 22 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, are entitled to submit a minority appeal to the Conference (the Committee on Policy/Admissions agreed that "committees" as stated in the first paragraph of Concept V refers to trustees committees):

- 1) Historically, a minority appeal to the General Service Conference has been very rare. It is hoped that an individual entitled under Concept V to make an appeal would exhaust every avenue offered within the General Service Conference structure prior to making a minority appeal to the General Service Conference.
- 2) The minority should announce to the chair of the General Service Board, the General Service Conference delegate chair and to the General Service Office Conference coordinator that it intends to present an appeal under Concept V to the General Service Conference.
- 3) Minority appeals are to be submitted in writing 30 days prior to the General Service Conference. However, appeals may be received up to the beginning of the General Service Conference Opening Session, but, the closer to the Conference a minority appeal submission is made the more difficult it is for the General Service Office to process the background and for Conference members to fairly appraise the material. Appeals submitted later than the 30 day deadline run the risk of the matter not being heard.
- 4) The individual entitled to make an appeal under Concept V should be mindful of the logistical and practical limitations involved with organizing and distributing the written appeal if it were to be submitted after the 30 day minimum deadline prior to the General Service Conference.
- 5) All Conference members will be given notice of the minority's decision to file an appeal.
- 6) The Concept V appeal and any background should be sent to the G.S.O. Conference coordinator for distribution as soon as possible prior to the 30 day deadline. The G.S.O. Conference coordinator will be responsible for seeing that the written minority appeal, including the minority report and its documentation, are physically made available to the Conference. G.S.O. will distribute the minority report and background to all Conference members within ten business days after their receipt if feasible.
- 7) If there is a defined majority, it would be appropriate to have the majority's side presented at the General Service Conference, along with the appeal, so that all sides would be fairly represented. Both minority and majority should have material available. If the minority does not provide all of its material prior to the 30 day deadline, it will be difficult for the majority to prepare its response.
- 8) In order to acquaint the Conference members with the substance of the appeal, the minority appeal will be presented immediately following the portion of the Opening Session referred to as the "Mechanics of the Conference."
- 9) The submitter will have ten minutes to present their appeal.
- 10) After the submitter has presented their appeal, the Conference will vote to determine whether the Conference debates the minority appeal or not. It would take a simple majority vote to debate the appeal.
- 11) Should the Conference vote to debate the appeal, the appeal

will be debated after all Conference committee reports have been heard, at which time, if there is a defined majority, a designated representative of the majority will be allowed ten minutes to present the majority position.

- 12) Whether or not the appeal is debated, all Concept V minority appeals will be printed in full in the *Final Conference Report* omitting the background material. **(See Floor Action #1)**

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee recommended that the A.A. Directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) be published annually and that the General Service Office continue exploring other methods of providing the information in the directories.
- The committee recommended that areas may choose to opt-out of the 30-day pending period to complete processing of new groups.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- Propose that the A.A. General Service Board develop an A.A. Guideline relating to "YPAA," to be presented to the 2011 General Service Conference. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Future Conference-approved videos will carry both an audio and visual disclaimer that state the following:

"Protection of the anonymity of A.A. members is a fundamental principle of Alcoholics Anonymous. In this production, no member of Alcoholics Anonymous appears in full face or otherwise identifiable." **(Not Approved)**
- Recommend that a policy be created that does not allow full faces of members or actors portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- The video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" be withdrawn from distribution until the policy of showing full faces of actors who are portraying A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media is resolved. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Publishing *La Viña* as a bimonthly, perfect-bound, black & white, 68 page issue at an additional estimated cost of \$21,400 per year beginning in 2011, followed by a year of review and assessment in 2012. The results of this review and assessment will be brought to the 2013 Conference Committee on the Grapevine. **(Not Approved)**
- That the board of directors of the Grapevine and A.A.W.S. be directed to combine the catalogs from Grapevine and A.A.W.S. into one catalog. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- A delegate area may opt out of the 30-day pending period to complete processing of new groups on either a group by group or annual basis by either the delegate or delegate's appointee notifying the Records Department of the General Service Office. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION**

December 31, 2009 (with comparative totals for 2008)

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2009	Consolidated 2008
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund				
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 3,719,377	\$ 465,123		\$ 114,213	\$ 727,579	\$ 237,206	\$ 5,263,498	\$ 2,085,817
Accounts and interest receivable		119,811			202,128	113,050	434,989	522,402
Intercompany balances	(1,502,081)	(1,676,400)			1,702,781	1,475,700	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,980,297	268,420	2,248,717	2,338,838
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					25,067	1,900	26,967	334,115
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)		13,015,375		881,817			13,897,192	13,535,086
Property and Equipment (net of accumulated depreciation - 2009 - \$4,305,204; 2008 - \$4,146,273) (Note 2)			\$ 804,340		326,968	7,870	1,139,178	709,476
Deferred charges and deposits	11,647				59,198	78,239	149,084	162,160
Prepaid conventions - 2010/2015/2020	720,200						720,200	316,896
Total Assets	2,949,143	11,923,909	804,340	996,030	5,024,018	2,182,385	23,879,825	20,004,790
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable					\$ 358,014	\$ 106,049	\$ 464,063	\$ 961,143
Accrued royalties					10,581		10,581	12,095
Deferred income								
- Orders and subscriptions	\$ 2,247				57,349	1,917,612	1,977,208	1,945,000
- 2010 International Convention	2,889,883						2,889,883	
Accrued postretirement health benefits				\$ 3,962,434			3,962,434	3,965,968
Accrued pension benefits		\$ 6,712,386					6,712,386	8,101,999
Total Liabilities	2,892,130	6,712,386	\$ -	3,962,434	425,944	2,023,661	16,016,555	14,986,205
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	5,211,523	804,340	(2,966,404)	4,598,074	158,724	7,863,270	5,018,585
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	2,949,143	11,923,909	804,340	996,030	5,024,018	2,182,385	23,879,825	20,004,790

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Exhibit B

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2009 (with comparative totals for 2008)

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. Grapevine, Inc.			Consolidated 2009	Consolidated 2008
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	English	Spanish Magazine		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE									
Gross Sales					\$ 13,758,520	\$ 3,043,078	\$ 122,692	\$ 16,924,290	\$ 15,854,206
Less: Discounts					282,804	121,628	-	404,432	464,300
Net Sales					13,475,716	2,921,450	122,692	16,519,858	15,389,906
Cost of Literature Distributed									
Printing					(3,573,637)	(462,430)	(38,852)	(4,074,919)	(4,033,809)
Royalties on books					(58,803)	-	-	(58,803)	(51,097)
Direct shipping and warehousing					(1,607,902)	(674,409)	(33,434)	(2,315,745)	(2,571,343)
Gross Profit from Literature					8,235,374	1,784,611	50,406	10,070,391	8,733,657
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$ 6,296,110							6,296,110	6,462,760
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	448	\$ 3,162		\$ 137,162	737	45,900	-	187,409	568,622
Total Income	6,296,558	3,162		137,162	8,236,111	1,830,511	50,406	16,553,910	15,765,039
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)									
Program	5,582,685			-	2,646,780	1,286,264	104,878	9,620,607	9,415,922
Supporting services	3,201,077	(558,531)	\$ 47,007	(275,261)	1,828,567	676,841	-	4,919,700	5,574,722
Total Expenses	8,783,762	(558,531)	47,007	(275,261)	4,475,347	1,963,105	104,878	14,540,307	14,990,644
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,487,204)	561,693	(47,007)	412,423	3,760,764	(132,594)	(54,472)	2,013,603	774,395
Change in pension liability - nonoperating	-	831,082	-	-	-	-	-	831,082	(4,081,517)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS									
GSB La Viña support	(54,472)	-	-	-	-	-	54,472	-	-
Other Transfer	2,541,676	(350,000)	443,871	-	(2,635,547)	-	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	1,042,775	396,864	412,423	1,125,217	(132,594)	-	2,844,685	(3,307,122)
NET ASSETS									
Beginning of year	57,013	4,168,748	407,476	(3,378,827)	3,472,857	291,318	-	5,018,585	8,325,707
NET ASSETS									
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	5,211,523	804,340	(2,966,404)	4,598,074	158,724	-	7,863,270	5,018,585

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2009 (with comparative totals for 2008)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	International Convention	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	La Viña Grapevine	Supporting Services	2009 Total	2008 Total
Salaries	\$ 691,741	\$ 863,809	\$ 177,536		\$ 146,452	\$ 106,950	\$ 1,287,262	\$ 500,730	\$ 73,883	\$ 2,141,359	\$ 5,989,722	\$ 6,109,714
Payroll taxes	55,834	66,453	13,328		11,663	4,423	94,326	45,382	2,780	173,299	467,488	474,981
Health and group insurance	107,004	127,323	25,076		20,870	9,006	178,078	91,597	678	496,385	1,056,017	1,045,739
Retirement expense - funding	263,933	314,101	62,597		51,502	22,546	443,548	105,180		740,577	2,003,984	1,402,789
Other program printing	255,581	56,600	59,885			24,620	457			-	397,143	491,751
Mailing labor	108,459	12,940	1,794				-			-	123,193	132,686
Postage and express	221,007	59,427	50,672			28,510	43,041	6,234	189	37,659	446,739	501,025
Writers' fees	18,430	89,562	3,895			2,410	21,709			-	136,006	182,574
Foreign literature assistance		114,472								-	114,472	95,887
Selling expenses	382	764					251,755	126,950	7,168	30,051	417,070	396,574
Professional fees		1,457					-		285	215,423	217,165	252,994
Contracted services	72,282	162,176	30,868		4,206	21,132	75,173	211,502	12,415	529,573	1,119,327	1,123,655
Occupancy	97,250	125,924	9,767		8,818	3,557	168,605	78,563		341,807	834,291	840,433
Telephone	16,598	15,038	2,392			1,885	13,791	21,311		53,275	124,290	116,888
Equipment maintenance	1,005	4,655	64		65	65	9,728			88,358	103,940	123,674
Furniture and equipment depreciation	20,879	24,707	2,570		2,570	4,172	33,278		180	48,945	137,301	150,700
Stationery and office supplies	78,125	6,115	6,703	812	341	3,115	2,112	49,408		61,375	208,106	241,017
Office service and expense	4,392	12,172	31,048		150	15,839	13,732	49,407	263	203,109	330,112	467,671
Travel, meals and accommodations	(275)	67,452	604,068	173		77,407	10,185		5,549	431,408	1,195,967	1,601,134
Bad debts									1,488	48,257	49,745	26,460
Delegate fees			(210,611)								(210,611)	(353,592)
Total Operating Expenses	2,012,627	2,125,147	871,652	985	246,637	325,637	2,646,780	1,286,264	104,878	5,640,860	15,261,467	15,424,754
Severance benefits										65,625	65,625	333,706
Postretirement health benefits										(275,261)	(275,261)	(407,349)
Retirement expense adjustment										(558,531)	(558,531)	(528,099)
Capital projects depreciation										47,007	47,007	167,632
Total Expenses	2,012,627	2,125,147	871,652	985	246,637	325,637	2,646,780	1,286,264	104,878	4,919,700	14,540,307	14,990,644
Allocation of supporting services to activities	870,382	919,043	376,955	426	106,661	140,825	1,828,567	676,841	-	(4,919,700)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,883,009	3,044,190	1,248,607	1,411	353,298	466,462	4,475,347	1,963,105	104,878	-	14,540,307	14,990,644
Services	\$2,883,009	\$3,044,190	\$1,248,607	\$ 1,411	\$353,298	\$466,462					\$ 7,996,977	\$ 8,679,444
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 4,475,347				4,475,347	4,244,973
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,963,105	\$104,878		2,067,983	2,066,227
											14,540,307	14,990,644
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2008	<u>\$3,113,661</u>	<u>\$3,259,880</u>	<u>\$ 1,281,443</u>	<u>\$346,473</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$677,987</u>	<u>\$4,244,973</u>	<u>\$1,945,073</u>	<u>\$121,154</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>\$14,990,644</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2009
 (with comparative totals for 2008)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2009</u>	<u>2008</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 2,844,685	\$ (3,307,122)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	183,213	(87,438)
Amortization of bond premiums	34,122	21,776
Depreciation	184,308	318,322
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	87,413	(5,832)
Inventories	397,269	(464,021)
Deferred charges and other assets	(390,228)	(129,309)
Accounts and accruals payable	(498,594)	377,400
Deferred income	2,922,091	160,300
Postretirement health benefits obligation	(3,534)	(156,349)
Accrued pension benefits	<u>(1,389,613)</u>	<u>3,553,418</u>
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u> <u>By Operating Activities</u>	 <u>4,371,132</u>	 <u>281,145</u>
 FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(614,010)	(138,219)
Proceeds from sales of investments	11,251,521	5,140,389
Purchases of investments	<u>(11,830,962)</u>	<u>(6,570,056)</u>
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u> <u>By Investing Activities</u>	 <u>(1,193,451)</u>	 <u>(1,567,886)</u>
 Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	 3,177,681	 (1,286,741)
 Cash, beginning of year	 <u>2,085,817</u>	 <u>3,372,558</u>
 Cash, end of year	 <u><u>5,263,498</u></u>	 <u><u>2,085,817</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 31, 2010

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015
Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2009 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2008 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated April 14, 2009, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2009 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2009

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. by-laws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND -This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which dur-

ing 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND -This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND -A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$716,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND -A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

The GENERAL FUND -This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions. **Note 2 Accounting Policies:** The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by

A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash onhand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2009 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$3,030,367	\$ 40,052	\$2,226,026
Furniture	8 Years	741,260	10,052	714,008
Computers - hardware	3 to 5 Years	829,819	74,587	744,480
Software	5 Years	842,936	59,617	620,690
		<u>5,444,382</u>	<u>184,308</u>	<u>4,305,204</u>

Investments: Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

The Corporations follow Accounting Standards Codification 820, Fair Value Measurements. It establishes a framework for measuring fair value, and expands disclosures about fair value measurements. Investments are now classified into one of three categories.

Level 1 -Quoted prices are available in active markets for identical investments as of the reporting date.

Level 2 -Pricing inputs are other than quoted prices in active markets, which are either directly or indirectly observable as of the reporting date, and the fair value is determined through the use of models or other valuation methodologies.

Level 3 -Pricing inputs are unobservable for the investment and include situations where there is little, if any, market activity for the investment.

All of the securities held by the Corporations at December 31, 2009 and 2008 have been valued at either Level 1 or Level 2.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity and certificates of deposit.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to assist in reaching the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. The fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2009, investments were comprised as follows:

	Cost	Fair Value	Level 1	Level 2
Reserve Fund				
Certificate of deposits	\$4,507,810	\$4,507,810	\$4,507,810	\$ -
U.S. Treasury	8,195,339	8,507,565	8,507,565	-
Totals	<u>12,703,149</u>	<u>13,015,375</u>		
Postretirement Medical Fund				
Bond funds	296,019	303,459	-	303,459
Equity funds	640,504	578,358	-	578,358
	<u>936,523</u>	<u>881,817</u>		
Totals	<u>13,639,672</u>	<u>13,897,192</u>	<u>13,015,375</u>	<u>881,817</u>

Investment income for 2009 and 2008 is comprised of the following:

	2009	2008
Interest and dividends	\$ 387,933	\$ 494,412
Realized gains	(15,804)	44,040
Change in unrealized appreciation	(167,409)	43,399
Investment expenses	(17,311)	(13,229)
	<u>187,409</u>	<u>568,622</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Subsequent Events: In connection with the preparation of these consolidated financial statements, Management evaluated subsequent events after the balance sheet date of December 31,

2009 through March 31, 2010 which was the date the financial statements were able to be issued.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with ASC 715 which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, ASC 715 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under ASC 715 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2009:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 13,799,784
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>20,512,170</u>
Funded status	<u>(6,712,386)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 6,712,386</u>
Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	6.0%
Expected return on plan assets (based on historical returns)	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	4.5%
Accumulated benefit obligation	\$ 17,726,240
Benefit cost	1,136,473
Employers' contributions	1,695,004
Benefits paid	918,594
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 1,695,004
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>(558,531)</u>
	<u>1,136,473</u>

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2010	\$ 1,048,985
2011	1,070,919
2012	1,156,530
2013	1,208,261
2014	1,245,791
2015 - 2019	7,382,993

The employers' contributions for 2010 are currently budget to be \$1,685,000.

Plan assets at December 31, 2009 were composed as follows:

Domestic Equity Mutual Funds	49.1%
International Equity Mutual Funds	11.3%
Bond Mutual Funds	31.0%
Cash and equivalents	<u>8.6%</u>
	<u>100.0%</u>

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2009, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2009 is \$5,120,000 as follows:

2010	\$ 569,000
2011	569,000
2012	569,000
2013	569,000
2014	569,000
2015 to 2018	<u>2,275,000</u>
	<u>5,120,000</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 6.0% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B.

Prior to 2006 the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years.

The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2009:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$3,962,434
Benefits paid	<u>\$ 169,977</u>
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 145,716</u>
Benefit cost reported by:	
Operating entities as funded	\$ 420,977
Postretirement Medical Fund	<u>(275,261)</u>
	<u>145,716</u>

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2010	\$ 180,176
2011	190,987
2012	202,446
2013	214,593
2014	227,469
2015 - 2019	1,359,198

Note 6 Tax Status: The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Management has determined that the Corporations had no uncertain tax positions that would require financial statement recognition. The Corporations are no longer subject to audits by the applicable taxing jurisdictions for the periods prior to 2006.

2010 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office — A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities) and the Grapevine Operations. It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

Income: The 2010 budget projects gross sales of \$14,300,000. Unit sales are expected to be approximately flat when compared with the 2009 after accounting for substantial purchases prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase. The 2010 budget includes a full year of the new selling prices. While reviewing and recommending the 2010 budget, the A.A.W.S. Board considered that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long-term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately 4% higher than actual 2009 costs but slightly less than the 2009 budget. While there may be some slight increases, our publishing department does not anticipate significant increases in paper or manufacturing costs. Royalties are budgeted at \$70,000 this year. While there are only 2 remaining recipients, the increase in selling prices results in higher Royalties. Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 8% higher than the 2009 results (we anticipate an increase in smaller shipments) but 12% less than the 2009 budget. The effect of large quantity purchasing just prior to the July price increase had an effect on these costs.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$8,452,850 or 60.6%. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$217,000 greater than 2009, a direct result of the increase in prices. The 60.6% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2010 compares with 61.1% for 2009. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available through our Service Structure in the Spanish and French languages as well as English, lower print runs in non English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages.

The table below reflects the Gross Profit Percentages from 2007 through the 2010 budget.

2007	2008	2009	2010 Budget
56.8%	55.9%	61.1%	60.6%

Even though Contribution revenue has shown positive movement for the last several years, total Contributions received for 2009 were less than the 2009 budget and 2008 receipts as well. Your G.S.O. was hit hard during the last quarter of 2008 as was the country at large. During 2009, there were 5 down months and 7 up months when compared with the same month in 2008. The last 4 months of 2009 showed positive results when compared with 2008 and this gave us hope. Prudence dictates that actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream so as to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted Servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services supplied.

Contributions: Total contributions received for the year 2009 were \$166,000 (2.5%) less than 2008. For 2010, contributions have been budgeted at \$6,350,000, an increase of slightly less than 1%.

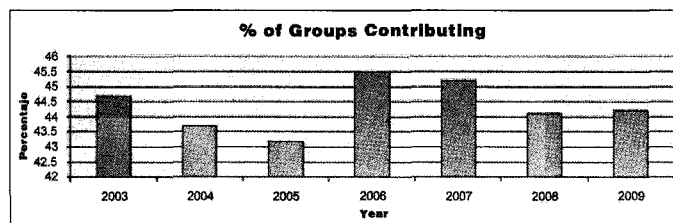
During 2009, contributions from groups and individuals of \$6,163,000 were \$198,600 (3%) less than budget and \$162,200 (2.5%) less than 2008. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International literature fund amounted to \$133,715, approximately \$4,000 less than 2008. In total, contributions received for 2009 were just over \$6,296,100.

The chart to the right reflects the approximate percentage of the AA groups that choose to list with the General Service Office that have participated in the 7th Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office.

Total Operating Revenue: for the 2010 is anticipated at \$14,803,850, an increase of approximately \$260,000 due to the increase in selling prices.

Total Operating Expenses: for 2010 have been budgeted at \$13,760,855, approximately \$500,000 or 3.8% greater than 2009 expenses and approximately one half percent greater than 2008.

The 2010 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$1,043,000 and is intended to assist in maintaining the Reserve Fund at approximately a nine-month level. This compares with an excess of revenue of \$1,273,500 for 2009 and a loss of \$275,000 for 2008.



2010 Grapevine Budget

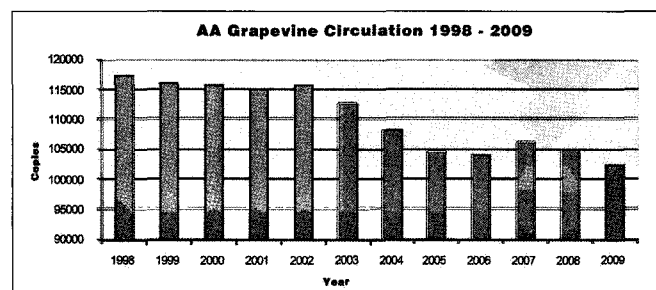
The 2010 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation of 92,000, 8,000 copies less than the 2009 budget and approximately 10,000 copies less than the 2009 average paid circulation of 102,281. Circulation for the last several years is depicted in the chart to the left.

Income: Magazine income of \$2,340,238 is expected, \$213,000 greater than 2009. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$929,957, \$135,772 higher than 2009.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$2,023,610 is budgeted for 2010. This compares with \$1,784,611 achieved for 2009 and the 2009 budget of \$1,705,728.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2010 are budgeted at \$2,315,251, \$352,146 more than the 2009 expenses of \$1,963,105.

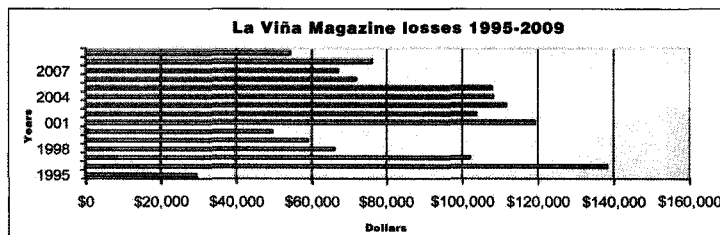
Net Income (loss): For 2010 the Grapevine anticipates a loss of \$245,741. This



compares with a 2009 budgeted loss of \$167,358 and an actual loss from operations of \$132,594.

2010 La Viña Budget

For 2010 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$23,101 compared with \$29,491 achieved in 2009. Circulation for 2010 is estimated at 9,300, approximately 360 fewer than the 9,663 average for the year 2009 and 700 fewer than the 2009 budget. Other Publishing income is estimated at \$30,498, which after deducting cost of product of \$5,702, expects to contribute \$24,796 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$126,861 for 2010, \$21,983 more than 2009. The 2010 budget projects a net loss of \$78,964, \$24,492 higher than the 2009 loss of \$54,472. To date, losses of approximately \$1,265,000 have been incurred.



The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2010 BUDGET

	GRAPEVINE ENGLISH			LA VIÑA SPANISH		
	2009 Budget	2009 Actual	2010 Budget	2009 Budget	2009 Actual	2010 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>100,000</u>	<u>102,281</u>	<u>92,000</u>	<u>10,000</u>	<u>9,663</u>	<u>9,300</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,833,600	1,939,391	2,156,000	\$84,000	84,076	80,918
Single copies and back issues	96,934	110,790	107,155	11,513	12,584	12,584
Digital Archives Project subs	51,600	50,987	50,987			
Audio Grapevine	21,600	26,097	26,096			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>2,003,734</u>	<u>2,127,265</u>	<u>2,340,238</u>	<u>95,513</u>	<u>96,660</u>	<u>93,502</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>931,975</u>	<u>880,094</u>	<u>932,958</u>	<u>74,597</u>	<u>67,169</u>	<u>70,401</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,071,759</u>	<u>1,247,171</u>	<u>1,407,280</u>	<u>20,916</u>	<u>29,491</u>	<u>23,101</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	941,409	794,185	929,957	38,558	26,030	30,498
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>307,440</u>	<u>256,745</u>	<u>313,627</u>	<u>9,529</u>	<u>5,115</u>	<u>5,702</u>
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>633,969</u>	<u>537,440</u>	<u>616,330</u>	<u>29,029</u>	<u>20,915</u>	<u>24,796</u>
Total Gross Profit	<u>1,705,728</u>	<u>1,784,611</u>	<u>2,023,610</u>	<u>49,945</u>	<u>50,406</u>	<u>47,897</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	331,969	335,208	406,108	57,000	48,150	53,800
Payroll taxes and benefits	162,538	164,784	217,057	26,085	654	12,290
Occupancy costs	73,774	71,996	74,156	4,373		
Office supplies and expenses	21,718	30,458	31,372		263	271
Magazine redesign						
Product development & Web	77,309	61,456	109,559			
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>667,308</u>	<u>663,902</u>	<u>838,252</u>	<u>87,458</u>	<u>49,067</u>	<u>66,361</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	450,084	450,784	442,350	24,148	25,732	23,400
Payroll taxes and benefits	191,104	210,830	240,709	2,964	2,804	2,907
Kable fulfillment	139,783	150,046	194,500	11,340	12,415	13,300
Occupancy costs	73,648	75,961	78,240			
Office supplies and expenses	62,248	68,357	70,408			
Selling expense-regular	136,900	111,349	176,604	15,175	7,168	15,175
- GvR program	23,400	15,601	17,800			
Postage	4,578	6,234	6,733	154	189	265
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>1,081,745</u>	<u>1,089,162</u>	<u>1,227,344</u>	<u>53,781</u>	<u>48,308</u>	<u>55,047</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Computer consulting	39,910	26,743	30,000			
Severance payments						
Insurance	7,331	5,572	6,129			
Professional fees	54,000	62,223	81,900	360	285	285
Meetings and conferences	41,646	53,292	75,000	3,500	5,549	3,500
Furniture and equipment	11,282	6,669	6,669	235	180	180
Canadian exchange and other	8,828	18,966	18,966			
Bank service charges	8,955	11,276	11,614			
Bad debts	18,281	25,300	19,377	275	1,489	1,488
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>190,233</u>	<u>210,041</u>	<u>249,655</u>	<u>4,370</u>	<u>7,503</u>	<u>5,453</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,939,286</u>	<u>1,963,105</u>	<u>2,315,251</u>	<u>145,609</u>	<u>104,878</u>	<u>126,861</u>
Interest earned	66,200	45,900	45,900			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>-167,358</u>	<u>-132,594</u>	<u>-245,741</u>	<u>-95,664</u>	<u>-54,472</u>	<u>-78,964</u>

The General Service Office 2010 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2009 Budget	2009 Actual	2010 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$13,900,000	\$13,758,520	\$14,300,000
Discounts allowed	342,000	282,804	350,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	13,558,000	13,475,716	13,950,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,800,000	3,573,637	3,700,000
Royalties	50,000	58,803	70,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	9,708,000	9,843,276	10,180,000
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,978,100	1,607,902	1,727,150
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	7,729,900	8,235,374	8,452,850
Contributions Received	6,500,000	6,296,110	6,350,000
Interest Income	4,000	1,185	1,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	14,233,900	14,532,669	14,803,850
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	\$5,253,000	\$5,195,472	\$5,457,000
Payroll taxes	394,000	392,159	409,000
Insurance	948,000	906,159	962,500
Retirement expense	1,607,000	1,850,100	1,804,000
Other program printing	443,203	397,143	424,700
Mailing, labor, etc.	132,500	123,193	110,500
Postage & express	444,500	440,316	450,500
Writers' fees	168,350	136,006	66,500
Other literature assistance	145,500	114,472	174,000
Selling expenses	238,000	282,952	268,650
Professional fees	163,500	154,656	151,500
Contracted services	842,000	895,410	1,038,600
Occupancy	744,200	719,349	740,700
Telephone	87,567	91,275	97,810
Equipment maintenance	96,142	77,197	96,270
Furniture & equipment	135,700	130,453	157,000
Stationery & office expense	184,200	158,698	172,700
Office service & expense	303,125	244,627	317,525
Travel, meals, & accomodations	1,058,301	926,515	851,400
Bad debts	10,000	22,957	10,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	\$13,398,788	\$13,259,109	\$13,760,855
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	835,112	1,273,560	1,042,995

2009 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTION PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS ⁽¹⁾	SPECIAL MEETINGS ⁽²⁾	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	437	207	47.4%	\$40,761.73	9,609	\$4.23	\$648		\$591		\$42,000.90	\$4.37
2.	Alaska	174	90	51.7	\$17,939.20	3,035	5.91	1,100		239		\$19,277.71	\$6.35
3.	Arizona	1,011	430	42.4	\$107,144.82	23,399	4.58	6,775	\$500	2,664	\$133	\$117,216.44	\$5.01
4.	Arkansas	254	139	54.6	\$25,735.11	4,550	5.65	149		1,463		\$27,347.67	\$6.01
	California												
5.	Southern	1,224	406	33.1	\$116,765.94	42,796	2.72	11,570	3,075	2,552	507	\$134,470.13	\$3.14
6.	N. Coastal	1,918	1,132	58.9	\$274,257.51	58,228	4.71	13,308	3,020	1,978	621	\$293,184.74	\$5.04
7.	N. Interior	897	434	48.3	\$79,238.66	27,482	2.88	4,112	3,000	1,043	684	\$88,077.86	\$3.20
8.	San Diego/Imp.	946	419	44.2	\$84,908.71	26,590	3.19	9,304		1,182	323	\$95,717.63	\$3.60
9.	Mid-South.	1,861	763	41.0	\$171,811.65	59,068	2.91	4,349	27	4,384	278	\$180,849.52	\$3.06
10.	Colorado	776	419	54.0	\$112,694.79	18,260	6.16	6,342		1,732	272	\$121,040.37	\$6.63
11.	Connecticut	1,599	650	40.6	\$125,442.13	39,339	3.19	6,231	185	17,914	240	\$150,012.23	\$3.81
12.	Delaware	231	129	55.7	\$36,759.65	3,565	10.31	316	25	320		\$37,420.45	\$10.50
13.	D.C.	483	227	46.9	\$53,558.36	14,676	3.65	1,903	50	2,471		\$57,982.62	\$3.95
	Florida												
14.	North	925	427	46.1	\$92,336.46	18,880	4.88	5,771		11,923	30	\$110,061.21	\$5.83
15.	South/	1,850	880	47.6	\$174,391.59	39,626	4.40	8,621	2,025	59,034	133	\$244,204.77	\$6.16
16.	Georgia	727	464	63.8	\$102,182.65	17,525	5.83	3,852	50	1,925	153	\$108,162.08	\$6.17
17.	Hawaii	310	169	54.4	\$34,182.10	5,137	6.64	639		622		\$35,443.41	\$6.90
18.	Idaho	238	111	46.6	\$18,955.86	4,755	3.98	286		937	104	\$20,282.86	\$4.27
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,231	300	24.4	\$85,704.03	29,494	2.90	5,570	1,411	3,547		\$96,232.10	\$3.26
20.	North	1,117	454	40.6	\$61,164.65	22,151	2.75	3,663	500	13,428	100	\$78,855.01	\$3.56
21.	South	472	172	36.3	\$29,318.17	8,646	3.38	1,062		1,194		\$31,574.62	\$3.65
	Indiana												
22.	North	658	250	38.0	\$36,332.70	9,708	3.74	1,760		1,291	20	\$39,403.91	\$4.06
23.	South	676	283	41.9	\$40,361.99	12,029	3.36	260		519		\$41,140.81	\$3.42
24.	Iowa	664	302	45.5	\$50,949.66	13,700	3.71	753	700	186		\$52,588.94	\$3.84
25.	Kansas	396	183	46.2	\$32,600.37	9,996	3.25	589	125	5,645	56	\$39,015.65	\$3.90
26.	Kentucky	635	314	49.3	\$74,508.17	10,409	7.16	2,512		3,746		\$80,765.97	\$7.76
27.	Louisiana	491	167	33.9	\$38,965.37	9,689	4.01	311		39		\$39,276.37	\$4.05
28.	Maine	518	189	36.4	\$18,317.18	8,298	2.20	458		1,760	38	\$20,571.88	\$2.48
29.	Maryland	1,031	415	40.2	\$79,932.26	16,057	4.97	1,545		1,150	50	\$82,677.61	\$5.15
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,414	474	33.4	\$119,484.76	47,451	2.51	8,074	25	76	189	\$127,848.57	\$2.69
31.	West	302	164	54.2	\$20,321.48	5,367	3.78	566		70		\$20,957.68	\$3.90
	Michigan												
32.	Central	638	257	40.2	\$34,397.95	13,556	2.54	2,823	2,025	466		\$39,711.91	\$2.93
33.	Southeast	923	282	30.5	\$57,056.29	21,181	2.69	1,797	175	500		\$59,527.93	\$2.81
34.	West	588	221	37.5	\$37,612.46	12,299	3.05	1,133		3,285		\$42,030.72	\$3.42
	Minnesota												
35.	North	575	253	44.0	\$28,344.66	8,782	3.22	857	100			\$29,301.82	\$3.34
36.	South	1,130	453	40.1	\$90,429.93	27,611	3.28	1,079	45	4,245		\$95,799.07	\$3.47
37.	Mississippi	236	101	42.8	\$22,105.30	4,734	4.67	103		696	3	\$22,906.66	\$4.84
	Missouri												
38.	East	553	269	48.5	\$65,650.59	9,089	7.22	4,370	1,000	3,132		\$74,152.94	\$8.16
39.	West	245	125	50.9	\$24,780.37	7,083	3.50	277		477		\$25,534.62	\$3.61
40.	Montana	292	133	45.4	\$29,201.15	5,159	5.66	424	205	1,090		\$30,920.15	\$5.99
41.	Nebraska	710	316	44.4	\$52,689.56	16,244	3.23	2,848	2,000	1,370		\$58,907.41	\$3.63
42.	Nevada	543	224	41.3	\$39,513.21	13,071	3.01	2,621		822		\$42,955.80	\$3.29
43.	New Hampshire	603	257	42.6	\$36,232.02	11,019	3.29	3,839	50	3,192	45	\$43,358.54	\$3.93
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,299	560	43.1	\$125,115.42	31,952	3.91	16,361	1,327	3,669	140	\$146,612.06	\$4.59
45.	South	530	254	47.9	\$66,645.94	8,861	7.52	2,072	602	380	241	\$69,941.39	\$7.89
46.	New Mexico	391	176	44.9	\$33,399.77	6,811	4.89	2,397		1,136		\$36,933.31	\$5.42
	New York												
47.	Central	748	281	37.5	\$50,387.23	12,340	4.07	1,874	215	954	203	\$53,633.12	\$4.35
48.	H./M./B.	780	301	38.6	\$30,869.67	11,233	2.75	654		4,967		\$36,490.71	\$3.25
49.	Southeast	1,801	735	40.7	\$229,279.35	58,335	3.93	12,796	8,010	3,750	191	\$254,025.87	\$4.35
50.	West	359	101	28.0	\$16,659.13	5,802	2.86	450				\$17,109.13	\$2.95
51.	N. Carolina	1,031	514	49.8	\$110,464.39	17,476	6.31	6,840	1,155	6,551	237	\$125,247.67	\$7.17
52.	North Dakota	153	79	51.5	\$13,108.53	3,367	3.88	31		595		\$13,734.53	\$4.08
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	773	216	27.9	\$28,595.95	10,794	2.65	2,260		1,184		\$32,040.77	\$2.97
54.	Northeast	1,483	377	25.4	\$45,972.97	20,216	2.26	959		1,144	100	\$48,175.82	\$2.38
55.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	312	99	31.6	\$13,865.54	4,446	3.11	164	50	925		\$15,004.54	\$3.37
56.	S.W. Ohio	571	255	44.6	\$41,449.20	10,618	3.89	3,309	600	426		\$45,784.18	\$4.31
57.	Oklahoma	377	190	50.3	\$35,881.36	7,817	4.58	687		1,780		\$38,347.72	\$4.91
58.	Oregon	1,037	431	41.6	\$87,070.48	19,964	4.35	3,842	3,000	2,929	92	\$96,933.98	\$4.86

59.	Pennsylvania	1,532	743	48.5	\$169,576.11	32,486	5.21	3,995	2,285	9,095	633	\$185,584.22	\$5.71
60.	East	866	388	44.8	\$56,288.67	12,087	4.65	3,000		2,160		\$61,449.14	\$5.08
61.	West	273	130	47.5	\$31,178.17	5,604	5.55	1,246		2,968		\$35,392.21	\$6.32
62.	Rhode Island	339	207	61.0	\$46,000.55	8,317	5.52	619	3,020	2,022		\$51,661.91	\$6.21
63.	South Carolina	168	70	41.7	\$9,933.84	5,088	1.94	161		468	100	\$10,663.62	\$2.10
64.	South Dakota	562	266	47.2	\$48,747.38	12,905	3.78	1,174		984		\$50,905.91	\$3.94
	Tennessee												
65.	Texas	457	213	46.5	\$76,824.03	19,966	3.85	11,317	3,000	7,601	579	\$99,320.68	\$4.97
66.	Northeast	230	76	32.9	\$18,152.54	5,138	3.52	287		3,272		\$21,711.62	\$4.23
67.	Northwest	583	287	49.2	\$73,994.47	16,288	4.53	4,431	150	3,087	165	\$81,828.46	\$5.02
68.	Southeast	568	258	45.3	\$80,673.41	13,857	5.81	905	10	3,568		\$85,156.21	\$6.15
69.	Southwest	305	163	53.3	\$32,210.86	6,225	5.17	433		4,076	75	\$36,794.81	\$5.91
70.	Utah	280	123	43.8	\$17,127.57	4,916	3.48	3,428		300		\$20,855.22	\$4.24
71.	Vermont	1,308	651	49.7	\$127,240.50	23,873	5.32	8,895	320	1,679	82	\$138,216.33	\$5.79
72.	Virginia	1,341	596	44.4	\$130,672.80	28,763	4.53	10,350	3,000	9,172	109	\$153,304.01	\$5.33
73.	Western Washington	322	139	43.2	\$12,687.73	3,501	3.62	152		1,838	15	\$14,692.10	\$4.20
	West Virginia												
	Wisconsin												
74.	N. Wis./Upper/Pen. Mich.	694	274	39.5	\$30,025.02	10,541	2.84	2,417	25	852	50	\$33,369.75	\$3.17
75.	South	1,022	421	41.2	\$53,517.48	19,113	2.80	1,324	500	851	15	\$56,206.95	\$2.94
76.	Wyoming	121	56	46.3	\$14,404.03	2,184	6.59	254		2,208		\$16,866.13	\$7.72
77.	Puerto Rico	122	67	54.9	\$7,524.54	1,255	6.00	150		1,024		\$8,698.40	\$6.93
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	510	284	55.7	\$75,121.38	8,640	8.69	447		4,452	284	\$80,304.46	\$9.29
79.	B.C./Yukon	761	414	54.4	\$106,778.74	14,820	7.20	1,169		6,656	64	\$114,668.16	\$7.74
80.	Manitoba	154	50	32.5	\$10,843.25	3,931	2.76	103	300	2,973		\$14,219.80	\$3.62
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	192	79	41.0	\$11,152.14	3,449	3.23	132		915		\$12,199.08	\$3.54
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	241	111	46.1	\$18,329.27	3,265	5.61	143		701	178	\$19,351.16	\$5.93
	Ontario												
83.	East	570	252	44.1	\$62,826.31	14,370	4.36	425		10,731	800	\$74,782.22	\$5.20
84.	Northeast	159	68	42.7	\$16,411.61	1,793	9.15	8		3,775		\$20,194.15	\$11.26
85.	Northwest	59	20	33.9	\$3,889.33	952	4.08		1,929	563		\$6,381.77	\$6.70
86.	West	568	242	42.6	\$61,165.68	11,223	5.45	1,138	869	13,539	729	\$77,441.42	\$6.90
	Quebec (3)												
87.	Southwest	555	500	90.0	\$14,938.81	12,815	1.16	1,332		13,775		\$30,045.76	\$2.34
88.	Southeast	196	157	80.1	\$1,315.18	3,095	0.41	1,004		16,910		\$19,228.53	\$6.21
89.	Northeast	308	281	91.1	\$1,823.81	5,961	0.30	928		23,521		\$26,272.54	\$4.41
90.	Northwest	366E	348E	95.0E	\$4,684.72	6,584	0.70	1,011		48,727		\$54,423.17	\$8.27
91.	Saskatchewan	280	123	43.9	\$23,734.02	3,265	7.27	698		6,179	47	\$30,658.48	\$9.39
92.	Washington East	494	200	40.5	\$31,041.12	6,573	4.71	2,434		4,023		\$37,498.68	\$5.70
93.	Central Calif	960	415	43.2	\$93,073.54	26,661	3.48	1,618		4,524	241	\$99,457.39	\$3.73
	Total U.S./Canada	61,613	27,295	44.3%	\$5,377,714.74	1,358,879	\$3.96	\$256,398.63	\$50,685.40	\$414,441.94	\$9,347.85	\$6,108,588.54	\$4.50
	Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				\$316,431.88								
	Specials				\$414,441.94								
	Total for U.S. & Canada				\$6,108,588.56								
	FOREIGN AND OTHER												
	On Line Meetings											\$555.64	
	Correctional & Hospital facility groups											\$241.00	
	Foreign											\$156,550.22	
	Internationalists											\$809.41	
	International Doctors in A.A.											\$26,500.00	
	International Young People in A.A.											\$1,000.00	
	International Lawyers in A.A.											\$789.75	
	Loners											\$1,075.00	
	Bird of a Feather												
	Grand Total				\$6,108,588.56							\$6,296,109.56	

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2009-2008 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC		
U.S. & Canada									
2009	61,613	27,295	44.3%	\$5,377,714.72	1,358,879	\$3.96	\$4.50		
U.S. & Canada									
2008	60,093	26,519	44.1%	\$5,480,770.92	1,342,380	\$4.08	\$4.69		
Increase (Decrease)	1,520	776	0.2%	-\$103,056.20	16,499	(\$0.13)	(\$0.20)	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	
								\$6.46	\$7.04

(1) A Special contribution is one that comes from any number of entities that is not an AA Group. For example, a Conference, a Committee, an Area, a District, an Intergroup, etc.

(2) A Special Meeting is a meeting that does not want to be a group but does want to contribute to the General Service Board.

(3) Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas).

2010 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Linda Clough
²Quinn Grose
 Steve Hildeman
 Mike Kimling
 Spencer Richie
 Monte Stokes
 Irma Van De Bon
¹Tom Zamaria

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Cooperation With the Professional Community

¹Ken Clark
 Jon Curphy
²Alain Desbiens
 Deb Domack
 Betsy Gerber
 Ruben Gonzalez
 Mike Rogers
 Cate Wittig

Secretary: Mary Cumings

Corrections

¹Rick Carter
 Suzette Cottrell
 John Czermerys
 Ino Fernandez
 Elaine Gaisey
 Elizabeth Martin
²Réal Normandin
 J.G. Regnier

Secretary: Jim Malone

Finance

Nancy Bagley
¹Danny Fitzgerald
 Joy Flynn
 Jim Foley
²Cher Parker
 Richard Sime
 JoAnne Taylor
 Allen Wharton

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Dean Bahr
 Jean-Claude Cromier
¹Jimmy Dean
²Judy Lavezzi
 Mike Peery
 Richard Purtell
 Alicia Rosselot
 Jamie Shropshire
 Bob Williams

Secretary: Amber Eden

Literature

Donna Gibson
 Vada Good
¹Jeff Johnson
 Chip Kronoff
 Patty Lavelly
 Lorna O'Connor
 Virginia Rogers
 Jules Roussy
 Loren Uhlenkott

Secretary: Julio Espallat

Policy/Admissions

¹Scott Ahlgren
 Don Autry
 Tim Bryson
 Gregory (Coop) Cooper
 Darryl Dunphy
 Cathie Feenie
 Angela Heuer
 Cathie Jones
²Barbara Simington

Secretary: Doug Richardson

Public Information

¹Carole Boerner
 Richard Boisvert
²Jason Carter
 Joel Castellaw
 Ross Drinen
 Tom Kepner
 Mel Lawson
 Elaine McAndrews
 Jean Smythe

Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

Report and Charter

¹Deborah Attix
 Louie Bellner
 Char
 Chazz Collette
 Billy Corbett
 Stu Elwing
 Lowell Long
²David Noll

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Treatment Facilities/ Special Needs-Accessibilities

¹Ken Bird
 Marsha Slane
 Bonnie Smith
 Dean Strassner
 David Thatch
 Dean Thrasher
 Melody Tolmie
²Dave Tully

Secretary: Gayle Solheim Riese

Trustees

Leon Arps
²John Howland
 Anne Meader
 Ray Mengler
 Kathy O'Shea
 Sandy Smith
¹Marty Watters
 Lisa Wilson
 Frank Ziemba

Secretary: Mary Dargan

Archives

Char
 Linda Clough
²Billy Corbett
 Joy Flynn
 Vada Good
 Ray Mengler
 Réal Normandin
¹Lorna O'Connor
 Tom Zamaria

Secretary: Michelle Mirza

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Scott Ahlgren
 Alain Desbiens
 Darryl Dunphy
²Elaine Gaisey
¹Elizabeth Martin
 Virginia Rogers
 Marcia Slane
 David Thatch

Co-Secretaries:

*Rick Walker
 Eva Sanchez*

2011 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee Chairperson

Agenda	Spencer Richie, Maine
³ Archives	Linda Clough, Mid-Southern California
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Deb Domack, H/M/B, NY
Corrections	Inocencio Fernandez, Puerto Rico
Finance	Joy Flynn, Kentucky
Grapevine	Jamie Shropshire, Eastern Washington
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Darryl Dunphy, Alberta/NW Territories
Literature	Patty Lavelly, Georgia
Policy/Admissions	Gregory (Coop) Cooper, Rhode Island
Public Information	Melanie Lawson, Western Michigan
Report and Charter	Char, Southwest Texas
Treatment	David Thatch, South Carolina
Trustees	Anne Meader, Oregon

Alternate

Steve Hildeman, N. Wis./Upper Penn. Mich.
 Ray Mengler, Northern Illinois
 Cate Wittig, Manitoba
 Suzette Cottrell, Arizona
 Allen Wharton, Wyoming
 Richard Purtell, New Hampshire
 Virginia Rogers, Southern Indiana
 Chip Kronoff, Western Massachusetts
 Angela Heuer, Idaho
 Joel Castellaw, San Diego/Imperial California
 Chazz Collette, Vermont
 Marsha Slane, New Mexico
 Ray Mengler, Northern Illinois

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2010 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 58th General Service Conference.

2010 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

George Martin, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Frances Brisbane
Corliss Burke
El Nault
Pamela Reising
Michelle Mirza, *secretary*

Audit

Madeleine Parmley, *chairperson*
Terry Bedient
Dorothy Hurley
John Kane
Don Miller
Don Meurer, *secretary*

Compensation

George Martin, *chairperson*
Dorothy Hurley
John Kane
Don Miller
Madeleine Parmley
Don Meurer, *consultant*
Eugene O'Brien, *consultant*
Olga Mesonjnik, *secretary*

Conference

Madeleine Parmley, *chairperson*
Conley Byrd
Bill Clark
Don Miller
El Nault
Bill Noonan
Vic Phillips
Albin Zezula
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities/ Special Needs-Accessibilities

Conley Byrd, *chairperson*
Corliss Burke
Bill Clark
Rogelio Flores
Roberta Lindeman
Don Massey
Vic Phillips
Albin Zezula
Mary Swart Cumings,
secretary — C.P.C.
Gayle Solheim Reese, *secretary*
*— Treatment Facilities/
Special Needs-Accessibilities*

Corrections

Ken Brueggemann, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Corliss Burke
Rogelio Flores
Bill Noonan
Don Miller
*Diane Olsen
Albin Zezula
Jim Malone, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Terrance Bedient, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
Dorothy Hurley
John Kane
George Martin
Don Miller
Bill Noonan
Madeleine Parmley
Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Jo-Anne Lowenberger, *chairperson*
Terry Bedient
Nancy Haynes
Bill Noonan
Madeleine Parmley
Don Massey
Warren Stafford, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Bill Clark, *chairperson*
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Frances Brisbane
Nancy Haynes
John Kane
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
El Nault
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*
—Regional Forums
Rick Walker, *secretary*
—International Conventions

Literature

Vic Phillips, *chairperson*
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Frances Brisbane
*Lizz Hudson
Roberta Lindeman
Don Massey
Pam Reising
Valerie O'Neill, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Julio Espaillat, *secretary*

Nominating

Rogelio Flores, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
Conley Byrd
Bill Clark
Dorothy Hurley
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
George Martin
Madeleine Parmley
Mary Dargan, *secretary*

Public Information

Terry Bedient, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
*Tom Bercher
Nancy Haynes
*Tina Hqrnsby
Roberta Lindeman
George Martin
Pamela Reising
Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Conley Byrd, *chairperson*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Ward Ewing
First vice-chairperson
Madeleine Parmley
Second vice-chairperson
Bill Clark
Secretary
Conley Byrd
Treasurer
Terrance Bedient
Assistant secretary
Doug Richardson
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 10



Traditionally, Conference members leave a book on a specified table and whenever delegates have a spare moment or two they sign books or write a message – a nice remembrance of Conference week.

*Denotes appointed committee members

** Ward Ewing is an ex officio member on all committees; Phyllis Halliday is an ex officio on all committees except the Audit Committee, Compensation Committee and the Nominating Committee.

2010 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Ward B. Ewing, D.D. (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected chairman of the board in 2009, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles.

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected Class A trustee and treasurer in May 2008. Currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York, his 30+ year career has included various executive positions, including hospital CEO. He has served on 12 nonprofit boards including the New York Lawyer Assistance Trust, which oversees substance abuse programs for attorneys and judges. Terry is a Fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives. He chairs the Finance & Budgetary and Public Information Committees and serves on the International and Audit Committees.

Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. (53 Rustic Ave., Medford, NY 11763) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. A graduate of Columbia University School of Social Work, she received a doctorate in Organization Development from Union Graduate School and University, Cincinnati, Ohio. Frances is the author of many articles and publications and has over 100 major presentations, nationally and internationally, on topics relating to substance abuse prevention and people of African ancestry. She is currently dean and professor, School of Social Welfare, S.U.N.Y. at Stony Brook, New York. Frances serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Archives and Literature Committees.

Corliss Burke, B.Ed. (11 Hayes Place, Whitehorse, Yukon Y1A 0E1) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. During her 26 years in the addiction field, Corliss has worked as a counselor, trainer, senior manager and Deputy Minister. Throughout this time, she has always been involved with Alcoholics Anonymous, attending open A.A. meetings in many countries and working to implement the Bridging the Gap program in Alberta and in the Yukon. Currently, her consulting business focuses on addictions program design and development, as well as on counselor training. Corliss serves on the Archives, Corrections, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

***William D. Clark, M.D.** (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School, and is board certified in internal medicine. Bill was medical director of the Addiction Resource Center (Brunswick, ME) and an attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Brunswick until he retired from patient care activities in 2004. Throughout his career he has taught physicians about alcoholism, with particular attention to doctor-patient communication and relationship issues. He is managing editor of a multi-media resource that helps medical students and physicians learn better communication and relationship skills. He teaches in medical schools and post-

graduate programs (residency), presents seminars and programs on alcoholism and writes papers and book chapters on these topics. He chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Conference and Nominating Committees.

The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores is now the Senior Judge on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara. He is assigned to various collaborative courts, including Drug Court and Mental Health Court, and is on the Board of Directors of the National Association of Drug Court Professionals. Rogelio chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities and Corrections Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Kenneth Brueggemann (6111 Belvedere Blvd., Omaha, NE 68111-1274) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 48 delegate, Ken remains active in his area. When he served as area remote communities chair he was instrumental in having A.A. literature translated into Nuer for the Sudanese population, and for 25 years has worked with groups in prisons and jails. Having taught high school for 32 years, Ken continues to substitute teach. He chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Conley F. Byrd, Jr. (Box 3, 1506 S. Hwy. 365, Redfield, AR 72132) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 43 delegate, Conley is active in his group, district and area. A graduate of LSU School of Veterinary Medicine, he is owner and sole practitioner of a Veterinary Hospital. Conley chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs Committee and serves on the Conference and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

Dorothy L. Hurley (304 Donna Dr., Plymouth Meeting, PA 19462) was elected general service trustee in April 2007. Dorothy served as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board (2004-2007) and has been active in her group and intergroup. With a professional background in organization development, administration, and education, she is now a university professor. Dorothy chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the Audit, Compensation, Finance and Budgetary, International and Nominating Committees.

John J. Kane, Jr. (549 Grant Ave., Collingswood, NJ 08107-1926) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 46 delegate, he served on committees in Area 45 and is an active sponsor. A mechanical engineer by profession, John is currently

Community Development Director of his town. John chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Audit, Compensation, Finance and Budgetary and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Jo-Anne Lowenberger (303 Regal Ave., Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 2007. A Panel 52 delegate, Jo-Anne spearheaded the Canadian Archives Display for the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming in St. Louis. A present and active member in her area, Jo-Anne is always happy to participate, when asked, to do and be part of any service activity, and loves being with the Fellowship wherever that may take her. She retired in January 2009 after nearly 30 years as a department manager for an International food chain. Jo-Anne chairs the International Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She has served as the Interim Eastern Canada regional trustee and also as a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

George G. Martin (209 East Liberty St., Milford, MI 48381) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. George has been a nontrustee director on the A.A. World Services Board, and has served on several trustees' committees, as well as the Employees' Retirement Committee. An attorney, his law practice primarily involves representation of nonprofit corporations in finance and business transactions. George chairs the Archives and Compensation Committees and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Nominating and Public Information Committees. He continues to serve as a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

Don Massey (3928 Uri St., Metairie, LA 70002) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2009. Don was a Panel 55 delegate and today is an active sponsor who also facilitates group, district and other A.A. entities inventories. An attorney, Don is adjunct professor, University of New Orleans and is an active member of various civic and legal organizations, including the Lawyers Assistance Program. He serves on the International, Literature and Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

Don Miller (P.O. Box 270389, Louisville, CO 80027) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. Don, a Panel 49 delegate, served on the A.A. World Service Board as a non-trustee director, 2003-2006. He is involved in project management and organizational development for new businesses. Don serves on the Audit, Compensation, Conference, Corrections, and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Eleanor (El) W. Nault (588 Crowe Mountain Rd., Walhalla, SC 29691) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2009. A Panel 56 delegate, El remains active not only in her home group, but in many area and district service functions. El's professional background is in city and regional planning; she recently retired as a teacher and administrator of a four-year research university. El serves on the Archives, Conference and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

***Madeleine Parmley** (2840 N. Englewood Place, Meridian, ID 83646) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2006. She served as a Panel 52 delegate and has long been active in carrying the message into jails and prisons, and has volunteered

as a camp counselor for incarcerated mothers and their children. Madeleine is a trauma care nurse. She chairs the Audit and Conference Committees and also serves on the Compensation, Finance and Budgetary, International and Nominating Committees.

Victor Phillips (Suite 204, 516 Cedar Crescent SW, Calgary, AB T3C 2Y8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 54 delegate, Vic currently serves as a director on the A.A. World Services Board, attends service events in his region, and goes to several regular A.A. meetings per week wherever he travels. Vic's professional background is in finance and management. He chairs the Literature Committee and also serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Communities/ Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and Conference Committees.

Pamela Reising (31829 Sheridan Dr., Beverly Hills, MI 48025) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2009. A former Panel 45 delegate, Pam is now Michigan Statewide treasurer and facilitator of her area's monthly G.S.R. orientation. Pam's background is in the criminal justice field and she teaches at a state university. She serves on the Archives, Literature and Public Information Committees.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2010 Conference

Rod Betonney (6553 Elmcrest Dr., #13F, Salt Lake City UT 84107) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 47 delegate, Rod is a licensed clinical social worker with a health care facility.

Donald Cusson (520 Joseph-Guay, Terrebonne, Quebec J6W 4S9) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 54 delegate Don is active in his district and area and is owner of a pest control company.

John A. Fromson, M.D. (221 Winslow Rd., Waban, MA 02468) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. He is a graduate of New York Medical College and is a board certified addiction specialist. John is an associate director of postgraduate medical education, Dept. of Psychiatry, Massachusetts General Hospital, and teaches at Harvard Medical School. He is the author of many articles and lectures widely.

Michele Grinberg, J.D. (4111 Staunton Ave., SE, Charleston, WV 25304) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. A graduate of West Virginia University College of Law, Michele is a practicing attorney with a concentration in health care policy, legislation and client compliance. She is co-editor of *Women and the Law*.

Roberta S. Lindeman (3487 Long Drive, Minden, NV 89423) was elected general service trustee in April 2010. Roberta served as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board, 2006 to 2010. With a background in teaching and counseling she currently owns an educational consulting firm.

A.A. World Services Directors

Andrea Barthwell, *director*
 John Kane, *regional trustee*
 Phyllis Halliday, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jo-Anne Lowenberger,
trustee-at-large/Canada

Roberta Lindeman, *director*
 George Martin, *general service trustee*
 Bill Noonan, *director*
 Doug Richardson, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Dorothy Hurley, *chairperson,*
general service trustee
 Ginger Rhoades Bell, *director*
 Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Ken Brueggemann, *regional trustee*

Conley Byrd, *regional trustee*
 Nancy Haynes, *director*
 Don Miller, *general service trustee*
 Albin Zezula, *director*

General Service Office Staff

Phyllis Halliday, *general manager*
 Adrienne Brown
 Mary Swart Cumings
 Mary Dargan
 Julio Espallat
 Mary Clare Lynch

Jim Malone
 Doug Richardson
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Amber Eden, *managing editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Militza Alma-Noyola, *staff assistant*
 Janet Arzooman, *GV assoc. editor*
 Ellie Biscuti, *support services*
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./executive asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *office coordinator*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish-language editor*
 Sheila Coppin-Thom, *staff assistant*
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennen, *executive assistant to general manager*
 John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Irene Donoso, *La Viña editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Frank Lama, *GV circulation manager*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Michelle Mirza, *archivist*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Valerie O'Neill, *publications director*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Frank Segui, *finance secretary*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*
 Robert Slotterback, *controller*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *Conference staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *office manager*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Summer Edition Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeriti

Leonard Blumenthal
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn
 Elaine McDowell, Phd.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 60th Conference includes Panel 59 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 60 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	59	Lisa Wilson 8121 Lillian Hwy, #45 Pensacola, FL 32506
Alaska	2	60	Loren Uhlenkott 2440 E. Tudor Rd. PMB 1115 Anchorage, AK 99507
Arizona	3	60	Suzette Cottrell 5502 E. Sandra Terrace Scottsdale, AZ 85254
Arkansas	4	59	James (J.G.) Regnier 51 Kingspark Rd. Little Rock, AR 72227
California Southern	5	59	Mike Peery 476 Sturtevant Dr., #K Sierra Madre, CA 91024-1396
Central	93	59	Jeff Johnson 11006 Orion Ave. Mission Hills, CA 91345-1337
Northern Coastal	6	59	David Noll 1005H Bryant Way Sunnyvale, CA 94087
Northern Interior	7	60	Melody Tolmie 9767 Deep Water Lane Stockton, CA 95219
San Diego/Imperial	8	60	Joel Castellaw 4239 Collwood Lane San Diego, CA 92115
Mid-Southern	9	60	Linda Clough 1873 Parkview Circle Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	59	Judith (Judy) Lavezzi 2280 Forest Ave. Boulder, CO 80304
Connecticut	11	59	Ken Bird 6 Plant Dr. Waterford, CT 06385
Delaware	12	60	Frank Ziemba 1 Lindsay Lane Ocean View, DE 19970
District of Columbia	13	59	Delma (Elaine) Gaisey 1825 Maryland Ave. NE, #18 Washington, DC 20002-3072
Florida North	14	59	Chet Parker 1006 Eastern Way Orlando, FL 32804
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I./ Antigua/St. Martin/ Cayman Islands	15	59	Ken Clark 601 23rd Place SW Vero Beach, FL 32962-8110
Georgia	16	60	Patty Lavelly 202 Lee Blvd. Savannah, GA 31405
Hawaii	17	59	Elizabeth Martin 46-271 Heeia St. Kaneohe, HI 96744
Idaho	18	60	Angela Heuer 1381 Avon Lane Idaho Falls, ID 83401-3792

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	59	Carole Boerner 4522 Shasta Ln. Billings, MT 59101
<i>Chicago</i>	19	59	Ruben Gonzalez 3528 W. Lyndale St. Chicago, IL 60647	Nebraska	41	60	Leon Arps 1110 N. 85th St. Omaha, NE 68114
<i>Northern</i>	20	60	Ray Mengler 13415 Rockton Trail Huntley, IL 60142	Nevada	42	59	Jason Carter 3932 Sarah Court Reno, NV 89509
<i>Southern</i>	21	59	Dean Strassner 724 N. Bruns Lane, #D Springfield, IL 62702	New Hampshire	43	60	Richard Purtell 6 Pete's Way Pelham, NH 03076
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	59	Barbara Simington 6703 Waveland Ave. Hammond, IN 46323	<i>Northern</i>	44	59	Cathie Feenie 401 Hickory St. Kearny, NJ 07032
<i>Southern</i>	23	60	Virginia Rogers 1708 Maynard St. Indianapolis, IN 46227	<i>Southern</i>	45	60	Elaine McAndrews 318 E. Third Ave. Runnemede, NJ 08078
Iowa	24	59	Rick Carter 1551 Washington St. Muscatine, IA 52761	New Mexico	46	60	Marsha Slane Box 321 Cloudcroft, NM 88317
Kansas	25	60	Mike Rogers 2849 N. Woodland St. Wichita, KS 67204-5159	New York			
Kentucky	26	60	Joy Flynn 236 Pindell Court Lexington, KY 40515	<i>Central</i>	47	59	Vada Good 43 C Veldor Park Rochester, NY 14612
Louisiana	27	59	Robert (Bob) Williams 2149 Helen St. Opelousas, LA 70570	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	60	Debra (Deb) Domack 385 Dewitt Mills Rd. Kingston, NY 12401
Maine	28	60	Spencer Richie Box 502 Brunswick, ME 04011	<i>Southeast</i>	49	59	Richard Sime 2501 Palisade Ave, #2-A Bronx, NY 10463
Maryland	29	60	Nancy Bagley 312 Landis Rd. Hagerstown, MD 21740	<i>Western</i>	50	60	John Czermerys Box 191, Station C Buffalo, NY 14209
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	59	Deborah Attix 2401 W. Club Blvd. Durham, NC 27705
<i>Eastern</i>	30	59	John Howland 105 Mt. Pleasant Ave. Roxbury, MA 02119	North Dakota	52	59	Lorna O'Connor 121 9th Ave. West Dickinson, ND 58601
<i>Western</i>	31	60	Charles (Chip) Kronoff 577 Suffield St. Agawam, MA 01001	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central/Southeast</i>	53	59	Jean Smythe 8411 Central College Rd. New Albany, OH 43054
<i>Central</i>	32	59	Michael (Mike) Kimling 2461 Steff-Ann Dr. Adrian, MI 49221	<i>Northeast</i>	54	59	Dan (Danny) Fitzgerald 25 Frederick Ave., #4 Akron, OH 44310
<i>Southeast</i>	33	59	Donna Gibson 4610 Campbell Dearborn Heights, MI 48125	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	60	Louie Bellner 4435 May Dr. Maumee, OH 43537
<i>Western</i>	34	60	Melanie (Mel) Lawson 9769 Division Dr. Ceresco, MI 49033	<i>Southwest</i>	56	60	Alicia Rosselot 603 Terrace Ave. Cincinnati, OH 45220
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	59	Ross Drinen 11013 E. 63rd St. Tulsa, OK 74133
<i>Northern</i>	35	60	Jon Curphy 509 15th St. N Virginia, MN 55792	Oregon	58	60	Anne Meader 12460 Crisp Dr. Oregon City, OR 97045
<i>Southern</i>	36	59	Scott Ahlgren 10970 43rd Ave., N Plymouth, MN 55442	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	60	Thomas (Tom) Kepner 105 Club Place Madison, MS 39110	<i>Eastern</i>	59	59	Lowell Long 2042 Chatham Park Dr., #418 Williamsport, PA 17701
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	59	Bonnie Smith 211 Phillips Dr. Pittsburgh, PA 15241
<i>Eastern</i>	38	59	Jim Foley 510 Sarah Lane, #A Creve Coeur, MO 63141				
<i>Western</i>	39	59	Quinn Grose 4820 SW Leafwing Dr. Lee's Summit, MO 64082				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	60	Gregory (Coop) Cooper 3363 Post Rd. South Kingstown, RI 02879
South Carolina	62	60	David Thatch 202 Atherton Way Greer, SC 29650
South Dakota	63	60	Dean Bahr 217 First Ave., #5 Ipswich, SD 57451
Tennessee	64	60	Donald (Don) Autry 2165 Night Shade Dr Germantown, TN 38139
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	59	Jimmy Dean 8111 LBJ Freeway, #860 Dallas, TX 75251
<i>Northwest</i>	66	60	Timothy (Tim) Bryson 4205 Crestgate Ave. Midland, TX 79707
<i>Southeast</i>	67	59	Elizabeth (Betsy) Gerber 12810 Fox Arrow Lane Houston, TX 77041
<i>Southwest</i>	68	60	Char 12601 Sandtrap Lane San Antonio, TX 78217
Utah	69	59	Monte Stokes 138 S. Eccles Ave. Ogden, UT 84404-4015
Vermont	70	60	Charles (Chazz) Collette 675 Rt. 4A West Castleton, VT 05735
Virginia	71	59	Thomas (Tom) Zamaria 13828 Delaney Rd. Woodbridge, VA 22193
Washington			
<i>State East</i>	92	60	Jamie Shropshire 3032 Mayfair Dr. Lewiston, ID 83501-4268
<i>Western</i>	72	59	David (Dave) Tully 13217 Fourth Ave. SW Seattle, WA 98146-3338
West Virginia	73	59	Kathleen (Kathy) O'Shea Box 1144 Huntington, WV 25713
Wisconsin			
<i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	60	Steve Hildernan 2400 Palisades Dr. Appleton, WI 54915
<i>Southern</i>	75	59	Stuart (Stu) Elwing Box 357 Campbellsport, WI 53010-0357
Wyoming	76	60	Allen Wharton 811 E. 23rd St. Casper, WY 82601
Puerto Rico	77	60	Inocencio (Ino) Fernandez Box 9983 San Juan, PR 00908-9983

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	60	Darryl Dunphy 3912-23 Ave. SW Calgary, AB T3E 0J8
B.C./Yukon	79	59	Martin (Marty) Watters 9478 Greenglade Rd. Sidney, BC V8L 3T7
Manitoba	80	60	Catherine (Cate) Wittig 301 Wildwood Park Winnipeg, MB R3T OE5
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	60	Jean-Claude Cormier 24 Chemin Chartersville Dieppe, NB E1K 1K1
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	59	William (Billy) Corbett 509 English Mountain Rd. Kentville, NS B4N 3V8
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	59	Sandra (Sandy) Smith 38 Bourdeau Crescent Embrun, ON K0A 1W0
<i>Northeast</i>	84	59	Cathie Jones 130 Churchill Blvd. Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6A 3Z8
<i>Northwest</i>	85	59	JoAnne Taylor 412 N. James St. Thundar Bay, ON P7C 4T2
<i>Western</i>	86	60	Dean Thrasher 21-273 Elgin St. Brantford, ON N3S 5B2
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	60	Jules Roussy 5, rue Marcel Dubé Blainville, PQ J7C 4W4
<i>Southeast</i>	88	59	Réal Normandin 380, rue St-Georges Windsor, PQ J1S 1K7
<i>Northeast</i>	89	59	Alain Desbiens 249 avenue Nolin Alma, PQ G8B 3N5
<i>Northwest</i>	90	60	Richard Boisvert 409, rue du Rhone Lachenaie, PQ J6W 5M3
Saskatchewan	91	59	Irma Van De Bon Box 488 Esterhazy, SK S0A 0X0